

Tatweer HR Manual 2018

Adopt the HR Manual of DDC

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معالي / يحيى بن سعيد بن عبدالله الجابري
رئيس مجلس الإدارة
هيئة المنطقة الاقتصادية الخاصة بالدقم
تحية طيبة وبعد:

الموضوع: لائحة الموارد البشرية لشركة عمان لتطوير
المنطقة الاقتصادية الخاصة بالدقم

بالإشارة إلى خطاب معاليكم رقم الدقم/٢٠١٨/١٣٨٤ المؤرخ ٢٨/٩/١٤٢٨ هـ الموافق
٢٠١٨/٦/١٣ بشأن طلب الإستمرار في قيام شركة عمان لتطوير المنطقة الاقتصادية الخاصة
بالدقم بتطبيق لائحة الموارد البشرية الخاصة بشركة تنمية الدقم.

نود إفادة معاليكم بأنه لا مانع لدينا من إستمرار الشركة المذكورة في تطبيق لائحة
الموارد البشرية الخاصة بشركة تنمية الدقم بعد الأخذ بملاحظات هذه الوزارة على بعض
البند الواردة في الكشف المرفق دون الحاجة لتطوير لائحة جديدة.

وتفضلوا معاليكم بقبول فائق الإحترام،،،

درويش بن إسماعيل بن علي البلوشي
الوزير المسؤول عن الشؤون المالية



الترتيب / المرفق	المادة	النقطة	نص المرسوم	رأي وزارة المالية
الإجازات المرضية	٦,٥,١	٥	يحق للشركة خصم مبلغ من مكافأة نهاية العام عن الإجازة المرضية التي أخذها الموظف خلال العام.	لا يحق للشركة خصم مبلغ من مكافأة نهاية العام عن الإجازة المرضية التي أخذها الموظف خلال العام إذا كانت ضمن نطاق عدد الإجازات المسموح بها في قانون العمل. عليه تعدل المادة على أن تكون على النحو التالي: يحق للشركة خصم مبلغ من مكافأة نهاية العام عن الإجازة المرضية التي أخذها الموظف خلال العام إذا تجاوزت نطاق عدد الإجازات المسموح بها في قانون العمل.
		٧	يعوض الموظف عن إجازته المرضية أثناء خروجه في إجازة سنوية.	لا يمكن تعويض الموظف عن إجازته المرضية أثناء خروجه في إجازة سنوية. عليه يرحى حذف هذا البند.
مقدم إيجار منزل	٨,٢,١	٤	يمنح الموظفون مقدم إيجار منزل يصل لمدة ستة أشهر وذلك حسب عقد الإيجار.	نرى أن يتم المنح لمدة الستة أشهر الأولى من الانضمام (للموظفين الأجانب الجدد فقط). عليه يجب تعديل المادة بذلك.
	٨,٢,٢	٢-١	-يخصص بدل نقل أو سيارة للموظفين حسب الدرجة الوظيفية. -يخصص سيارة للموظفين في الدرجة الأولى بحيث لا تتجاوز قيمتها ٢٨ ألف ريال عماني.	نرى تخصيص سيارة للرئيس التنفيذي بحيث لا يتجاوز قيمتها ٢٥ ألف ريال عماني ، وعلى أن لا يجمع بين البدل المقرر والسيارة المخصصة، وبحيث يكون الحد الأدنى لفترة إستبدال السيارات ٩

توفير بدلات نقل أو سيارة			سنوات من تاريخ شرائها، ووقف تخصيص سيارات للإستخدام من قبل الموظفين بحيث يتم صرف علاوة النقل بدلا من تخصيص السيارات لهم. أية مخالفات مرورية أو إصابات من حوادث يتحملها الموظف (السائق) والسماح بتوفير سيارة أخرى للعاملين في الشركة شريطة أن تكون لأغراض العمل فقط. عليه يرجى تعديل المواد بناء على ذلك.
	٣		لا نرى تخصيص سيارة للموظفين في الدرجة الثانية بحيث لا تتجاوز قيمتها ٢٣ ألف ريال عماني
بدل أثاث	٨,٢,٣	٥-١	يتم توفير بدل أثاث للموظفين في الدرجة الأولى وحتى الدرجة الرابعة. ويصرف البدل مرة واحدة خلال فترة العمل في الشركة. وينود أخرى.
هواتف نقالة ومعدات اتصالات	٨,٢,٥	١	يتم توفير بدل هاتف نقال للموظفين الذين تتطلب طبيعة عملهم ذلك.
		٢	يتم توفير هواتف نقالة للموظفين في الدرجة الأولى وحتى الدرجة الثالثة
		٣	يتم تغيير نوع الجهاز ومدة إستخدامه بقرار من الرئيس التنفيذي أو نائبه.

بديل دراسة أبناء الموظفين.	٨,٢,٦	٢-١	يتم توفير بديل دراسة أبناء للموظفين في الدرجة الأولى وحتى الدرجة الرابعة، بحيث يكون لطفلين لأعمار من (١-١٨) سنة.	نرى تعديل المادة بحيث تكون قيمة البديل بمقدار ٢,٠٠٠ ر.ع للطفل الواحد للدرجات الوظيفية من ٤-١ ويكون لطفلين فقط من عمر ٣ سنوات وحتى ١٨ سنة.
تأمين الحياة	٨,٢,٨	١	يتم توفير تأمين على الحياة لموظفي الشركة. وفي حالة عدم رغبة الموظف في الحصول على التأمين يوفر له بديل سنوي عن ذلك.	نرى منح هذه المنفعة فقط للموظفين المعرضين للخطر بسبب طبيعة عملهم، وأن لا تتعدى هذه الفائدة ٣٦ راقباً أساسياً. كما لا نرى منح البديل في حالة عدم رغبة الموظف الحصول على التأمين.
التأمين الصحي	٨,٢,٨	٤-٢	يشمل التأمين الصحي جميع عائلة الموظف.	المنتفعين: العامل وزوجه غير العامل وأولاده غير العاملين بحيث تكون فقط للعائلة وثلاث أطفال كحد أقصى ولا تتجاوز أعمارهم ١٨ سنة، وشريطة عدم تمتعهم بأي تأمين صحي آخر. <u>نطاق التغطية:</u> تكون التغطية فقط في السلطنة إلا في حالة وجود مهمة عمل خارج السلطنة، بحيث لا تشمل التغطية المستشفيات في مستوى A حسب تصنيف شركات التأمين، عدم شمول التغطية لأمراض الحمل والولادة ومعالجة الأسنان وعلاج أمراض العيون والأمراض المتسببة تلقائياً. <u>نسبة التغطية:</u> يتحمل الموظف ٢٠٪ من إجمالي التكلفة الصحية. <u>سقف التغطية التأمينية:</u> ٦٠٠٠-١٠٠٠٠ ريال عماني سنوياً للمعالجة داخل السلطنة وان تكون مرتبطة

				بالدرجة الوظيفية.												
				وقف الفحص الطبي الدوري ما لم تكن طبيعة الوظيفة تتطلب إجراء الفحص، على أن يتم حصر وتحديد الوظائف التي تتطلب طبيعتها إجراء فحوص طبية دورية مع تحديد تلك الفحوص على وجه الدقة. ويكون الفحص الطبي للموظف فقط دون العائلة.												
				ويرجى تعديل اللائحة وفقاً لذلك.												
التعويض/علاوة السفر	٨,٢,٩	٦	منح بدل السفر للموظفين بمقدار ١٠ ريال لكل يوم عند الذهاب للقدم.	نرى وقف هذه الميزة.												
		٨ و ١٠	منح تعويض للموظفين في حالة الحضور أو السفر لمهمة عمل وذلك حسب الآتي:	نرى تعديل المواد حسب الجدول المرفق الذي يوضح بدلات المهمات الرسمية خارج و داخل عمان.												
			<table border="1"> <tr> <th>الدول</th> <th>الدرجات ٢ أو ٣</th> <th>الدرجات ٤ والأخرى</th> </tr> <tr> <td>دول الخليج</td> <td>٢٠٠</td> <td>١٥٠</td> </tr> <tr> <td>الدول الأخرى</td> <td>٢٥٠</td> <td>١٥٠</td> </tr> <tr> <td>داخل عمان</td> <td colspan="2">التعويض بناء على المضروف الفعلي</td> </tr> </table>	الدول	الدرجات ٢ أو ٣	الدرجات ٤ والأخرى	دول الخليج	٢٠٠	١٥٠	الدول الأخرى	٢٥٠	١٥٠	داخل عمان	التعويض بناء على المضروف الفعلي		وعلى أن تقوم الشركة بحجز الفندق وتذاكر السفر حيثما أمكن داخل الحد الأقصى المذكور في الجدول المرفق.
الدول	الدرجات ٢ أو ٣	الدرجات ٤ والأخرى														
دول الخليج	٢٠٠	١٥٠														
الدول الأخرى	٢٥٠	١٥٠														
داخل عمان	التعويض بناء على المضروف الفعلي															
			يستحق أعضاء مجلس الإدارة والموظفين في الدرجة ١ و ٢ الذهاب على درجة رجال الأعمال، وبقية الموظفين على الدرجة السياحية.	- وأن لا تقوم الشركة بدفع البديل في حالة توفر السكن للموظف عن طريق جهة أخرى. كما أن البدلات لا تشمل تكاليف أخرى مثل المكالمات الهاتفية التجارية والترفيه وحجز غرف المؤتمرات وتكاليف النقل بين المدن (بالطيران / السكك الحديدية / الحافلة) ويمكن للموظف المطالبة بذلك المبلغ في حالة توفر إيصالات أصلية												

تشبهت ذلك.				
- في حالة السفر داخل البلد ، يحق للموظف الحصول على بدل إقامة بنسبة ٥٠% إذا كانت الرحلة لا تتطلب المبيت. - في حالة إلغاء / العودة في وقت مبكر من رحلة العمل ، يجب على الموظف إرجاع البدل المستلم / علاوة الفائض إلى الشركة. - يتم تخفيض المصروفات اليومية والإقامة بنسبة ٥٠% لفترة التدريب المتواصلة والتي تزيد عن ١٥ يوماً. - تعطى أولوية الطيران للرحلات المحلية والدولية إلى الناقل الوطني (الطيران العماني).				
نرى تعديل المادة بأن حجوزات التذاكر تتم عن طريق الشركة ولا يمكن التعويض النقدي للموظف في حالة عدم رغبته الذهاب لمهمة عمل عن طريق الطيران.	تعويض الموظف بنسبة ٧٥% في حالة عدم الذهاب لمهمة عمل عن طريق الطيران	١٢		
نرى تعديل المادة بأن يعطى الموظف مكافأة نهاية الخدمة تعادل أجر خمسة عشر يوماً عن كل سنة خدمة من السنوات الثلاث الأولى وأجر شهر عن كل سنة من السنوات المتبقية. وذلك حسب قانون العمل العماني.	يحق للموظف أخذ راتب أساسي شهري عن كل سنة في خدمة الشركة.	١١	٨,٣,٢	مكافأة نهاية الخدمة للموظفين غير العمانيين
يجب وقف هذه الميزة.	يحق للموظف أخذ قرض يعادل راتب أساسي بحيث يتم إستراده خلال عام.	١	٨,٤,١	القرض الشخصية

البيانات الرسمية خارج عمان			
الدرجة	الميزان الوظيفي	المسكن	درجة التطوير
أعضاء مجلس الإدارة والرئيس التنفيذي المنطقة ١ المنطقة ٢	١٠٠ ٨٠		رجال الأعمال
N-1, N-2, N-3 المنطقة ١ المنطقة ٢	٨٠ ٦٠	١٦٠ ١٢٠	رجال الأعمال
N-4 و N-5 المنطقة ١ المنطقة ٢	٦٠ ٤٠	١٢٠ ٩٠	السياحية
الدرجات الأخرى المنطقة ١ المنطقة ٢	٥٠ ٤٠	٩٠ ٧٠	السياحية
البيانات الرسمية داخل عمان			
أعضاء مجلس الإدارة والرئيس التنفيذي	٣٠		رجال الأعمال
N-1, N-2, N-3	٢٥	٧٠	السياحية
N-4 و N-5	٢٠	٦٠	السياحية
الدرجات الأخرى	٢٠	٥٠	السياحية

- المنطقة ١: أمريكا الشمالية ، الدول الأوروبية ، اليابان ، سنغافورة ، كوريا ، هونج كونج.
- المنطقة ٢: جميع الدول الأخرى غير المشمولة في المنطقة ١.
- (N) تعني الرئيس التنفيذي أو ما يعادله، (N-1) تعني الوظائف التي تقدم التقارير إلى الرئيس التنفيذي (N)، (N-2) الوظائف التي تقدم التقارير إلى الوظائف (N-1) وهكذا.

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Chapter 1. Introduction

Section 1.1. Introduction to HR Policies and Procedures Manual

Introduction

The Human Resource Policies and Procedures Manual contain comprehensive information on human resource management within the Duqm Development Company (DDC) as per the Oman Labour Law formulated by the Ministry of Manpower, Sultanate of Oman (Royal Decree No. 35/2003). Guidelines and procedures contained within the HRM apply to all employees in DDC except where specifically stated in the application section.

Application

This section of the manual outlines the structure of various policies and procedures stated in this manual; guidelines on amendment and authorities for approval of changes.

Article 1.1.1. Purpose of the Manual

The purpose of this manual is to have the most up to date information on the existing people practices in the organization and serve as a guidance document for both management and staff of DDC in dealing with people related matters.

The policies outlined in this document provide a basis for ensuring that all essential human resource procedures are applied uniformly and consistently and supplement the terms and conditions specifically stated in the employment contract.

Article 1.1.2. Structure of the Manual

1) Page Layout

Each page of this manual follows a standard layout which includes a header, footer, and the main body of text.

a) The header includes the following information:

- i) DDC's logo
- ii) Title of manual
- iii) Month/ Year of Issue

b) The footer includes the following information:

- i) Author
- ii) Page Number

2) Structure of the Manual

Each chapter or section of this Manual is structured as follows:



- **Introduction**

A brief description of the chapter and the objectives attained by introducing it shall be included under Introduction header.

- **Application**

The applicability of the policy and procedure shall be included under the Application header.

- **Guidelines**

A specific guideline followed by DDC with respect to the procedure will be detailed under the Guidelines header.

- **Procedures**

Detailed description of the procedures relevant to the policy shall be included under Procedures header.

- **Cross Functional Process Maps**

A pictorial representation of the procedures to be followed shall be detailed under the Cross Functional Process Maps header.

Article 1.1.3. Master Manual and Revisions Register

The policies and procedures have been laid down to ensure optimal functioning of DDC in the present business environment. However, over a period of time; changes in the environment may make one or more sections/sub-sections in this manual irrelevant. The manual has to be updated when such changes occur. The Manual may require changes due to one or a combination of the following reason(s):

- Category I - Amendments to the Laws of Sultanate of Oman and /or
- Category II - Changes in the organization structure / objectives / policies / activities of DDC.

- 1) The Human Resource Manager (HRM) will be responsible for maintaining a 'master manual', and 'annexure' relating to the procedures outlined in this manual.
- 2) The HRM will also be responsible for the distribution of any revisions or supplements to the existing policies to the employees.
- 3) The 'master manual' along with other documents will be maintained both in the form of a soft-copy and a hard copy with the HRM.
- 4) The HRM will also maintain a register of the revised procedures and forms.
- 5) The register will be held in front of the master manual and may be referred to by users to ensure that they are using the most up to date procedures and forms.

Article 1.1.4. Maintenance of the Manual

- 1) The HRM will be the controller of this manual.
- 2) All enquiries and requests for revisions relating to matters included in this manual should be addressed to HRM.



- 3) The HRM will be responsible to ensure that the revisions to the manual are up to date, version controls are followed and older versions archived.

Article 1.1.5. Acronyms Used

Term	Definition
DDC	Duqm Development Company
BOD	Board of Directors
CEO	Chief Executive Officer
DCEO	Deputy Chief Executive Officer
CFO	Chief Financial Officer
COO	Chief Operating Officer
HRM	Human Resource & Administration Manager
PASI	Public Authority for Social Insurance

Article 1.1.6. Amendments to the Manual

- 1) The policies and procedures in this manual are subject to change as considered necessary or appropriate by DDC management. Concerned employees will be notified in writing of any changes in the policies and procedures of this manual.
- 2) It is the responsibility of the HRM to review the manual on a periodic basis, to carry out changes when an existing policy / procedure or form is revised, or a new policy / procedures are introduced and to circulate the same to all the custodians of the manual.
- 3) The sections of this manual can be amended on the request of the Heads of various divisions, followed by HR committee recommendations, DCEO and CEO review and approval of the board.
- 4) The procedures for updating the Manual for the two categories are set out below:
 - ☐ Category I – Changes in policies due to changes within the organization
 - ☐ Category II – Changes in policies due to changes in regulatory environment

Table 1 – Procedure for Manual Amendments

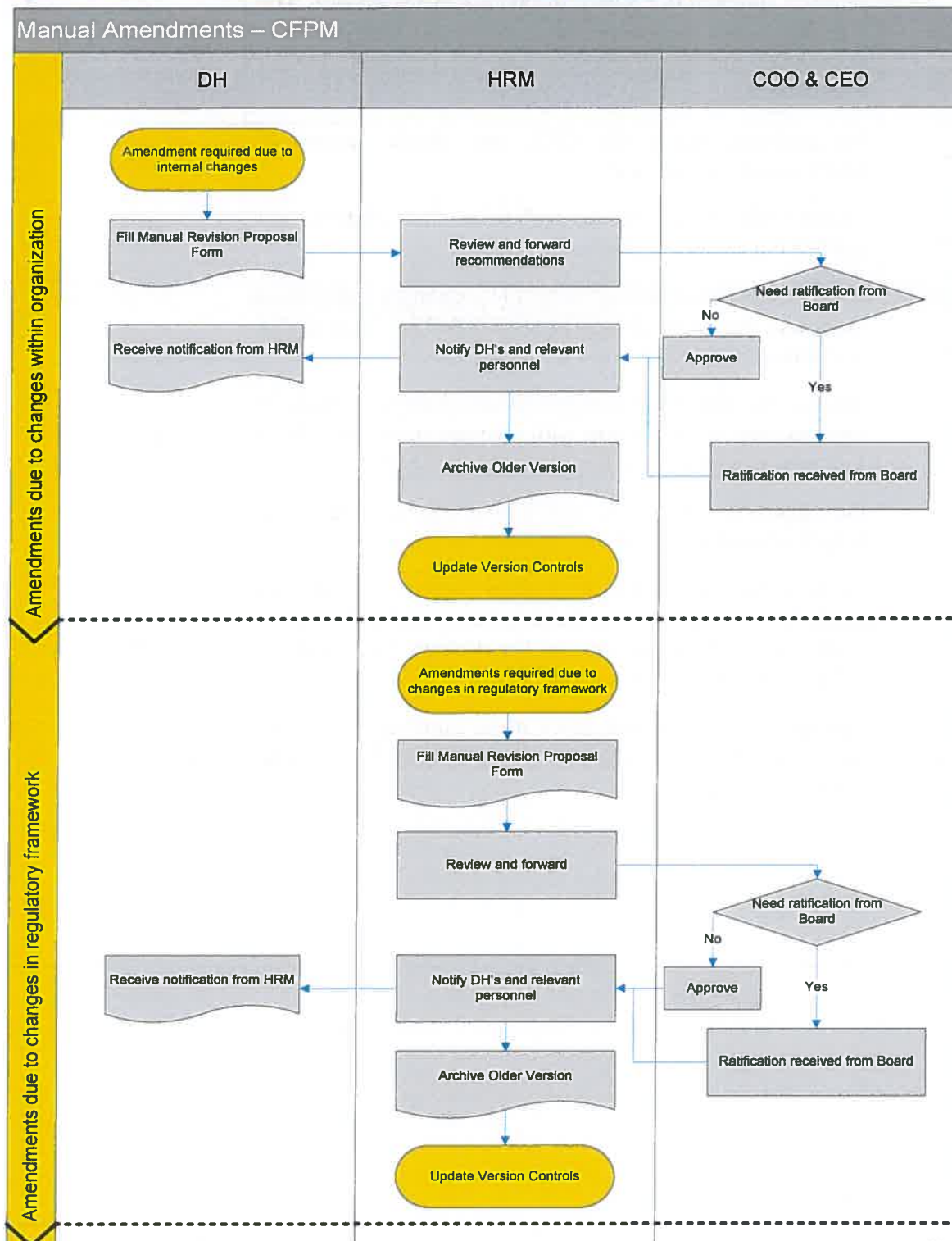
Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
☐ Category I – Changes in policies due to changes within the organization		
1	Propose a change in the policy with a justification for the change through a Form (<i>Annexure 1: Manual Revision Form</i>) to HRM	DH
2	Review the changes or amendments as requested in the Manual Revision Proposal Form	HRM
3	Forward the amendments to the DCEO & CEO with recommendations for approval	HRM



4	Approve or, if the change required is to a policy of DDC and signifies approval if it relates to changes in procedures. The DCEO & CEO shall check if the approval/ ratification is required by the Board and then take it up in the following Board Meeting.	DCEO & CEO
5	On approval, notify the DH's and relevant personnel (electronically by e-mail).	HRM
6	Archive the older version, update version controls and publish the newer version on the intranet	HRM
Category II – Changes in policies due to changes in regulatory environment		
1	Complete the Form (<i>Annexure 1: Manual Revision Form</i>) and submit it to HRM	DH
2	Receive the changes relating to the revisions of the policies / procedures in connection with changes in Oman Labour Law regulations and forward to the CEO for approval.	HRM
3	On approval, notify the DH's and relevant personnel (electronically by e-mail and with the hard-copy).	HRM
4	Archive the older version, update version controls and publish the newer version. Submit the revised policy along with the relevant section of the Labour Law will be submitted for ratification to the CEO.	HRM
5	The DCEO & CEO shall check if the approval/ ratification is required by the Board and then take it up in the following Board Meeting.	DCEO & CEO



Figure 1 – Manual Amendments Cross Functional Process Map



Article 1.1.7. Controlling Law

- 1) The controlling law for all policies at DDC is the Oman Labor Law and its Executive Regulations. In the event of any conflict that may arise between the contents of this Manual and the interpretation of the Law as given in any Ministerial or vice order, the latter shall prevail. In the event of amendments to the Law conferring more benefits than those provided in this Manual, the employee will be entitled to the more beneficial of the two, but not both.
- 2) In the day-to-day operation of DDC, cases may arise which are not covered by any of the policies and procedures outlined in this manual. Hence, such matters are to be handled on an individual basis, with a certain degree of flexibility.
- 3) In these cases and / or generally on matters of interpretation of this Manual, advice should be sought from the HRM.

Article 1.1.8. Confidentiality

- 1) This manual and its contents are the sole property of DDC, and the details contained herein should be treated with utmost confidentiality.
- 2) It is illegal to reproduce any of the manual's contents without the prior permission of the HRM.
- 3) The contents of the manual should not be shared with any person not employed with DDC.

Article 1.1.9. Distribution of the Manual

- 1) The full copy of the manual will be distributed to the Management Team for their reference and for the reference of employees working in their respective departments.
- 2) The manual will also be available for reference of all employees and the HRM is the custodian of the Manual.
- 3) Certain policies should be displayed prominently on the notice boards of the company as mandated by the Oman Labour Law
- 4) Distribution of this Manual outside DDC is strictly prohibited.



Section 1.2. Organization Structure

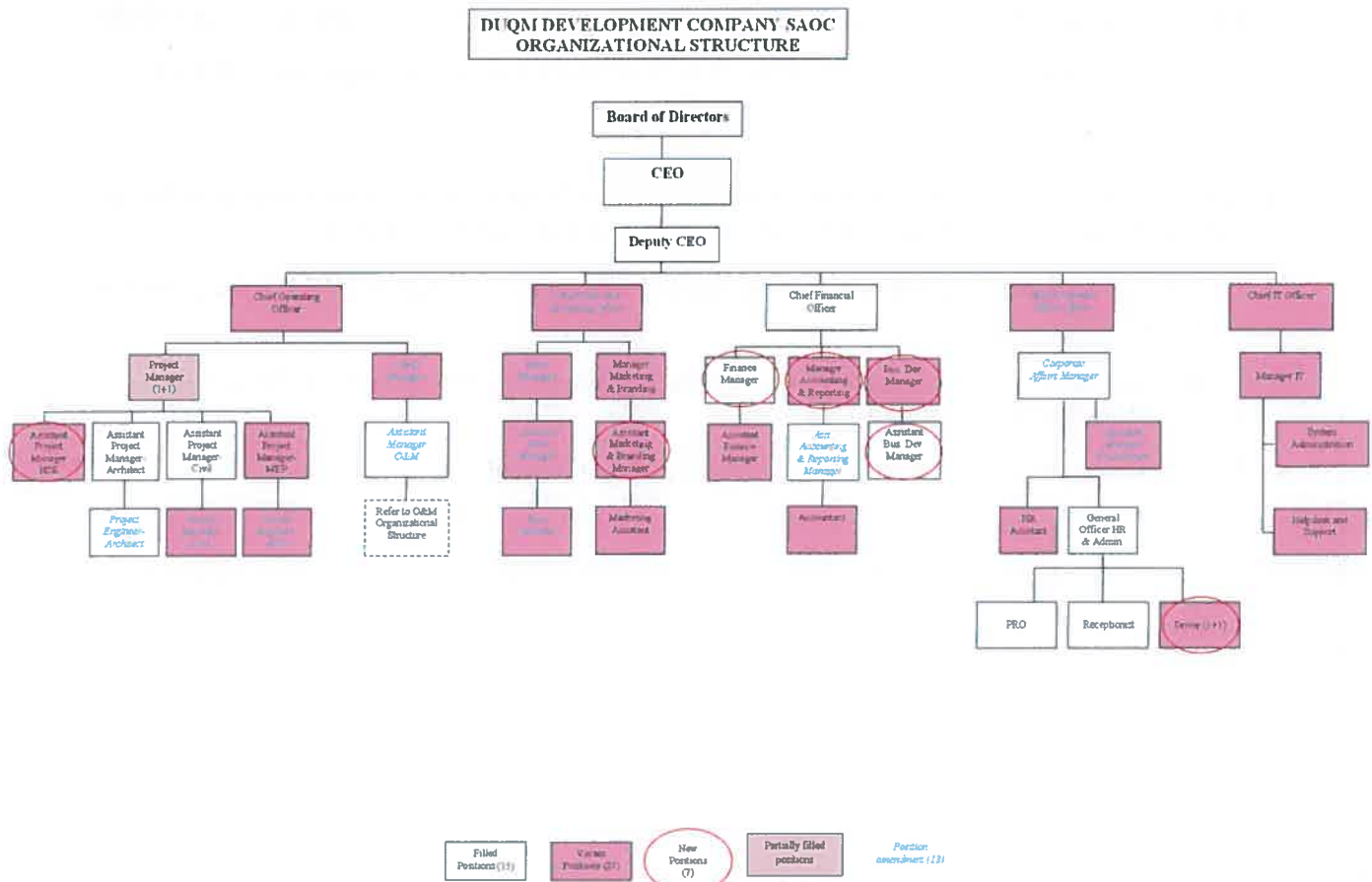
Introduction

Organization structure is a visual representation of the relationship between all departments/functions in DDC. DDC's organization structure is designed to help the organization serve its customers efficiently; manage its manpower effectively while ensuring that the business objectives are met consistently

Application

This section of the policy covers all employees of DDC. The functional and positional structures defined and illustrated in the manual represent a high level overview of the organization, the structure at the lower levels shall however be defined and approved within the provisions of this policy.

Article 1.2.1. Organization Chart



Article 1.2.2. Maintaining the Organization Structure

1) Amendments to the Organization Structure

- a) Requests for changes in the organization structure can either be received by the DH's within DDC or carried out as part of an organization wide restructuring due to change in strategy, business expansion or a business process re-engineering initiative.
- b) All requests for changes in the organization structure whether at the senior level or within the functions/departments should be reviewed by the HR Committee and recommendations should be forwarded to the DCEO and CEO for review and approvals.
- c) Any changes in the Organization structure should be approved by the board of directors.
- d) Every position mentioned on the organization structure should have a defined job description and grade level within the organization.

2) New Departments

- a) Requests for new departments should be proposed by the DH's to the HRM, the requests should be reviewed by the HR Committee and recommendations should be forwarded to the DCEO.
- b) The DCEO shall review the requests and may suggest changes or approve and forward to the CEO for sign off.
- c) The CEO will review the recommendations and then reject or recommend changes as appropriate.

Section 1.3. Human Resources Committee

Introduction

The Human Resource Committee (HRC) will assure the adequacy of Human Resources Policies, Procedures and Practices at DDC.

Application

The HRC is established to assist the DCEO and the CEO in fulfilling his oversight responsibilities through the implementation of sound HR practices.

Article 1.3.1. Incorporation of the HR Committee

The DCEO along with the CEO will appoint or remove the HRC members at any time. The HRC will consist of at least three members and the Head of HRC will be appointed by the DCEO and the CEO.

Article 1.3.2. Guidelines

- 1) The HRC will function in accordance with the Human Resources Policies and Procedures established at DDC.



- 2) Oversees implementation of standards, guidelines and policies relating to Human Resource function.
- 3) Reviews and approves goals and objectives relevant to Department Heads, evaluates the performance in light of these goals and objectives.
- 4) Determines and approves the compensation and other employment arrangements for the employees of DDC.
- 5) Makes recommendations to the DCEO and the CEO with respect annual performance appraisals, increments, benefits policies and incentive programs.
- 6) The HRC in consultation with the DCEO and the CEO, periodically review DDC's management succession planning including policies for the DCEO and the CEO succession in the event of incapacitation, retirement or removal of the DCEO or CEO, and evaluations of, and development plans for, any potential successors to the DCEO or the CEO.
- 7) Selects, retains and terminates any consulting firm in the benchmarking of compensation and benefits practices, conducting employee satisfaction surveys and developing Human Resource practices. However, the DCEO and the CEO will have the authority to approve the consulting firm's fee.
- 8) The HRC will periodically review the DDC's practices for supporting diversity at workplace and may review, as appropriate, DDC value statements and programs in support of employee morale and satisfaction.
- 9) The HRC will report to the DCEO and the CEO periodically. The report shall include a review of any recommendations or issues that arise with respect to DDC HR policies, procedures and any other matters that deems appropriate or is requested to be included by the DCEO and the CEO.

Article 1.3.3. Secretary, Voting Rights, Meetings and proceedings of the committee

- 1) The HRC will comprise of members from the DDC senior management team, ideally the DCEO, CFO, COO and the HRM.
- 2) The secretary of the HRC shall be appointed by the DCEO and the CEO.
- 3) The HRC shall meet as often as it determines is appropriate to carry out its responsibilities.
- 4) The secretary of the HRC, in consultation with the other committee members, shall determine the frequency and length of the Committee meetings and shall set meeting agendas consistent with this policy.
- 5) No senior management team member should attend that portion of the meeting where such team member's performance or compensation is discussed, unless specifically invited by the HRC.
- 6) The HRM shall note the minutes of the meetings and circulate it to all HRC members, the DCEO and the CEO.



Chapter 2. Hiring

Section 2.1. Manpower Planning

Introduction

Manpower plans are based on forecasts of human resources needed to meet operational objectives.

Manpower planning is most effective when it is linked with strategic, operational and work planning.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all types of human resource/ manpower requirements pertaining to all departments of DDC. These guidelines must be followed for budgeting manpower requirements at the beginning of the year and for dealing with non budgeted positions during the year. Manpower includes all manpower whether outsourced, in sourced or employee head count.

Article 2.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) DH's are responsible for preparing forecasts of manpower requirements for their department. The HRM and the CFO will provide technical help, as required.
- 2) Manpower forecasts are based on the working requirements of the departments as defined in the departmental business plan.
- 3) The preparation of the annual manpower plan and its approximations should begin at least 3 months prior to the forthcoming financial budget year. Manpower forecasts and plan must be proposed as part of the annual departmental budget.
- 4) Each DH will identify new positions to be introduced, or new skills/competencies required within the department, workforce requirements (along with their titles) based on department's business plan, the method of employment whether it is short term employment (project based) or long term employment, the assessment of the current workforce; and how the current workforce may evolve in the future.
- 5) The DH prepares a preliminary forecast of manpower requirements for the department based on the following:
 - a) Estimated manpower requirements to support the department's business plan, objectives – what human resources are needed (Demand) :
 - i) Planned working requirements
 - ii) Planned organizational changes, including workforce adjustment
 - iii) Authorized positions
 - iv) Overtime spent
 - v) Retirement, promotions
 - vi) Omanization



vii) Temporary Positions/ Causal Vacancies

b) Estimated future manpower supply – what human resources are available (Supply) :

- i) Authorized positions
- ii) Expected attrition
- iii) Mobility
- iv) Training and Development
- v) External workforce supply
- vi) Succession plans

c) Estimated net manpower requirements

- i) The difference between the human resources needed (a) and the human resources available (b)

- 6) The preliminary forecasts shows the positions each department need in the future and assess the extent to which current employees can fill those positions and plan the required manpower accordingly.
- 7) The DH must prepare the manpower forecasts on the standard formats and be based on annual budget guidelines and directions issued by the CFO.
- 8) The HRM is responsible for consolidating the overall manpower plan from the inputs provided by various DH's. This would include a cost assessment of the entire manpower plan, including the cost of salary and benefits, overhead costs, recruitment costs(sourcing costs, travel, advertising etc.) , incidental costs such as visa processing, relocation costs etc. These costs must be factored in to each department budget under the manpower costs heading and then into the overall budget of DDC.
- 9) The HRM will provide ongoing monitoring and evaluation of the manpower plan framework and implementation. The HRM will also provide advice and support throughout the cycle.
- 10) The HRM along with the CFO must review the overall manpower plan and recommend the consolidated plan to the DCEO and the CEO for approval.
- 11) The DCEO and the CEO must review, obtain approval/ ratification from the BOD, recommend changes or approve the manpower plan.
- 12) Amendments to the approved plan will be based on the changes to requirements requested by the DH's, however this must be only for exceptional circumstances and must be accompanied with substantiate justification.
- 13) All amendments to the manpower plan must be reviewed by the HRM and CFO and approved by the DCEO and signed off by the CEO.



Table 2 – Procedure for Manpower Planning

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
Manpower Planning		
1	The HRM will initiate the manpower planning process 3 months prior to the forthcoming financial budget year by contacting DHs via email and forwarding relevant formats and requesting them to submit yearly manpower forecasts	HRM
2	Estimate net manpower requirements considering the demand and supply of manpower and take assistance/support from HRM and CFO where required	DH
3	Forward the manpower forecasts based on the annual budgeting and directions issued by the CFO and in appropriate formats as suggested, 3 months prior to the forthcoming financial budget year	DH
4	Analyze the departmental forecasts and discuss with the respective DH prior to consolidation	HRM & CFO
5	Consolidate the overall manpower forecasts and forward the plan to the CFO	HRM
6	Based on the consolidated manpower plan, prepare cost estimation and analysis of the financial impact of employee overheads.	CFO
Manpower Plan Review and Discussions		
7	Schedule a meeting with the respective DH, CFO and MP to review and discuss all cost estimations and to discuss considerations taken into account for formulating the manpower plan	HRM
8	Finalize the manpower plan based on the review.	HRM & CFO
10	Analyze the budget utilization for the current period and clarify the related issues with the DCEO and the CEO	CFO
11	Prepare reports suggesting the overall financial impact of the changes in the manpower plan to the current year's employee overheads	CFO
12	In consultation with the DCEO and the CEO rationalize budgetary projections for the forthcoming year in comparison to the current year and recommend changes.	CFO

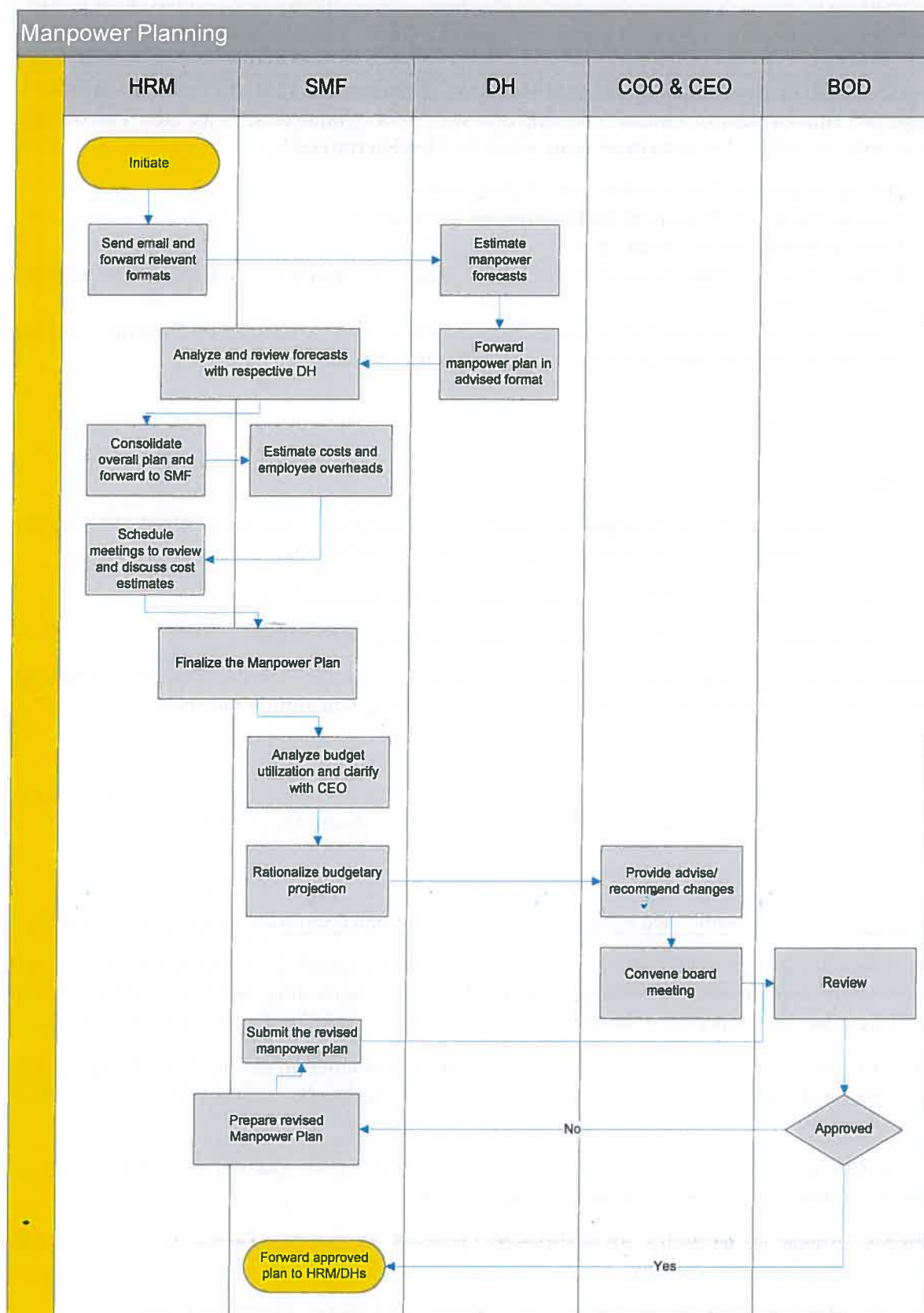
Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
Manpower Plan Approval		
13	Convene the board meeting prior to the end of current year and present the manpower plan along with the finance	DCEO & CEO



	budget for the forthcoming year	
14	Review the manpower plan in line with business plans and strategy, approve or suggest changes as appropriate.	BOD
15	In the event that the manpower plan is not approved by the board, in consultation with the DCEO, the CEO, CFO and the DH's prepare revised manpower plan considering the suggestions of the Board.	HRM & CFO
16	Revise manpower plan as approved by the Board	CFO
17	Review and approve the manpower plan	BOD
16	Communicate the approved manpower plan and budget to the DH's and HRM	CFO



Figure 2 –Manpower Planning Cross Functional Process Map



Article 2.1.2. Omanization

- 1) Employment of Omani nationals in current positions held by expatriates will be planned in a phased manner. As part of the Manpower Planning process, the HRM in co-ordination with the respective DH be responsible for implementation of Omanization. This will form part of DDC's target for employment of Omani nationals and will be communicated to all DH. The overall expatriate vs. national employment ratio target will be determined by:
 - a) Directives provided by the Ministry of Manpower
 - b) Current Omani staff strength by Department & Category
 - c) Current skill levels of Omani staff
 - d) Estimated time frame to recruit and train Omanis to move into job positions held by expatriate staff.
 - e) Identification of existing job positions in each Department, which can be Omanized during the year through recruitment and training of quality nationals.

Section 2.2. Eligibility Lists

Introduction

Eligibility list is an inventory of applicants who have applied on a vacant position and may be qualified to fill future similar vacancies. An eligibility list can be either:

- Prequalified applicants who have been tested and interviewed; or
- A candidate database with resumes and information of applicants.

Eligibility lists are a cost-effective and efficient method of staffing similar positions. Once an eligibility list is established, the list may be used to fill subsequent similar vacancies.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all hiring requirements pertaining to all departments of DDC. These guidelines must be followed while hiring an employee for a vacant position.

Article 2.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) Eligibility lists are established by the Department of Human Resources to fill similar vacancies.
- 2) An eligibility list is established after the hiring process is completed for a vacant position and there is an appointment of an applicant to DDC. The remaining applicants with required qualifications and experience are determined to be on an eligibility list for similar positions.
- 3) When a job application process is open and no one is appointed to the position, the applicants with required qualifications and experience are determined to be on eligibility list for similar positions.
- 4) Qualified employees available through staff retention policy or internal qualified employees must be considered before applicants on eligibility lists.
- 5) Eligibility lists are normally established for a term of six months. Factors to consider when using an eligibility list include:
 - a) The likelihood that the remaining applicants are qualified and interested; and



- b) The possibility that qualified and interested applicants did not apply on the original job position advertised and are not included in the eligibility list.
- 6) The eligibility list may be established for more or less time as appropriate to the vacant positions and extended if necessary.

Section 2.3. Selection Committees

Introduction

Each hiring requires a Selection Committee that will apply the relevant policies and guidelines to determine the most suitable candidate.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all hiring requirements pertaining to all departments of DDC. These guidelines must be followed while hiring an employee for a vacant position.

Article 2.3.1. Guidelines

- 1) The Selection Committee shall include at least the Human Resources Representative and Supervisor of the position being filled.
- 2) Depending on the level of the position, the recommended maximum size of the Selection Committee is three people as approved by the DCEO and the CEO.
- 3) Members of the Selection Committee are expected to participate in all aspects of the screening, interview and assignment components of the hiring process in order to maintain consistency.
- 4) The Selection Committee shall include, but is not necessarily restricted to, a Human Resources Representative and the Supervisor of the position being filled. Where appropriate, a member with technical expertise may be added to the Selection Committee, either as a full participant or in an advisory capacity with no vote in the final hiring decision.
- 5) Where a Committee member must remove himself/herself from the hiring process and it is necessary to replace that member, a substitute may be used for interviews as long as he/she has relevant expertise for hiring for the position.
- 6) The Selection Committee will:
 - a) Develop/ approve the screening criteria;
 - b) Approve the advertisement;
 - c) Develop/ approve interview questions, assignments and anticipated responses;
 - d) Review all applications to determine whether they meet the screening criteria;
 - e) Interview, rate and rank the candidates;
 - f) Assess information obtained in the references or criminal records or medical checks; and
- 7) All Selection Committee members should become familiar with the DDC hiring process, guidelines and procedures.
- 8) Selection Committee members should excuse themselves from participating as part of the



Selection Committee if they are not able to participate for the duration of the hiring process.

- 9) Selection Committee members who find themselves in a potential conflict of interest situation due to a relationship with the candidate, are required to discuss this with the other Selection Committee members and, if necessary, withdraw from the hiring process.

Section 2.4. Preparing Screening Criteria

Introduction

Screening criteria will be established to determine which candidates qualify for further consideration. They consist of a combination of prerequisite experience and education.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all hiring requirements pertaining to all departments of DDC. These guidelines must be followed while hiring an employee for a vacant position.

Article 2.4.1. Guidelines

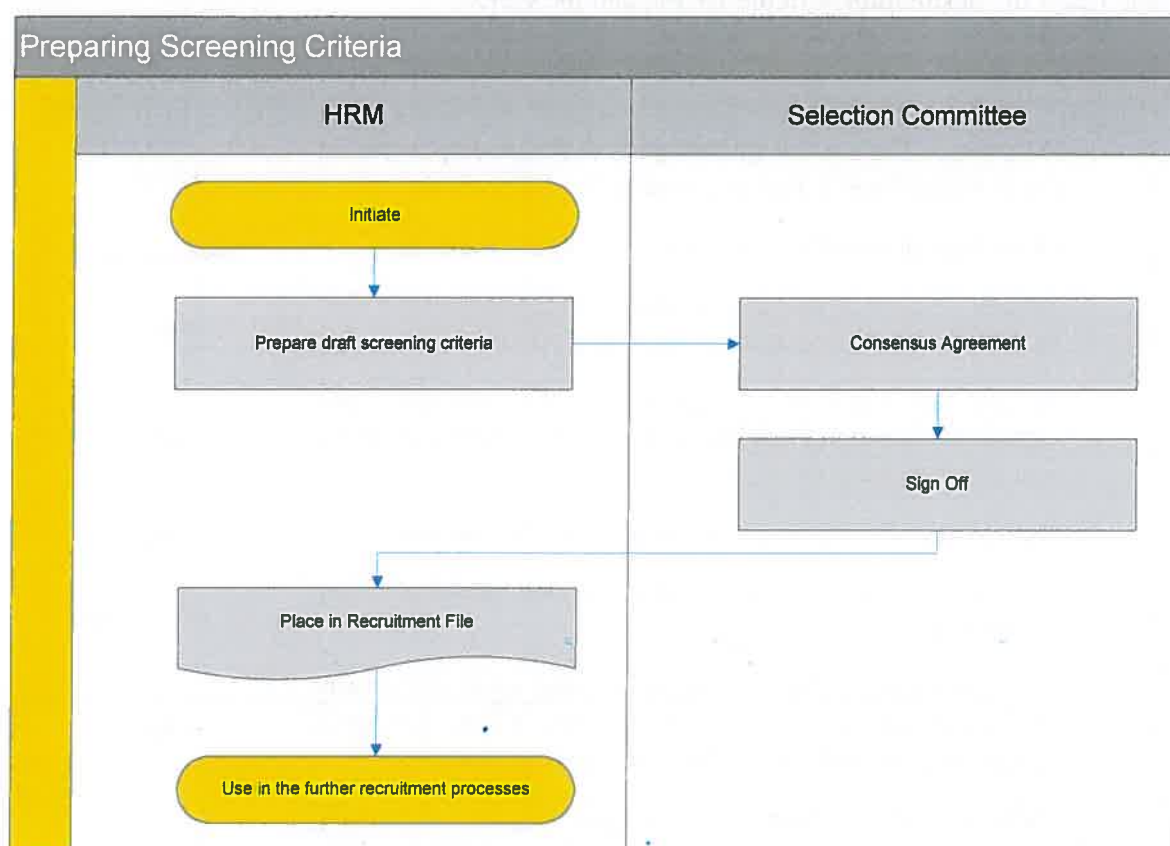
- 1) The job description is used as a guide to create the "screening criteria" which establishes various combinations of education and experience required to do the job.
- 2) The Selection Committee shall identify at least two combinations of education and experience they consider equivalent to the education and experience listed in the job description for the position.
- 3) To assist in the identification of equivalencies, the DDC practice is to consider one year of directly related experience equivalent to one year of education and vice versa. However, this is only a guideline. Experience and education combinations must often be considered on a case by case basis.
- 4) As it is not possible to identify all equivalencies, the sentence "Other combinations of education and experience will be considered on a case by case basis" must be included on the screening criteria sheet.
- 5) Statutory requirements for position qualifications must be included in the screening criteria. Some examples of statutory requirements are:
 - a) For a position which requires the employee to drive, applicants must have a driver's license or be able to obtain a driver's license within a reasonable time;
- 6) Screening criteria shall not result in the establishment of systemic employment barriers. For example, rather than requiring experience with the DDC Financial Information System, the screening criteria should address a more general requirement such as experience in a computerized accounting environment.
- 7) Where possible, the screening criteria shall be completed prior to the preparation of the advertisement.
- 8) The screening criteria shall be completed prior to reviewing applications for the position.

Table 3 – Procedure for Preparing Screening Criteria



Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	Prepare a draft of screening criteria based on the actual knowledge, skills, abilities, experience and education specified in the job descriptions	HRM
2	The screening criteria is dated and signed off by all members of the Selection Committee to indicate consensus agreement of the Selection Committee.	Selection Committee
3	The original copy of the screening criteria, dated and signed by all Selection Committee members, is placed on the recruitment file.	HRM

Figure 3 – Preparing Screening Criteria Cross Functional Process Map



Section 2.5. Preparing the Advertisement

Introduction

A job advertisement provides relevant information to qualified individuals to encourage them to apply on a position. Preparation is required to develop an effective advertisement.

Advertising is done in the most effective way to maximize the advertising audience within available advertising expenditures.



Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all hiring related advertising. These guidelines must be followed while placing advertisements or selecting advertising agencies for a vacant position.

Article 2.5.1. Guidelines

- 1) Under no circumstances should a job vacancy be advertised unless the DCEO has reviewed and the CEO has approved a valid job description as per the organization chart and the advertising costs are as per the budget.
- 2) Positions should be evaluated prior to advertising whenever possible. Advertising without an evaluation will negatively impact quality and/or quantity of the applicants. Therefore, only under extenuating circumstances may a position be advertised while awaiting job evaluation.
- 3) An appropriate format and size of the ad should be used; all advertisements should be reviewed by the HRM in consultation with the DCEO and the CEO.

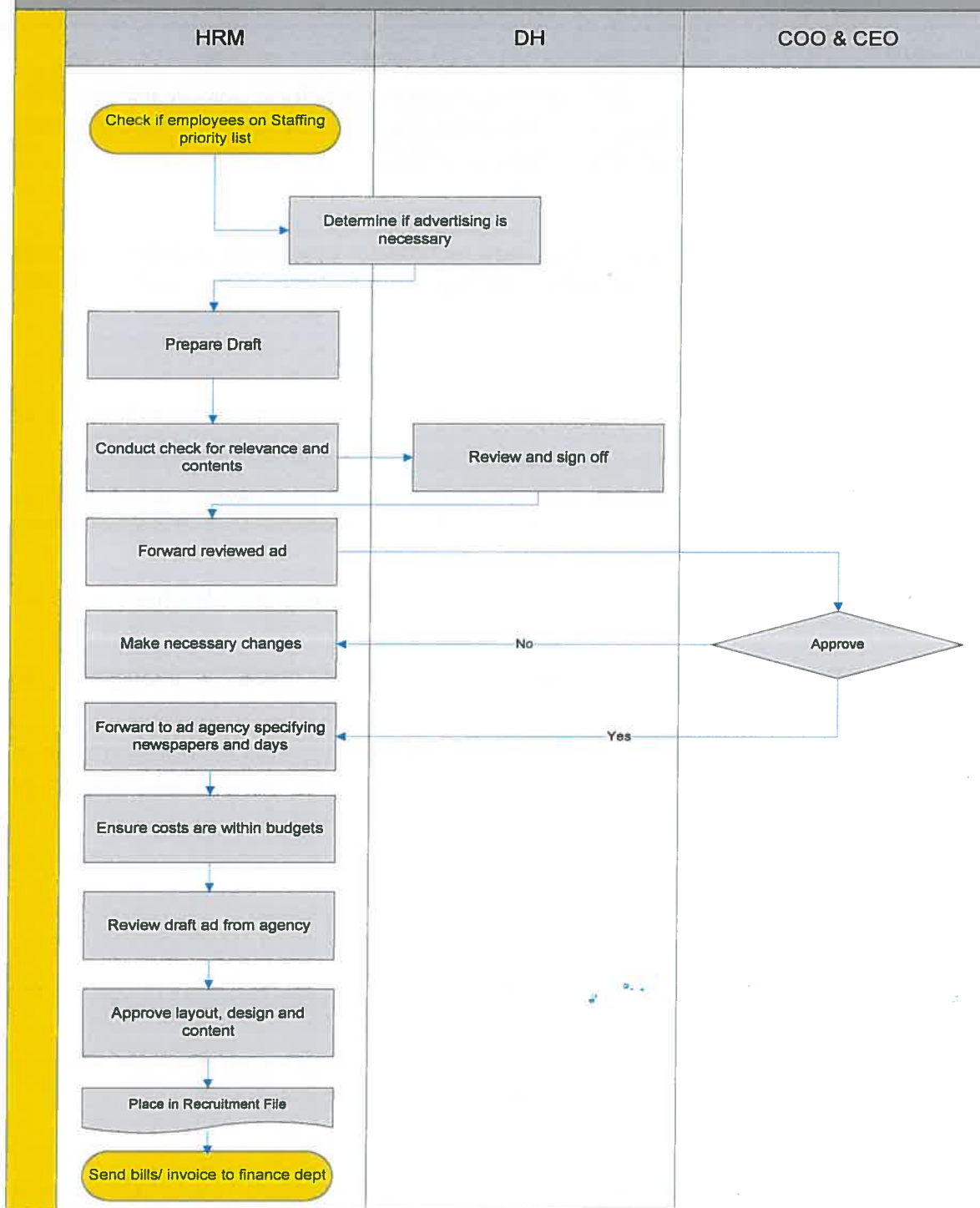
Table 4 – Procedure for Preparing the Advertisement

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	Prior to advertising, confirm whether there are employees on the Staffing Priority List to consider for the position	HRM
2	Determine if advertising a vacant position is necessary	HRM & DH
3	Prepare an appropriate draft using the information specified in the job description and the screening criteria	HRM
4	Ensure that there is consistency in the education and experience listed in the job description, the screening criteria and the draft advertisement	HRM
5	Review the advertisement and sign off on the contents	DH
6	Approve the advertisement prior to the position being advertised.	DCEO & CEO
7	Forward a copy of the ad to the advertising agent and specify the newspapers in which the advertisements have to appear and ensure the costs are within the approved budgets	HRM
8	Review draft of advertisement prepared by the advertising agent, review and approve the design layout and content or recommend changes as appropriate	HRM
9	Place a copy of the Advertisement in the recruitment file and forward relevant bills and copy of the advertisement to the Finance Department	HRM

Figure 4 –Preparing Advertisements Cross Functional Process Map



Preparing Advertisements



Section 2.6. Using External Recruitment Consultants

Introduction

External recruitment consultants are widely known recruitment agencies or consultants who offer employers a range of services attracting candidates, managing candidate responses, screening and short listing or run assessment centers on the employer's behalf.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all external recruitment consultants related activities of DDC. These guidelines must be followed while selecting or using external recruitment consultants for a vacant position.

Article 2.6.1. Guidelines

- 1) DDC may use external recruitment consultants to assist with the recruitment of the potential candidates.
- 2) The HRM must examine the market carefully before selecting an agency or consultancy. Different services are provided by different agencies. It is important that DDC selects an agency which reflects its aims and objectives and has experience of its labor market.
- 3) To be clear about what is required from an agency, the HRM should provide a brief in writing and ensure it is fully understood and that all information given is current and accurate.
- 4) Accurate, detailed and up-to-date job descriptions and/or a person specification/job profile has to be given to the recruitment agencies.
- 5) An agreement has to be established with the recruitment agency stating the responsibilities of the agency and DDC (for example, who will be responsible for checking qualifications or handling references etc).
- 6) The fee structure for the recruitment agency's service must be reviewed by the HRM and approved by the DCEO and signed off by the CEO.

Section 2.7. Acknowledging Applications

Introduction

The HR Department will acknowledge applications received for a vacant position. This will maintain goodwill and may reduce the number of calls from the applicants.

Application

These principles and guidelines should be applied for all the applications received during the course of recruitment.

Article 2.7.1. Guidelines

- 1) Applicants will be contacted within 24 hours of receipt of their application with an email thanking them for their interest in working with DDC and advising them that they may be contacted if their application is shortlisted.



- 2) In the event that an application is rejected during the screening process, an email will be sent to the applicant stating that the applicants profile doesn't match the current vacant position and they may be contacted if any suitable vacancy arises that matches their profile.

Section 2.8. Interview Questions & Assignments

Introduction

Prior to reviewing resumes, the selection committee establishes interview questions and assignments that are used to measure applicant's ability to do the job.

Application

These guidelines detail the steps to be taken by the selection committee prior to screening of applicants. These guidelines and principles should be followed for all recruitments.

Article 2.8.1. Guidelines

- 1) In addition to oral questions, the Selection Committee may rely on an assignment or test to help determine an applicant's ability to do the job.
- 2) Questions, assignments and tests shall relate to those duties, responsibilities, knowledge and skills specified in the approved job description.
- 3) Questions, assignments and tests shall be established in a manner that will effectively assess the technical, personal and behavioral suitability of a candidate (*Annexure 2: Question and Assignment examples*).
- 4) Questions, assignments and tests shall be developed, where possible, prior to the screening of applications.
- 5) Questions, assignments and tests shall not introduce systemic employment barriers.
- 6) Questions shall be weighted relative to their relevance to the position.
- 7) The Selection Committee shall determine the desired weighting for an assignment prior to the interviews.
- 8) All questions, assignments and tests used to evaluate interview results shall include suggested responses that are approved by the Selection Committee.

Section 2.9. Screening Applications

Introduction

Once the sourcing of applications is complete and the questions and assignments are prepared, the Selection Committee reviews each application to determine who meets the requirements listed in the screening criteria and who will be selected for an interview.

Application

These policies and guidelines outline the screening procedure. These guidelines are applicable for all recruitments.



Article 2.9.1. Guidelines

- 1) Members of the Selection Committee shall reach unanimous consent on the outcome of the screening process.
- 2) The HRM shall remind all Selection Committee members that applicant information and the recruitment process are confidential and that all applications are to be considered fairly and in accordance with the Oman Labor Law.
- 3) The Selection Committee may use an assignment to assist in narrowing the field of applicants screened in to be interviewed. If this is done, a decision must be made regarding the relative value of the assignment results in the final assessment of the candidate.
- 4) Under no circumstances shall Selection Committee members contact the current employer or other references of a candidate during the screening process (*see, Conducting Reference Checks*).
- 5) Indeterminate employees who are on the Staffing Priority List shall have staffing priority status. Such employees shall have priority for staffing over all other potential candidates for all vacancies in DDC.
- 6) If applications are received from individuals on the Staffing Priority List who are qualified for the position or can become qualified through one year or less of training, they must be interviewed prior to all other applicants. A current Staffing Priority List can be obtained from the Human Resources Department.
- 7) Generally, three to five interviewees are sufficient for most recruitment. However, if a smaller group of priority candidates have been screened in, it is common to limit the number of interviewees to those candidates

Table 5 – Procedure for Screening Applications

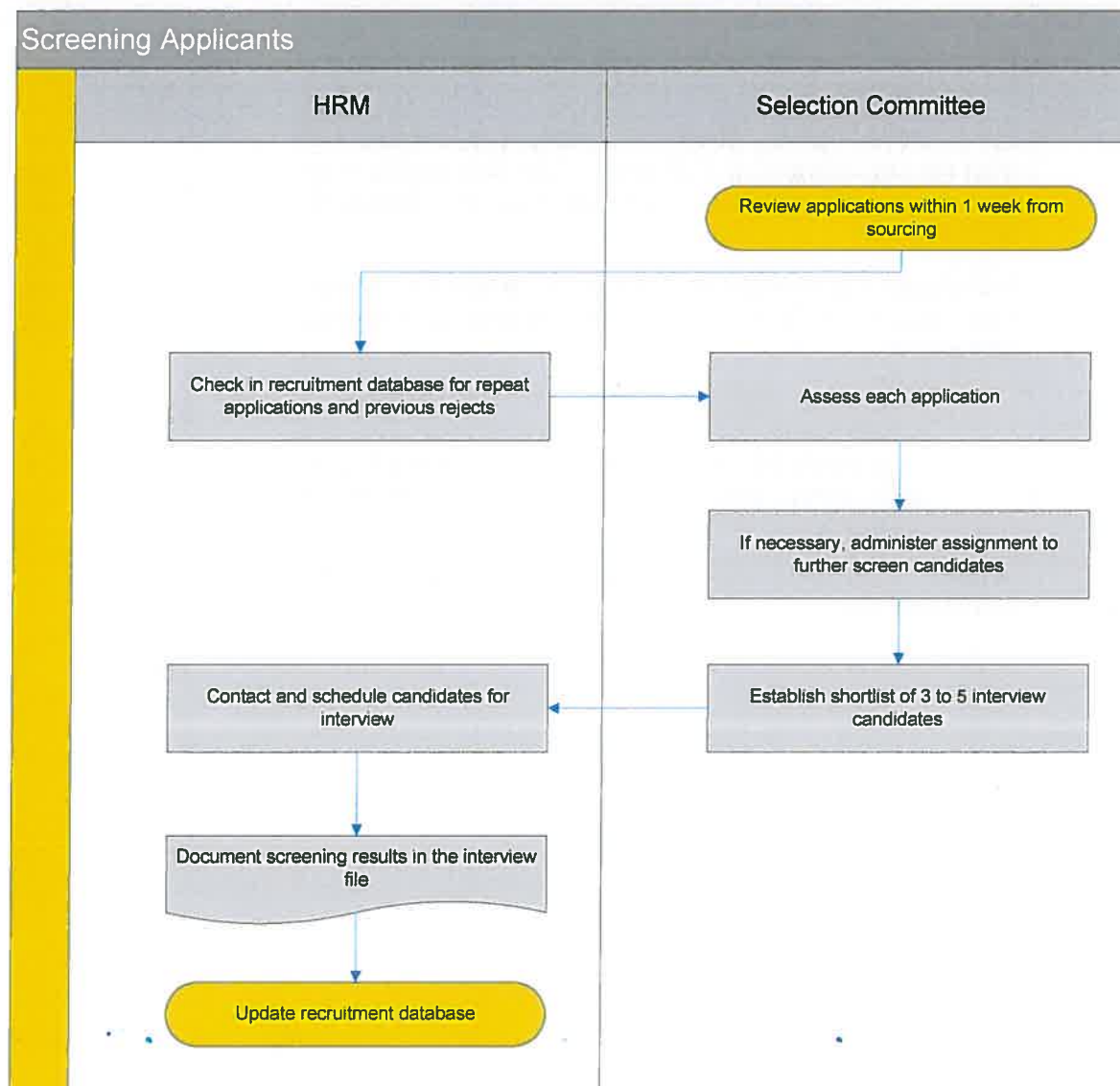
Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	Within 1 week of sourcing of applications, the members of the Selection Committee review all the applications received	Selection Committee
2	The HRM checks the recruitment database to see if an application has been dismissed or rejected earlier, such candidates are automatically screened out of recruitment process and are advised in writing (<i>Annexure 3: Sample letter to dismissed or rejected candidates</i>).	HRM
3	The Selection Committee assesses each application received to determine if the requirements or equivalencies in the screening criteria are satisfied.	Selection Committee
4	The Selection Committee may administer a brief assignment to help further assess candidates who meet the screening criteria.	Selection Committee
5	The Selection Committee establishes a short list, generally three or five applicants, to be selected for an interview. If the number of candidates is large, the Committee can use one of the following to help determine which candidates to interview first: a. Administer a pre-interview test to the top candidates. Only top	Selection Committee



	scorers are considered for an interview; and b. Identify those candidates possessing qualifications that make the likelihood of success in the job greater (i.e., more education, experience, etc.).	
6	The HRM records the Selection Committee's assessments and other relevant information. This may be done by including notes on each resume or by using a formal screening list (<i>Annexure 4: Screening List</i>).	HRM
7	Individuals to be interviewed are generally contacted at least 24-hours prior to the interview and provided with the following information: Job position, date – time – location & length of interview, any documentation they are required to bring, names of members on Selection Committee, contact person's name and telephone number, assignment or test information if applicable.	HRM
8	Written records of screening results shall be placed on the recruitment file.	HRM
9	Update the recruitment database accordingly	HRM



Figure 5 –Screening Applications Cross Functional Process Map



Section 2.10. Determining Suitability

Introduction

Once the Selection Committee determines which candidates will receive further consideration, a formal interview, assignment and/or test is administered to determine the suitability of a candidate.

Application

The Selection Committee must apply these guidelines while short-listing or considering a job applicant for interview or selection process.

Article 2.10.1. Guidelines

- 1) The HRM shall act as chairperson and will facilitate the interview and/or administer the assignment or test ensuring compliance with all relevant policies, procedures and legislation.
- 2) Interviews shall consist of a pre-established set of questions that will be administered in the same manner for all candidates.
- 3) Interviews may be conducted face to face, over the telephone or as a videoconference.
- 4) Assignments and tests shall be designed to help the Selection Committee determine a candidate's suitability relative to the skills and knowledge needed to perform in the job.
- 5) The HRM shall give candidates clear and concise instructions on how to complete the assignment or test.
- 6) Where possible, candidates shall be provided the same environment and amount of time in which to complete an assignment or test.
- 7) Assignments or tests may be given before, during, or following an oral interview and may be completed by distance

Table 6 – Procedure for Determining Suitability

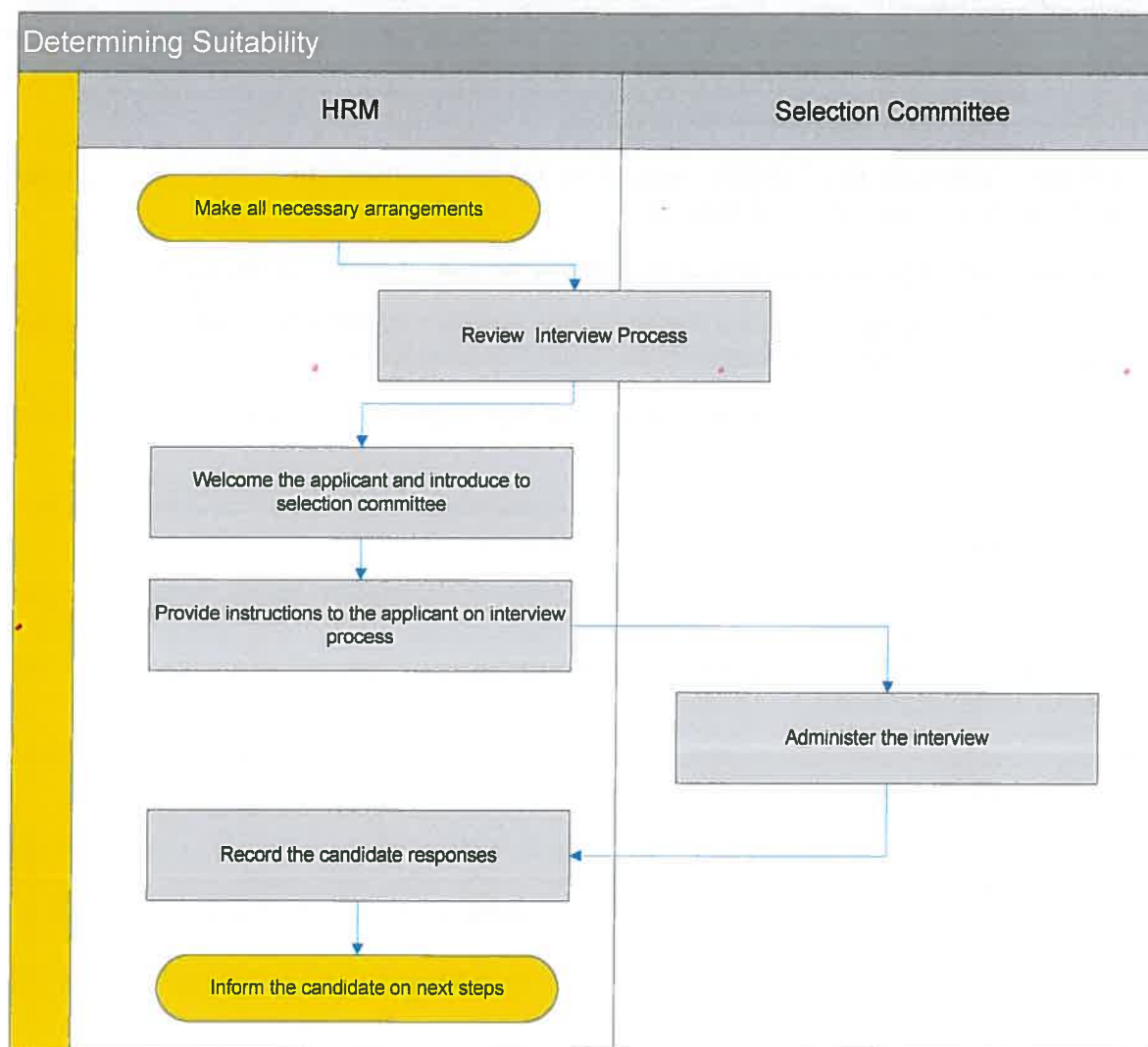
Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	The Human Resources Representative prepares the interview room and makes available any necessary documents for the candidate and members of the Selection Committee.	HRM
2	The Human Resources Representative reviews the interview process with the Selection Committee prior to the start of the interview and reminds members to: a. Ask candidates the approved set of predetermined questions; b. Write down candidate responses to each question; c. Avoid rating candidate responses until the end of the interview	HRM
3	The Selection Committee predetermines who will ask each question and when to administer the assignment if one is used.	Selection Committee
4	The HRM establishes rapport with the candidate by greeting them	HRM



	and introducing him/her to Selection Committee members.	
5	Prior to starting the interview, the Human Resources Representative informs the candidate that: a. <i>Members of the Selection Committee will ask a set of predetermined questions;</i> b. <i>They can ask for clarification on any of the questions;</i> c. <i>They can return to any question to add or clarify additional information;</i> d. <i>Selection Committee members will be recording their responses for evaluation purposes;</i> e. <i>There will be time at the end of the interview for questions from the candidate; and</i> f. <i>The candidate will be given a specific amount of time to complete a written assignment or test (if applicable).</i>	HRM
6	Selection Committee members ask the candidate predetermined questions providing sufficient time for each response.	Selection Committee
7	Selection Committee members may probe for additional information or may be required to rephrase a question if the candidate does not provide sufficient detail or misunderstands the question. Questions may be re-worded as long as the intended meaning remains the same.	Selection Committee
8	The HRM ends the interview by: a. <i>Giving the candidate an opportunity to ask questions about the job, work environment, etc.;</i> b. <i>Asking the candidate to provide three supervisory references, one of which shall be the candidate's most recent immediate supervisor;</i> c. <i>Requesting any required educational transcripts, memberships, professional registrations, medical clearances, driver's licenses, etc. (see Conducting Additional Pre-Employment Checks);</i> d. <i>Providing an indication of how long it will take to convey the outcome of the interview; and</i> e. <i>Thanking the candidate for coming to the interview.</i>	HRM
9	All records of candidate responses and completed assignments or tests are placed on the recruitment file.	HRM



Figure 6 –Determining Suitability Cross Functional Process Map



Section 2.11. Evaluating Interviews, Assignments and Tests

Introduction

Selection Committee members evaluate the oral responses, assignment and/or test for each candidate to determine who will receive further consideration.

Application

The Selection Committee members should apply these guidelines while determining a suitable job applicant for a vacant position.

Article 2.11.1. Guidelines

- 1) The HRM, as chairperson, shall facilitate the evaluation of the interview results.
- 2) Interview results shall be evaluated based on the suggested responses approved by the Selection Committee.

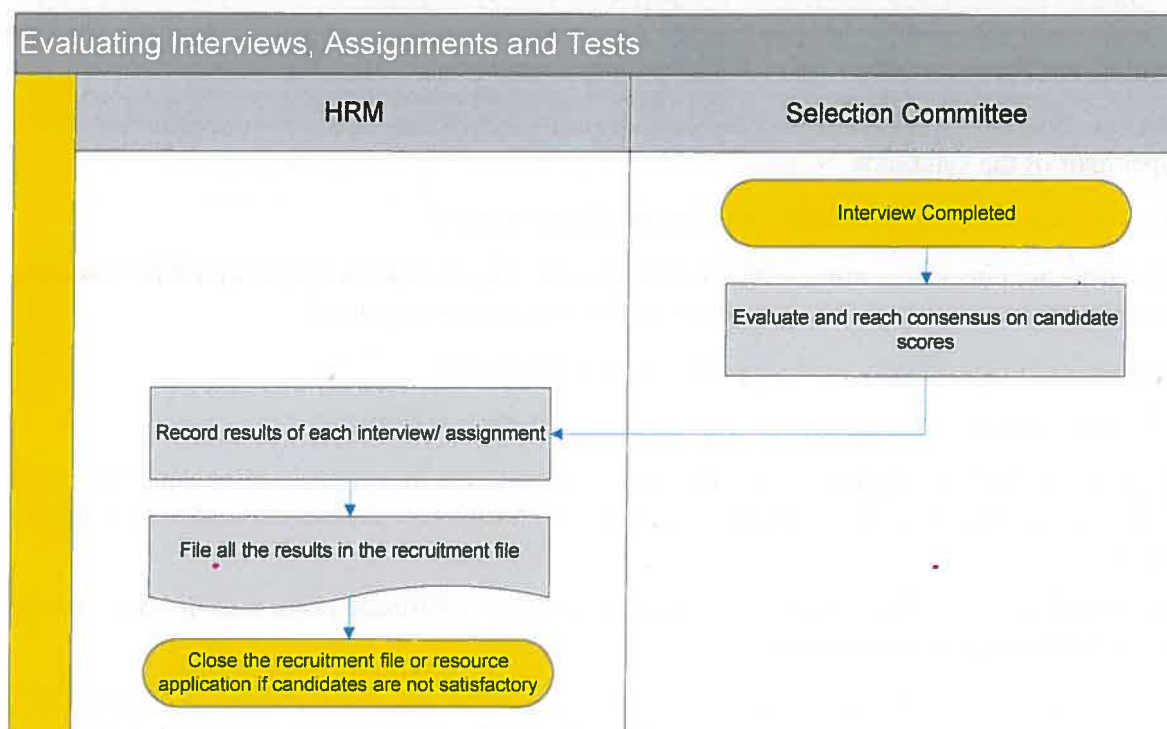


- 3) Written assignments are evaluated based on a predetermined answer key approved by the Selection Committee.
- 4) Oral interview questions are rated on the following scale:
 - a) 0 Points: The candidate provides no response.
 - b) 1 Point: Although the candidate attempts to answer the question, he/she has very little understanding of the subject matter.
 - c) 2 Points: The candidate provides an answer that satisfies only part of the question.
 - d) 3 Points: The candidate provides an answer that closely resembles the suggested response approved by the Selection Committee and would be acceptable to do the job.
 - e) 4 Points: The candidate provides an answer that expands on the suggested response approved by the Selection Committee.
 - f) 5 Points: The candidate provides an impressive response that greatly exceeds the suggested response approved by the Selection Committee.
- 5) When a candidate gives a response to a question that suggests illegal behavior, gross misconduct, or a lack of adherence to a professional code of conduct and ethics or accepted practice, the Selection Committee may deem the candidate to be unsuitable, regardless of the total score of the interview.
- 6) Selection Committee members shall reach consensus on the score of the interview questions and/or assignment.
- 7) The pass mark shall be 60% and is generally comprised of a total score from the oral questions, written assignment and/or test. A total score of 60% represents an average score of three for each question and means that the candidate has the ability to do the job at an acceptable level.
- 8) In the event of a tie, the Selection Committee may administer additional oral questions and/or an assignment.

Table 7– Procedure for Evaluating Interviews, Assignments and Tests

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	After administering the interview, assignment and/or test, the Selection Committee meets to evaluate and reach consensus on the candidate's score(s).	Selection Committee
2	The HRM records the results of each interview, assignment and/or test on the appropriate testing document(s).	HRM
3	All documents showing the results of the interview, assignment and/or test are placed on the recruitment file.	HRM
4	If the recruitment effort fails to produce a successful candidate, the HRM and Supervisor may consider re advertising or sourcing new applications for the open position.	HRM



Figure 7–Evaluating Interviews, Assignments and Tests Cross Functional Process Map

Section 2.12. Conducting Reference Checks

Introduction

Once the Selection Committee chooses a likely appointee through the interview process, references are checked to validate, clarify or add to information that has already been gathered.

Application

The HRM should apply these guidelines upon selection of a suitable job applicant for a vacant position.

Article 2.12.1. Guidelines

- 1) The HRM or supervisor shall conduct the reference checks. Additional members of the Selection Committee may also participate particularly if some of the information is very technical in nature. The hiring supervisor makes the final decision as to who is best to conduct reference checks.
- 2) All candidates receiving an interview shall provide permission to the HRM to contact supervisory references, one of which shall be the candidate's most recent direct supervisor. The Human Resources Representative may use a form (*Annexure 5: Reference Check Authorization Form*) to obtain written authorization to contact each reference.
- 3) Candidates who do not grant permission to contact their most recent direct supervisor(s) are deemed to have withdrawn from the recruitment.
- 4) Other reference types, such as clients, may be considered if a former direct supervisor has not had contact with the candidate in many years and is not able to verify the candidate's



knowledge, skills and abilities as they relate to the position being staffed.

- 5) A supervisory reference's superior may be permitted as a reference only if that individual is familiar with the candidate's knowledge, skills and ability.
- 6) Selection Committee members may be used as a reference if they are a current or recent direct supervisor of the candidate.
- 7) Reference checks shall be conducted either by phone or email.
- 8) References are checked starting with the most recent. The exception to this would be when the candidate asks that the current supervisor be the final person contacted.
- 9) Details of reference checks shall be kept strictly confidential.
- 10) Job offers shall be contingent upon receipt of two positive references.
- 11) References shall be asked questions that are relevant to the knowledge, skills and abilities as demonstrated through the candidate's actions or behaviors during previous work-related activities.
- 12) The HRM may ask the proposed appointee to provide additional references if concerns are identified during the initial checks.
- 13) The HRM may review the personnel file of a candidate who is a current or former DDC employee if an issue is raised during the reference check. Performance appraisals should only be used to support information gathered from other sources, such as reference checking, and should not be the only source of information about past work performance.
- 14) If at any time during the recruitment process, the HRM determines that a candidate intentionally misrepresents any part of their qualifications or work experience, they are immediately eliminated from the recruitment process.
- 15) Reference check results, where the previous position applied on is similar in nature to the current position, will stand for a period of six months. Where an applicant is known to have applied on a similar position within the previous six months, reference checks completed for the old vacant position will be opened and reviewed by the current selection committee and applied to determine suitability for the current competition.

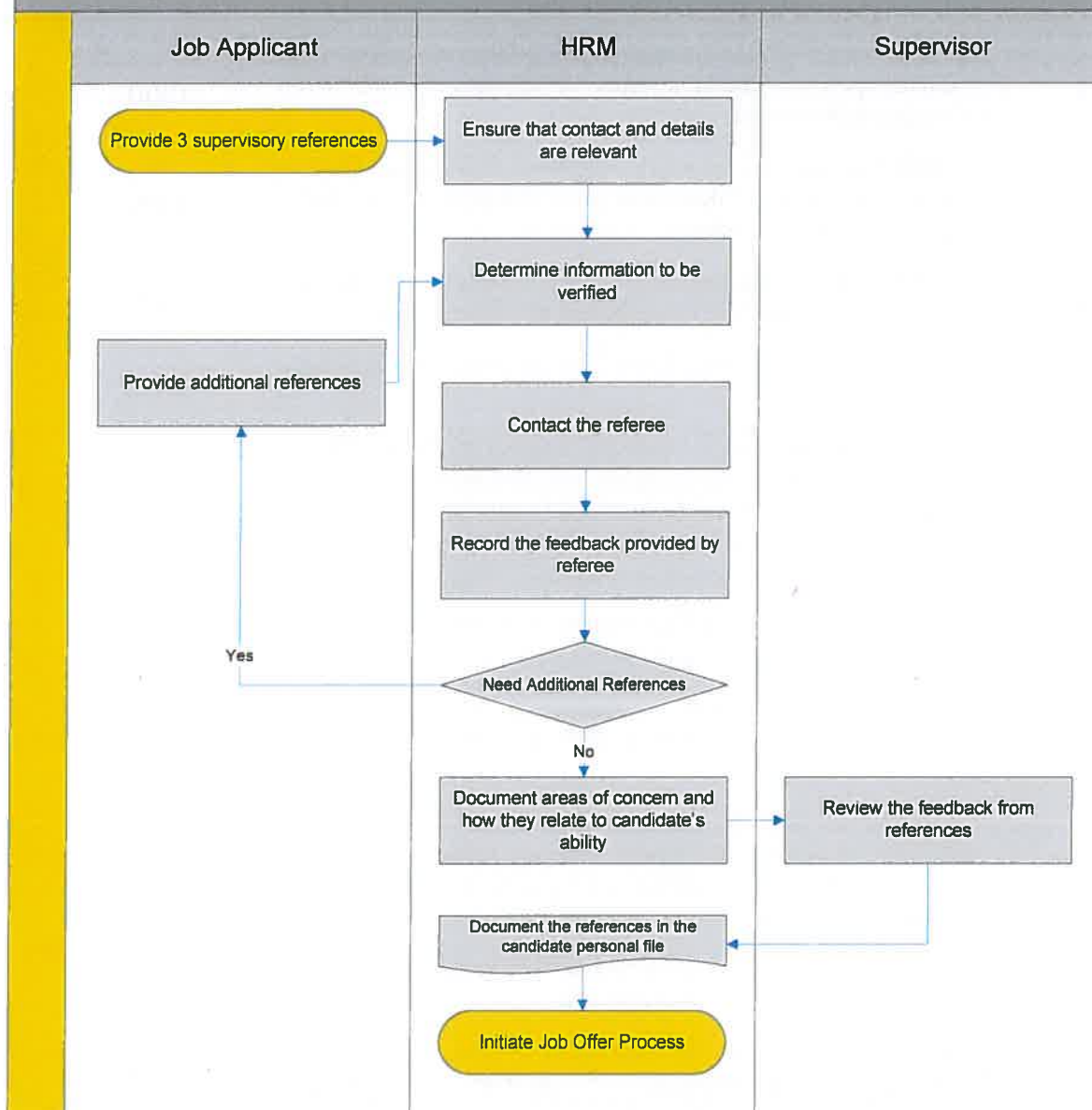


Table 8– Procedure for Conducting Reference Checks

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	The HRM collects contacts of supervisory references from the job candidates specifying the name, organization, contact number and their relationship to each reference.	HRM
2	The HRM reviews the interview responses and resume of the proposed appointee to determine what information to verify during the reference checks.	HRM
3	The HRM contacts the references either in person or by phone starting with the candidate's most recent direct supervisor.	HRM
4	The HRM briefly describes the position for which the candidate is being considered.	HRM
5	Using the Reference Check Guide (<i>Annexure 6: Reference Check Guide</i>), the HRM records feedback provided by each reference including an assessment of the candidate's knowledge, skills and abilities as they relate to the position being filled.	HRM
6	Upon completion of the reference check, the HRM thanks the reference and provides him/her with contact information in the event that they have something additional to provide.	HRM
7	The HRM documents areas of concern and describes how they relate to the candidate's ability to perform in the position being filled.	HRM
8	The HRM may skip further reference checks if two positive references are obtained; however, further references may be required if the HRM is unable to assess particular qualifications or require clarification in case of conflicting information.	HRM
9	The findings of all reference checks are reviewed with the Supervisor of the position being staffed.	Supervisor
10	Upon completion of the reference checks, all relevant documentation should be placed in the appointee's personnel file.	HRM

Figure 8–Conducting Reference Checks Cross Functional Process Map

Conducting Reference Checks



Section 2.13. Job Offers

Introduction

Once the proposed appointee satisfies the necessary pre-employment checks, a formal job offer is used to confirm acceptance of the final terms and conditions of employment.

Application

The HRM should apply these guidelines upon successful completion of reference checks. All final shortlisted candidates should be provided with a verbal job offer. On acceptance of the verbal job offer by the appointee a formal written job offer should be provided to the appointee.



Article 2.13.1. Guidelines

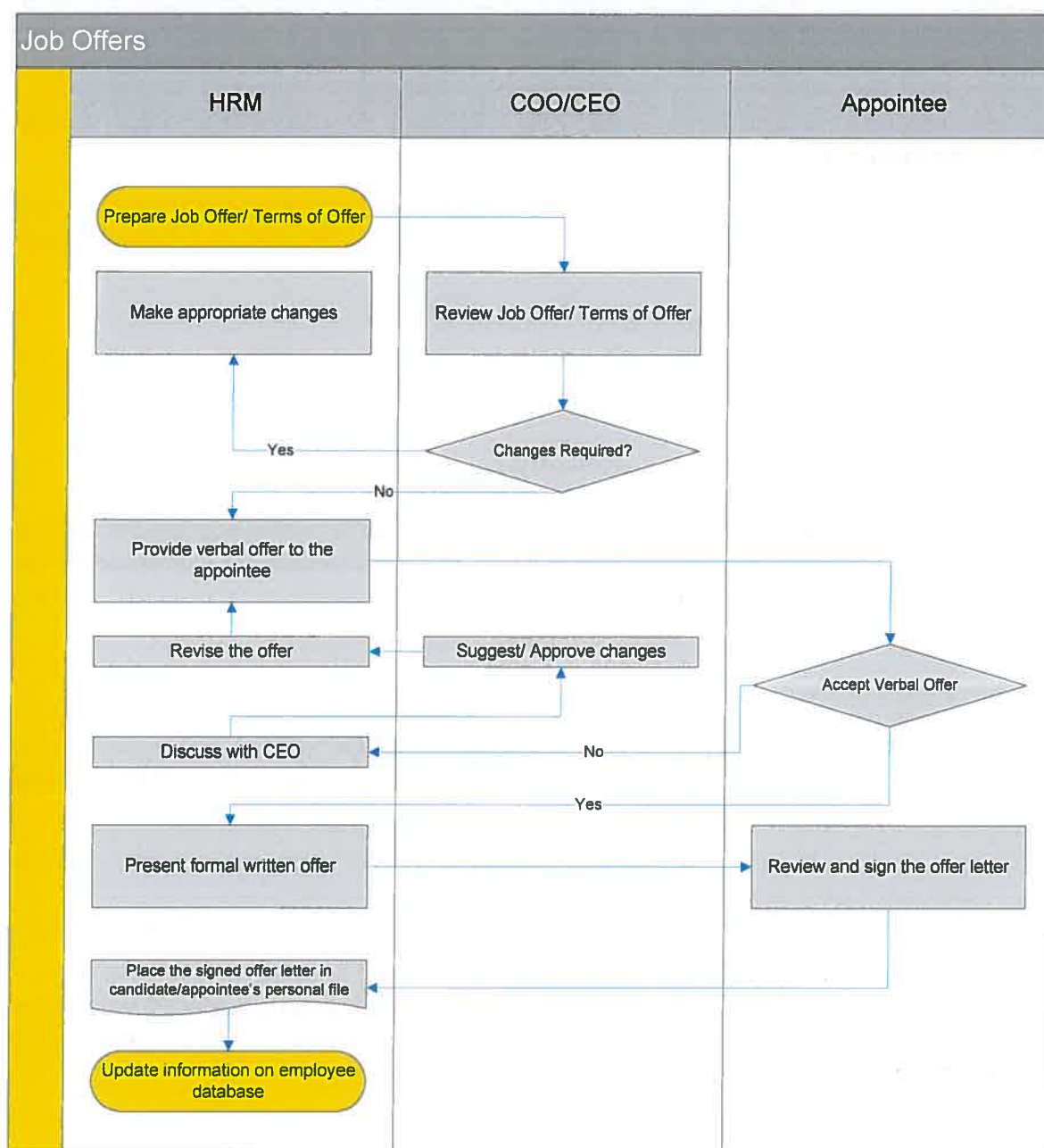
- 1) A job offer, when accepted by the appointee, binds the DDC to a contractual arrangement. It does not, however, bind the appointee to a contractual arrangement until they arrive for work on the effective date specified in the job offer.
- 2) A verbal acceptance by an appointee of specific terms and conditions of employment shall be immediately followed by a written job offer.
- 3) The HRM and Supervisor shall not act upon a job offer until a copy that has been signed and dated by the appointee is received.
- 4) A job offer may be conditional upon certain requirements being met. If those requirement(s) are not met prior to the start date specified in the job offer, the Selection Committee may defer the start date until such a time that they are satisfactorily met. Examples include:
 - a) Motor vehicle licensing requirements;
 - b) Certified criminal record check;
 - c) Medical examination; or
 - d) Society and/or association memberships.
- 5) The written job offer must be approved by the DCEO and signed off by the CEO.
- 6) The HRM shall recommend salary based on the existing grade and salary levels. The recommendations must be approved by the DCEO and signed off by the CEO.
- 7) Start dates for positions shall be established in the job offer.



Table 9– Procedure for Job Offers

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	The HRM discusses all terms and conditions requiring negotiations with the DCEO and the CEO.	HRM
2	The DCEO and CEO shall review all terms and conditions and provide necessary approvals.	DCEO /CEO
3	The HRM in consultation with the DCEO and the CEO provides a verbal offer to the appointee specifying the following terms and conditions of employment: <i>a. The title of the position and the department;</i> <i>b. Start date;</i> <i>c. The length of the Contract;</i> <i>d. Supervisor's name;</i> <i>e. Salary;</i> <i>f. The offer is conditional pending the completion of a medical check (if applicable);</i> <i>g. Any other conditions to the offer</i> <i>h. Where to report to work; and</i> <i>i. Information on annual leave, air passage, visa status etc</i>	HRM
4	If the candidate verbally accepts the proposed terms and conditions of employment, the HRM presents a formal written offer. An expiry date for the written offer will be specified in the body of the letter.	HRM
5	The appointee must review and sign the offer letter and any additional conditions of employment specified.	Appointee
6	The HRM places the signed job offer, job description and employee information request form and any additional documentation on the appointee's personnel file.	HRM
7	The HRM updates the information on the employee database accordingly.	HRM



Figure 9 – Job Offers Cross Functional Process Map

Section 2.14. Employment Contract

Introduction

The employment contract is a legal document that stipulates the terms and conditions of work under the purview the Oman Labor Law. It binds both employee and DDC to the terms of work agreed upon and ensures fairness to both employee and DDC.

Application

Every employee at DDC will have an employment contract. The HRM must ensure that the

employment contract is prepared and approved by both the employee and the DDC at the time of joining.

Article 2.14.1. Guidelines

- 1) An employment contract must be prepared by the HRM upon the acknowledgement of the job offer by the appointee.
- 2) The employment contract shall be written in both Arabic and English and must be signed by both the employee and the CEO /DCEO (Electronic sample Employment Contract - from MOM).
- 3) General considerations for drafting employment contract for Omani Nationals:
 - a) A contract of employment for an Omani employee will remain valid until he resigns; contract expires, retires or is terminated in accordance with the DDC policies and procedures.
 - b) All Omani nationals shall be given a bilingual contract in Arabic and English.
 - c) In respect of trainees, DDC shall confirm with local labor law.
 - d) The Contract signed with the employee is considered as the first reference to his duties and rights, and what has been listed on this manual regarding the Contract demonstrate the provisions of the Labor Law and are an inseparable part of it, but do not replace the contract.
 - e) The effective date of joining shall be the day they report to work.
- 4) General considerations for drafting employment contract for Expatriates:
 - a) A contract of service for an expatriate employee shall initially subsist for a period of two years commencing from the date of joining and shall be deemed to have been extended further provided:
 - i) The Company is able to obtain labor clearance for his / her employment as per the applicable labor and immigration rules
 - ii) The employees' services are needed by DDC based on business requirements and / or policy of the Company
 - b) DDC will bear all expenses related to the candidate's employment including obtaining labor clearances, work permit, visa, airfare, freight and personal effects etc and the Oman Labor Law shall be strictly adhered to.
 - c) The effective date of employment shall be as below:
 - i) For expatriate employee the effective date of arrival shall be considered as the effective date of joining
 - ii) For the locally hired expatriates the effective date of joining shall be from the day they report to work
 - iii) For trainees the effective date of joining will be from the date of completion of the training period.
- 5) One original copy of the signed employment contract must be placed in respective employee personal file.



Section 2.15. Pre-Employment Medical Examination

Introduction

Pre-employment medical examination includes certain pathological test, X-Ray checks or any special tests which DDC requires all prospective employees to undergo prior to joining to DDC.

Application

These guidelines should be applied by the HRM while hiring a new employee.

Article 2.15.1. Guidelines

- 1) All prospective employees should undergo a pre-employment medical test from GCC approved medical center. The medical test papers and certificate must be sent to the HRM for completing Visa formalities (in case of expatriates).
- 2) The fee for pre-employment medical test will be borne by the prospective employee. The fee shall be reimbursed to the employee upon joining DDC.
- 3) Upon arrival to Oman, prior to completion of resident card formalities, the employee will undergo medical examination at Ministry of Health approved clinics.
- 4) Employment at all circumstances shall be subject to the prospective employee being medically fit for working.

Section 2.16. Graduate Internships

Introduction

Graduate internships provide an opportunity for eligible Omani graduates to gain relevant and hands-on work experience with DDC Departments through a six- months/ one-year internship. Internships are intended to provide the first work experience relevant to the graduate's field of study.

Application

These guidelines and procedures must be applied while hiring graduate interns.

Article 2.16.1. Guidelines

- 1) The HRM is responsible for promotion and coordination of the internship program at DDC.
- 2) DHs are responsible for promotion and establishment of graduate internship positions in their Department.
- 3) Internships are intended to a span of six months to one year.
- 4) The graduate internship program applies only to graduates those in the field of study relevant to DDC business.
- 5) In order to be considered for a graduate internship, eligible Omani graduates will meet the following criteria:
 - a) Have completed a post-secondary program within the six months prior to being hired;
 - b) Were registered in a full course load for the two semesters prior to graduating; and
 - c) Were registered in a post-secondary program of at least four semesters in length that



resulted in a college diploma or university diploma or degree.

- 6) Position duties, experience and education requirements outlined on the job description must reflect those relevant to a new graduate.

Section 2.17. Induction

Introduction

Probationary periods are an opportunity for the employing Department to determine if the employee is suitable for the position. DDC is committed to ensuring that new employees have an opportunity to learn their job and to succeed.

Application

These guidelines and procedures shall apply to every new employee joining DDC. These guidelines document the necessity and the procedure of the induction program conducted by DDC.

Article 2.17.1. Guidelines

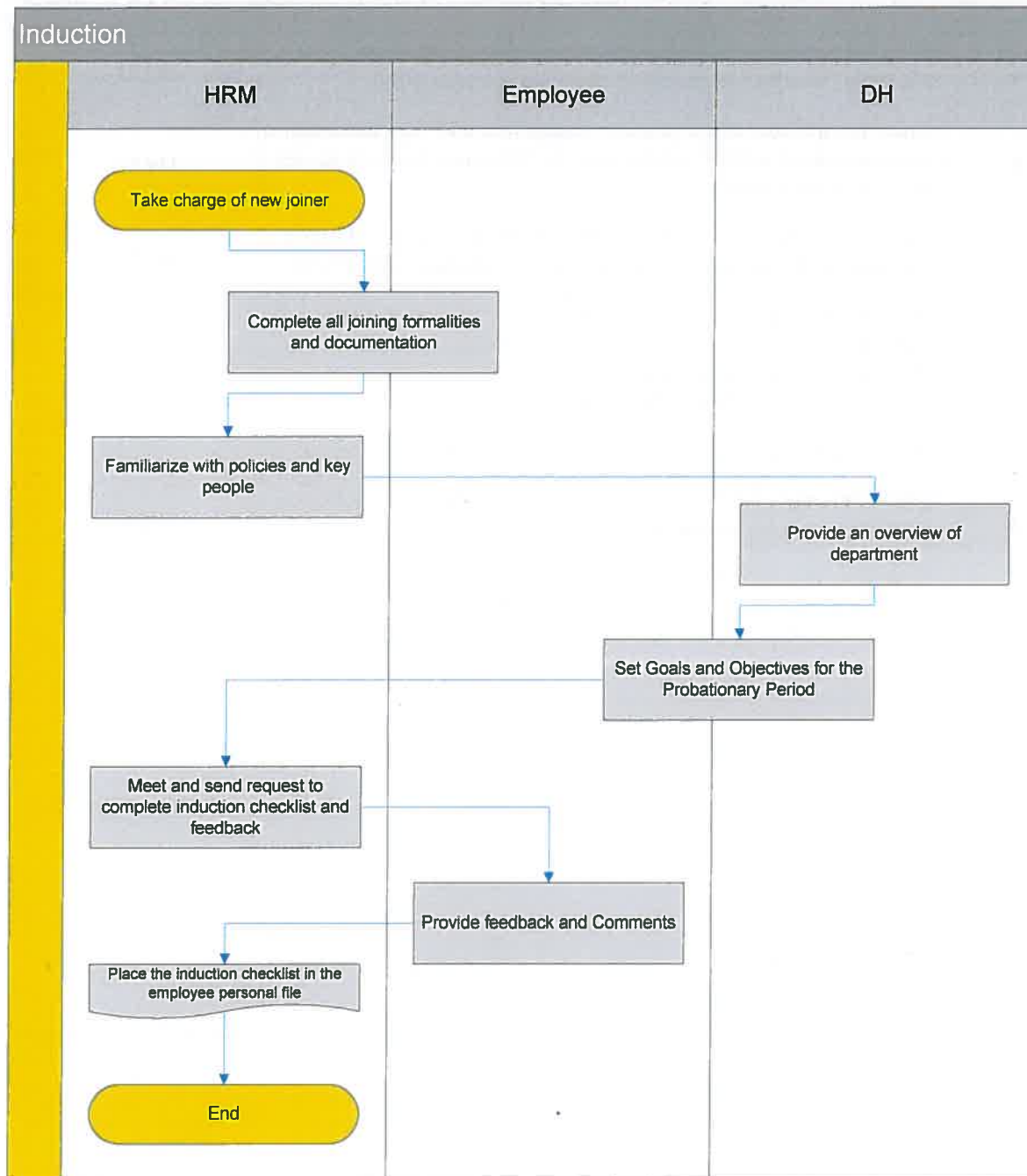
- 1) A formal Induction Program will be prepared jointly by the concerned DH and the HRM for every new staff joining DDC. The period of Induction will be mutually agreed.
- 2) The Induction Program should include orientation to Organizational Culture, Corporate Objectives, Policies, Procedures, Systems Activities, Facilities, Rules & Regulations applicable and the respective department overview.
- 3) The extent of information sharing will depend on the level / position of the staff.
- 4) The Induction Program also should include cross-functional orientation and on the job training as relevant for the position.
- 5) The HRM will familiarize new employees with procedures covering the following:
 - a) Medical treatment and other benefits
 - b) Leave rules
 - c) Timekeeping
 - d) Pay procedures
 - e) Performance evaluations
 - f) Holidays and vacations rules
 - g) Authority rules and disciplinary matters
 - h) Code of Conduct
 - i) Grievance Procedure
 - j) Travel Benefits



Table 10 – Procedure for Induction

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	The HR department will take charge of a new joiner when he joins and make sure that all joining formalities are completed.	HRM
2	Upon completion of all joining formalities and documentation instruct concerned DH and initiate the induction program as per pre determined schedule.	HRM
3	Familiarize the new joiner with the Organization, Policies, Procedures, key people and any further documentation required.	HRM
4	Provide the new joiner with an overview of the department and explain the new joiner on work rules, department deliverables, job description, roles and responsibility, performance parameters, authorities and reporting relationships.	DH
5	Set new joiner goals and objectives for the probationary period.	DH
6	Meet the new joiner and request to complete the induction checklist and provide feedback on the induction program.	HRM
7	Complete the induction checklist and provide feedback on the induction program.	Employee



Figure 11 – Induction Cross Functional Process Map

Section 2.18. Probationary Periods

Introduction

Probationary periods are an opportunity for the employing Department to determine if the employee is suitable for the position. DDC is committed to ensuring that new employees have an opportunity to learn their job and to succeed.

Application



These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 2.18.1. Guidelines

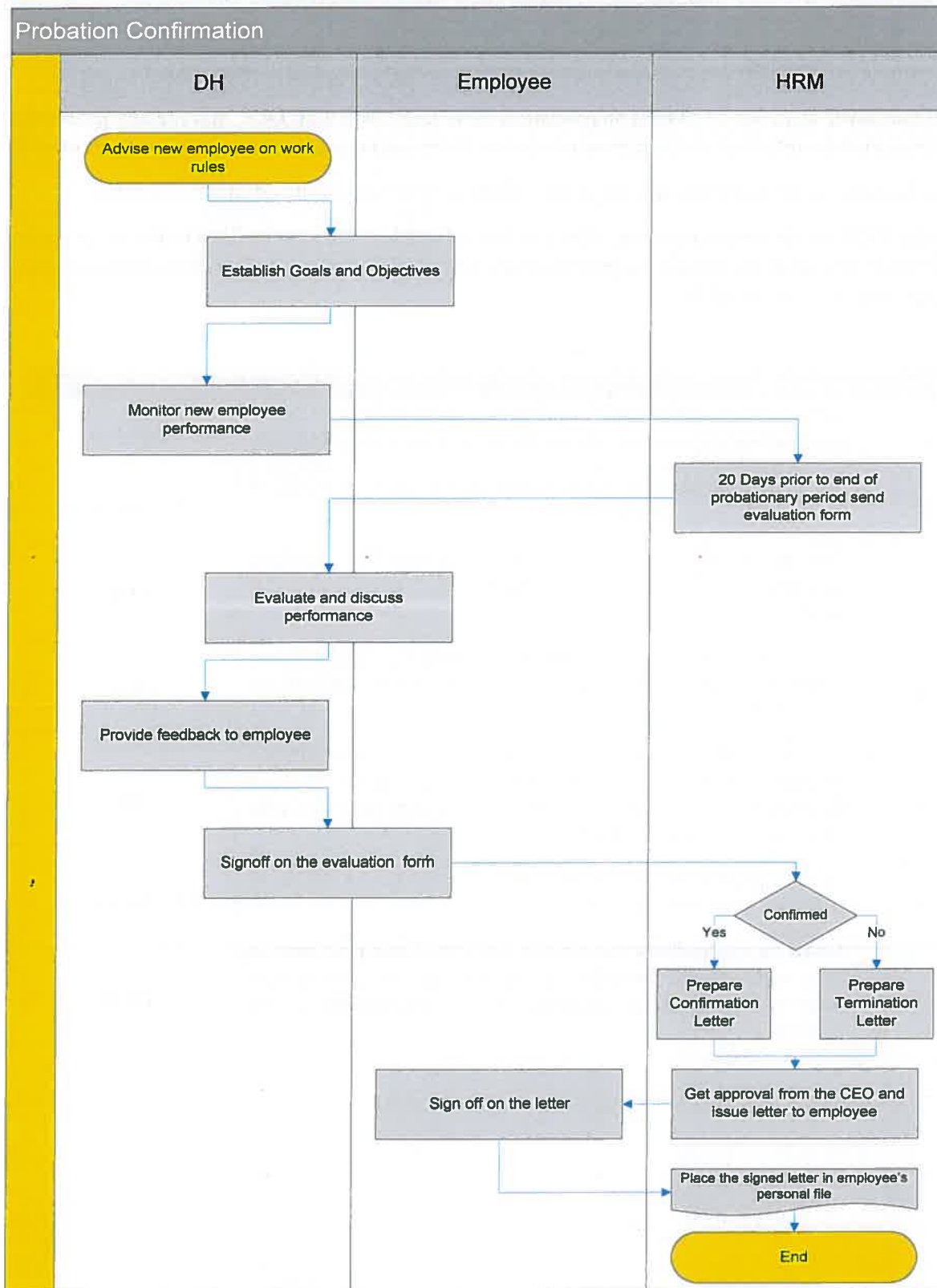
- 1) An employee shall not be placed on probation for a period exceeding three months.
- 2) An employee shall not be placed on probation more than once with DDC and the any probation period shall be included in the period of service if the employee has successfully completed it.
- 3) In all cases the probationary period, if any, shall be specified in the contract of service.
- 4) Either DDC or the employee may, after a notice of not less than seven days to the other party, terminate the contract during the probationary period, if it becomes clear that continuation in employment is not suitable.

Table 11– Procedure for Probation Confirmation

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	Advise probationary employees of the standard of conduct that is expected and explains the rules of the work place to the employee.	DH
2	Establish the goals and objectives during the first two weeks of probationary employment.	DH/ Employee
3	The performance of probationary employees is carefully monitored by DH. If problems are identified, corrective action is taken.	DH
4	20 days prior to the end of probationary period forward Probation Confirmation form to the DH to evaluate and provide feedback on the probationary employee.	HRM
5	Evaluate and discuss the performance of the probationary employee against set goals and objectives; provide feedback on the probation confirmation form whether the employee is suitable or not suitable for confirmation.	DH
6	15 days prior to the end of probationary period Sign off on the probation confirmation form	DH/ Employee
7	Based on the feedback received on the form, issue confirmation letter to the suitable probationary employee and issue termination letter to a probationary employee who is not suitable for the position.	HRM



Figure 11 – Probation Confirmation Cross Functional Process Map



Chapter 3. Job Evaluation

Section 3.1. Job Evaluation

Introduction

Job evaluation is the analysis and evaluation of the required know-how, problem solving, accountability and working conditions of a job. The result establishes the relative value of a job within DDC.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to employee at DDC.

Article 3.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) DHs are responsible for determining the organizational design and positions required for the operation of the Departments. DHs are also responsible (by signing the job description) for determining the work assigned to positions.
- 2) The responsibility for effective implementation of the job evaluation function rests with the HRM on behalf of DDC.
- 3) The HRM in consultation with the DCEO and the CEO decides on the method to be used for Job Evaluation.
- 4) Copies of all job evaluation documentation are kept in the position file maintained by the HRM and are disposed of in accordance with business requirements.
- 5) The job evaluation process does not evaluate the following aspects of jobs as they are not valid indicators of a position:
 - a) Confidential material – handling or viewing of confidential or sensitive material or subject matter is expected of every position within DDC
 - b) Volume of work – does not affect complexity or responsibility level and is dealt with through payment of overtime;
 - c) Duties assigned/assumed – the Employer determines and assigns the work to be completed by the employee;
 - d) Incumbent qualifications – qualifications above those required for the position are not considered; and
 - e) Recruitment, long service, or other compensation issues – these are pay issues and are not part of the evaluation criteria.
- 6) The job evaluation process is not used to provide an employee with a raise or a reward for superior performance.

Section 3.2. Job Descriptions

Introduction



A job description is a list of the general tasks, or functions, and responsibilities of a position. Typically, it also includes to whom the position reports, specifications such as the qualifications needed by the person in the job, salary range for the position, etc..

Application

Job description provide outline of duties and responsibilities to make the screening process as direct and focused as possible and acts as input in developing employee key performance indicators and are not the key performance indicators by itself. These guidelines and procedures apply to employee at DDC.

Article 3.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) Job descriptions are developed by the HRM or an expert in the area in consultation with the concerned DH and are tailored to meet the organizational and departmental objectives to the fullest.
- 2) Job descriptions should be accurate and most up to date in order to source a right candidate or to establish the right performance standards for employees.
- 3) All job descriptions must include the following:
 - a) Purpose of the position
 - b) Grade and Title
 - c) Competencies and Skills required
 - d) Key Responsibilities
 - e) Relevant years of experience
 - f) Qualifications
 - g) Reporting relationships
- 4) The HRM shall be the custodian of all job descriptions and shall be responsible for keeping them most updated
- 5) All requests for creation of new job descriptions and updating old ones must be sent to the HRM with reasonable justifications and information regarding the roles and responsibilities of the said position
- 6) Job descriptions shall carry grades that are in accordance with the grading structure after a comprehensive job evaluation exercise.

Section 3.3. Grades and Titles

Introduction

Grades and titles are representation of the ranking of positions within DDC. It states out the level of the position and reflects the role of the position.

Application



These guidelines apply to all positions at DDC.

Article 3.3.1. Guidelines

- 1) At present there are 9 grades and various titles within DDC.
- 2) Grades shall be determined based on the job evaluation process and should be approved by the Board. Once the grades and titles are determined they are communicated across the organization.
- 3) The HRM is the custodian of the grade and title chart and the chart must be updated to reflect organizational changes.
- 4) All job descriptions and the organization chart should bare current relevant position listed out in the grade and title chart.
- 5) Below is the grade and title chart for various positions at DDC:

Job Grade	Existing Job Title
1	Chief Executive Officer
2	DCEO
3	COO/ CFO/ Project Coordinator
4	Technical Manager/ HR & Admin Manager/ Planning & Marketing Manager
5	Assistant Manager Finance
6	Accounts Assistant
7 & 8	HR & Admin Assistant/ PRO / Receptionist
9	Driver/Office Assistant



Chapter 4. Employee Records

Section 4.1. Documentation

Introduction

Documentation is an important session for new employees, where in all necessary joining formalities are completed prior to inducting the candidate in to his/her job role.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

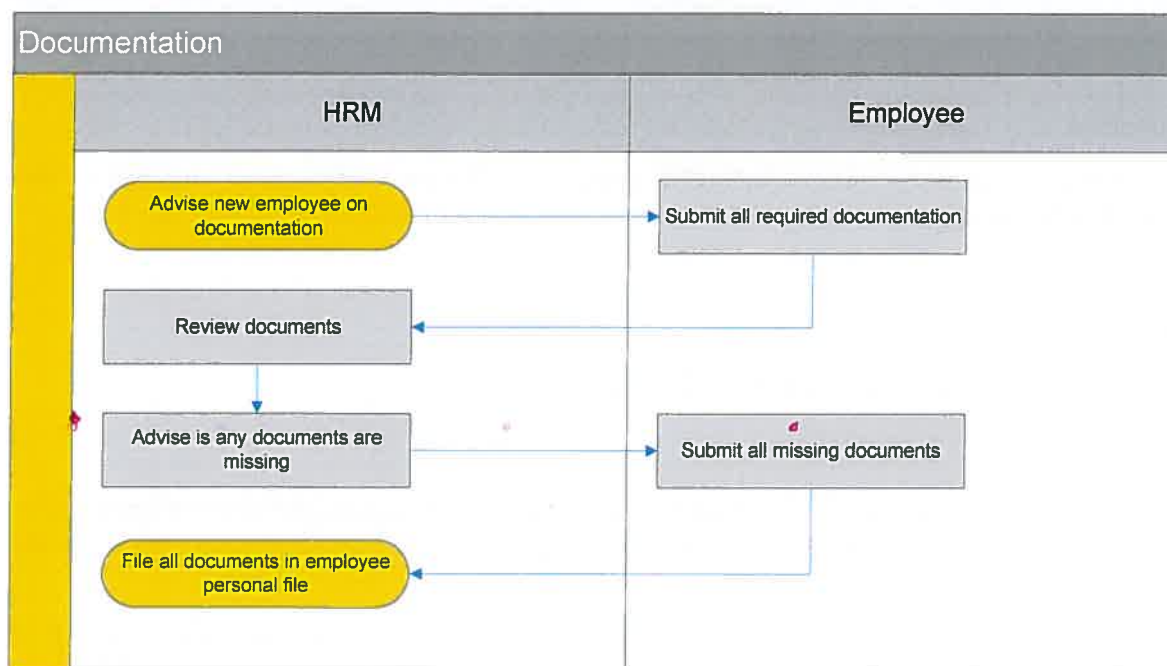
Article 4.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) The HRM is responsible for setting out all information and documentation required from employees when they are hired.
- 2) Each employee is required to submit prescribed documents to the Human Resources Department as soon as possible after the start of employment. Failure to provide the requested documents may result in delays in processing employee benefits or even might lead to disciplinary actions.
- 3) Employees are required to bring the following certificates and information to documentation:
 - a) Employee Information Request
 - b) Certificates of birth, marriage etc.,
 - c) Passport/ National ID
 - d) Copies of degrees , certificates and diplomas

Table 12– Procedure for Documentation

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	New employees are advised in the letter of offer about the requirement for a documentation session.	HRM
2	Employees submit all required documentation on the date of joining; expatriate employees submit documents required for labor clearances, visa processing and other joining formalities upon acceptance of offer.	Employee
3	Employees who miss their documentation on the date of joining should submit the necessary documents within one week of joining.	Employee
4	File the documents in employee personnel file and provide copies to relevant people as deemed necessary.	HRM



Figure 12– Documentation Cross Functional Process Map

Section 4.2. Employee Identification

Introduction

Cards are issued to employees for identification purposes.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees

Article 4.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) Identification cards are issued to employees at the time of joining. They are not normally issued to casual employees or trainees unless required.
- 2) Identification cards are the property of DDC. Lost cards should be reported to the Human Resources Department. Employees should safeguard the identification cards for access purposes and in the event they lose the identification cards the additional expense for procuring the card shall be borne by the employee.
- 3) Identification cards must be returned to DDC Human Resources Department when employment ceases.

Section 4.3. Personnel Records

Introduction

Personnel records are maintained for all DDC employees. Personal information obtained by the DDC and held in an employee's personnel record is held in confidence.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees

Article 4.3.1. Guidelines

- 1) An employee may view his or her own personnel file by making an appointment with HRM. An employee is not entitled to view the references contained in sealed envelopes on the personnel file.
- 2) A supervisor may view disciplinary or performance-related documents on the personnel file of any employee who reports to the supervisor. A supervisor is not entitled to view confidential information such as references or insurance beneficiaries.
- 3) An employee must be made aware of any disciplinary documents placed on the personnel file. The supervisor providing the employee with a copy of the document at the time of filing can do this. Documents will be clearly marked "Copy to Personnel File" or include a statement in the body of the letter indicating that a copy of the letter will be placed on the employee's personnel file.
- 4) For an employee, any document or written statement related to disciplinary action and placed on the personnel file of the employee shall be destroyed after 18 months has elapsed if no further disciplinary action has been recorded.
- 5) For an employee in the Grade 1 to 3, any document or written statement related to disciplinary action and placed on the personnel file of the employee shall be destroyed at the discretion of the DCEO and the CEO or the Board.
- 6) An employee may not place any document or information directly on his or her personnel file. Information of a disciplinary or complimentary nature must be placed on file by the HRM with the supervisor's consent. An employee is allowed to place responses to appraisals or disciplinary action on the personnel file. This must be done through the HRM and the employee's supervisor so that the supervisor is aware of the information on the personnel file.

Section 4.4. Release of Information

Introduction

Personnel records are maintained for all DDC employees. This information is held in the form of



personnel files with the Human Resources department. Any personal employee information retained by the DDC is held in confidence.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees

Article 4.4.1. Guidelines

- 1) Any third party requests for employee information should be forwarded to the HRM. HRM will check the identity of the third party and require them to produce evidence of the employee's consent to release of the information.
- 2) Any employee who has authorized a third party to obtain his personal info from DDC should intimate the HRM about to them same along with the information he/she has intended to release, however any information related to discipline and/or performance shall not be release until deemed to be necessary by DDC.
- 3) Most requests for employee information may come from banks or credit bureaus, when receiving such requests the Human Resources Staff may:
 - a) State the employees position title, date of hire and date of termination
 - b) Confirm whether or not the salary estimate provided by the bank or credit bureau is close to the real salary
 - c) Human Resources staff will not give out any exact salary information without employee's written authorization, they shall only confirm whether the salary stated by the third party is close to real salary or not.
- 4) The employee's consent is not needed if the law requires disclosure of information.



Chapter 5. Hours of Work and Overtime

Introduction

DDC establishes a regular schedule of hours of work for employees based upon work requirements.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Section 5.1. Standard Hours of Work

- 1) Standard hours of work for all employees at DDC are Eight (8) per day/ hours per week.
- 2) The standard hours of work from Sunday to Thursday will be as proposed by management from time to time and approved by the Chairman.
- 3) Friday and Saturday are considered to be weekly holidays.
- 4) The maximum working hours during the month of Ramadan shall be six (6) hours a day or 36 hours a week for Muslim workers. The actual work timings shall be communicated to the employees.
- 5) All Muslim employees can take a 15 minutes break for offering prayers.

Section 5.2. Shift Work

- 1) Employees in certain categories may be required to work in shifts. The schedule of hours of work for employees who must work in shifts shall be set by the respective DH in consultation with the HRM and in line with the Oman Labor Law.
 - a) The supervisors/ managers concerned should publish the rosters and communicate to the staff who are required to be on shifts well in advance.
 - b) Employees required to work on off days and public holidays will be given compensatory offs in lieu, such compensatory offs in lieu are at the discretion of the managers and will depend on the business exigencies.

Section 5.3. Overtime

- 1) To deliver projects effectively DDC may require employees to work outside of their regularly scheduled hours of work. The requirement for overtime is driven by operational needs.
- 2) Overtime shall be compensated to employees in grade 8 to 9, however for rest of the employees compensatory off/ lieu time policy shall be applicable.
- 3) Compensation for overtime shall be paid when work is authorized in advance by the DH and shall be paid as detailed below:



- a) For hours worked between 6:00 am and 8:00 pm, overtime shall be paid as 1.25 times including regular salary per hour and compensation for overtime.
 - b) For hours worked between 9:00 pm and 5:00 am, overtime shall be paid as 1.50 times including regular salary per hour and compensation for overtime.
 - c) For hours worked during weekly rest day or public holidays, overtime shall be paid as 2 times including regular salary per hour and compensation for overtime.
- 4) Overtime paid to employees will be in line with Oman Labor Law and is calculated for hours in excess of scheduled hours of work or in excess of 45 hours per week.
 - 5) During the holy month of Ramadan, Muslim employees will be paid overtime for hours worked in excess of 6 hours per day.

Section 5.4. Lieu Time (Compensatory Off)

- 1) To deliver projects effectively, DDC may require employees to work outside of their regularly scheduled hours of work. DDC will grant employees equivalent leave with pay at the appropriate overtime rate (lieu time).
- 2) The granting of lieu time is strictly at the discretion of the DH and must be taken at a time agreeable to both the supervisor and the employee.
- 3) Lieu time cannot be accumulated and should be utilized in the same fiscal year. When employees are on lieu time, same has to be intimated to the Human Resources department; else the same will be considered as absence.



Chapter 6. Leave

Section 6.1. Leaves – General

Introduction

Employees are provided with facility to avail various leaves, be it for vacation or dealing with sickness, maternity, emergencies, study, religious obligations and for mourning in case of death of close family members.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 6.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) An employee is expected to report to duty and work unless on authorized leave.
- 2) An employee who is unable to report to duty and work is required to call his/her supervisor or designate, personally, at the start of the workday. The employee is required to request conditional approval of the leave and to provide an indication of the expected length of the absence.
- 3) An employee is responsible for understanding the type of leaves set out in the Human Resources Policy Manual. An employee who is unsure of what leave he/she is entitled to should speak to his/her supervisor or HRM.
- 4) One type of leave cannot be substituted for another type of leave except in exceptional circumstances or otherwise stated.
- 5) An employee is required to complete an application for leave (*Annexure 8: Leave Application Form*) for all leave or time off.
- 6) Except where otherwise established in these guidelines, the employee's immediate supervisor or respective DH is normally the individual who may approve leave.
- 7) The employee and the immediate supervisor are jointly responsible for the completion and authorization of a request for leave for:
 - a) Leave taken without prior (verbal) approval (e.g., emergency leave, special leave for the death of a relative or special leave for illness of a relative, etc.);
 - b) Restoration of leave when recalled from vacation leave; or
 - c) Any change in a previously approved leave after the leave has started.
- 8) Verbal approval must be sought at the earliest reasonable opportunity. Entry into leave database by the Human Resources Department must be completed immediately after the employee returns from leave.



Section 6.2. Attendance

Introduction

Employees must attend work regularly and on time. When an employee's attendance is unsatisfactory, corrective action must be taken.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 6.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) Employees must attend work during their regularly scheduled hours of work.
- 2) DDC DHs has a right and responsibility to know where employees are during scheduled hours of work.
- 3) An employee must request authorization of any unscheduled absence as soon as reasonably possible after learning that the absence will occur. The request must include a reason for the absence and an estimate of the duration of the absence. Managers may require employees to submit their requests in writing.
- 4) DHs must be fair and reasonable in determining whether any unscheduled absence from the workplace will be authorized.
- 5) Authorization of leave to cover the time away from work will be granted only if the DH deems the absence reasonable and unavoidable.
- 6) Where the employee is absent without leave or is late, appropriate deductions may be made from the employee's pay.
- 7) Absence without leave is subject to disciplinary action.

Article 6.2.2. Attendance Registers

- 1) The HRM ensures that attendance registers are maintained for employees. The attendance registers will record the attendance and absences of each employee.
- 2) Employees shall sign the attendance register each day and verify accuracy as required.
- 3) Employee attendance reports are prepared by the Human Resources Department and shared with the finance department while processing salaries.

Section 6.3. Attendance Management

Introduction

An employee is expected to report to duty and work unless on authorized leave. Managing the use of authorized and unauthorized leave is the responsibility of the respective DH.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.



Article 6.3.1. Employee Responsibilities

- 1) Employees who are unable to report to duty and work are required to call their immediate supervisor or DH, personally, at the start of the workday. Employees are required to request conditional approval of the leave and to provide an indication of the expected length of the absence.
- 2) Failing to personally seek conditional approval for lateness or sick/special leave may result in employees being recorded as absent without approved leave, which may lead to disciplinary action.
- 3) Immediately upon returning to work, the employee is required to complete a Leave Form indicating the number of hours of leave requested. The failure to submit a leave application in a timely manner may also result in the leave being recorded as absent without approved leave.
- 4) Employees who are absent from work due to illness or injury for a lengthy period (10 working days or more) must maintain contact with their manager on a regular basis. Failure to maintain contact may be viewed as insubordinate behavior and subject to disciplinary measures.

Article 6.3.2. DH Responsibilities

- 1) DHs approve the granting of leave subject to the terms and conditions of employment where there is reason to believe that the request for leave is a valid one.
- 2) DHs monitor the use of leave and act appropriately according to the circumstances when unusual attendance patterns (i.e. late 20 minutes every other morning) or leave usage (i.e. misses every other Saturday morning) become evident by an individual employee.
- 3) DHs are responsible for following up with employees who have been absent to ensure that leave taken are forwarded to Human Resources department within one working day of an employee's return to work.
- 4) DHs must reconsider the approval of sick leave where there is evidence that employees have been involved in activities that are inconsistent with their being too ill to work such as participation in recreational activities or working elsewhere while off work due to illness. Prior to denying sick leave or sick leave without pay, the manager is responsible for consulting with HRM conducting a review of the facts pertinent to the matter.
- 5) DHs will interview employees when they return to work from a lengthy absence due to illness or if the length, frequency or pattern of sick leave absences is unusual or inappropriate and advise HRM on any appropriate actions to be taken.

Article 6.3.3. Unauthorized Absence

- 1) Absences that do not fall under the circumstances defined in the Leave section and those that are not in accordance with the procedures defined will be considered as Unauthorized Absence
 - a) Employees will abide by established DDC Hours of Work and Leave policies and assume responsibility of advising management of any absence or late coming.
 - b) Unauthorized days of absence will be charged to the employees' annual leave account and in the event that the annual leave balance is zero, it shall be considered as leave without pay.



- c) Unauthorized absenteeism and persistent late coming will result in progressive disciplinary action.

Section 6.4. Annual Leave

Introduction

DDC considers it essential to employees' well being that they take annual leave at regular intervals.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 6.4.1. Guidelines

- 1) Annual leave with pay is granted to an employee each year for the purpose of taking a vacation, where the following applies:
 - a) The employee has earned the annual leave;
 - b) The employee will earn the annual leave during the fiscal year, or during their term of employment, whichever is shorter;
 - c) The time is mutually agreeable to the employee and the employee's supervisor.
- 2) Annual leave entitlements are based on continuous service and prior completed years of service and are accumulated on a monthly basis for all employees. Annual leaves shall accumulate from the date of joining on a pro rata basis each month and shall be credited to the employees leave balance database maintained by the Human Resources Department.
- 3) Annual leaves can be availed by the employee only after 3 months from the date of joining and upon completion of the probation period.
- 4) The annual leave entitlements for different levels of employees at DDC is given below:
 - a) 30 working days for employees in Grade 1 and 2.
 - b) 25 working days for employees in other categories

Article 6.4.2. Dependents of Employees

- 1) DDC provides leave benefits to dependents of employees.
- 2) Dependents include:
 - a) An employee's spouse who is residing with the employee in Oman and not employed by any other organization in Oman.
 - b) A child, step child or adopted child residing with an employee in Oman and is under age of 18.
- 3) Any policy or guideline outlining benefits or allowances refer only to aforesaid dependents. Any allowances or benefits provided to dependent children will be subject to a maximum of two children.
- 4) An employee's spouse who is on employee's dependent visa must not be employed with any



other organization unless an employment visa is received from the employing organization.

Article 6.4.3. Annual Leave Planning

- 1) The DH will prepare annual leave plan for his team members at the beginning of every year.
- 2) The employee must be in a pay status on the day immediately preceding the annual leave to be eligible to proceed on leave.
- 3) Granting of annual leaves will be dependent upon operational exigencies and minimum headcount that needs to be maintained for each function. The department head will have the discretion on sanctioning annual leaves.
- 4) An employee can request for splitting his total annual leave for the year into various durations to be availed at different times of the year.
- 5) The Human Resources department shall make the necessary arrangements for the eligible employees to proceed on leave in coordination with the HR department.
- 6) All departments must produce a yearly leave plan for the staff and to ensure that the leave implemented. The leave plan should be shared with the Human Resources Department.

Article 6.4.4. Accumulation of Annual Leave

- 1) Employees are encouraged to avail their annual leaves every year; however employees should avail at least 15 days of annual leave every year and remaining leave can be carried forward.
- 2) Only in cases where the employee is not permitted to go on leave for operational reason, the leaves can be carried forward entirely/ in part and should be availed within 6 months. The DH in such exceptional circumstances should make recommendations along with justification to the DCEO and the CEO and the same will be based on the DCEO and the CEO's approval.

Article 6.4.5. Annual Leave Encashment

- 1) DDC does not permit leave encashment for its employees; leave encashment is only permitted in case of retirement, resignation, death or termination due to prolonged illness.
- 2) Employees terminated due to disciplinary actions and on moral & ethical grounds shall not be eligible for leave encashment.

Article 6.4.6. Recall during Annual Leave

- 1) All expatriate employees are eligible for Annual leave ticket. Annual leave tickets shall not be accumulated and should be utilized in the year they are due.
- 2) Class of travel will be economy unless otherwise stated.
- 3) If an employee who is entitled to annual leave is recalled (due to business exigencies) by DDC, he/she may split the annual leave in to two periods on account of the recall.
- 4) In such cases, an employee will be entitled to leave ticket for each leave period. However, approval from the DCEO and signoff from the CEO is required to recall staff from leave. The unutilized portion of the leave shall be credited to the leave balance of the employee.



Article 6.4.7. Advance salary during annual leave

- 1) On the request of an employee where the annual leave period is more than or equal to 20 days, salary advance up to the current month's pay can be disbursed two weeks prior to the departure date.
- 2) Such advances will be subject to conditions mentioned in the Compensation and Benefits section of this manual.

Section 6.5. Other Leaves**Article 6.5.1. Sick Leave**

- 1) DDC is committed to just and fair treatment of its employees as employees are among those stakeholders that help DDC in achieving the business and social objectives in the Sultanate of Oman. Employees who have completed three months of service with DDC shall be entitled to Sick Leaves every year in accordance with Oman Labor Law.
- 2) All employees of DDC are entitled to sick leave as per Labor Law as follows:

Sick Leaves During	Entitlement
1 st and 4 th Week	Full Salary
5 th and 6 th Week	75% Salary
7 th and up to the end of the 10 th Week	50% Salary
11 th and up to the end of the 13 th Week	25% Salary

- 3) All staff are entitled to sick leave not less than 30 days in a calendar year or on pro rata basis for employees who have joined during the year based on the month of joining. CEO is authorized to approve any exception in the Sick Leave Policy whenever a genuine case arises.
- 4) This policy shall apply to all kinds of sickness including dental; except maternity. Maternity leaves are covered under the Maternity Leave Policy.
- 5) All sick leaves shall exclude variable pay as mentioned in the table above.
- 6) Paid sick leave for more than one day shall be supported by an approved medical certificate. An approved medical certificate is defined as a certificate issued by the Ministry of Health or by approved clinics / hospitals.
- 7) If an employee falls sick during any paid leave / approved unpaid leave, the same has to be supported by an approved medical certificate. In such cases, the number of days of sickness which is approved will be re-credited to the annual leave and deducted from the sick leave balance.
- 8) In the case of expatriate staff, such medical evidence issued by a Government Hospital must be endorsed "Not fit to Travel" and must specify the exact nature of the treatment provided to the employee. This evidence will be handed over to the Company as and when the employee returns to duty.
- 9) Employees who are sick on a Public Holiday will not be compensated with days off in lieu.



- 10) In case the employee is afflicted with a contagious disease, a fitness certificate should be produced from a recognized medical practitioner before resuming duties.
- 11) Sick leave with full pay will be credited to the employees' sick leave balance on a pro rated basis every month, though employees will be eligible to avail the sick leaves entitlement for the calendar year in advance
- 12) While calculating sick leaves, any periods of unauthorized leaves or leave without pay will be deducted on a pro rata basis from the total sick leave eligibility. This is to ensure that such sick leaves are earned by the employee for his/her contribution to company objectives and not as a matter of right.
 - a) Example: If an employee was on unauthorized leave or unpaid leave for a period of 1 month during a calendar year, his eligibility for the year will reduce by 1.16 days (14 days/12 months X 1 month)

Article 6.5.2. Maternity Leave

- 1) DDC supports the well being of its employees and recognizes the need for women employees to take time off from work to deal with their last month of pregnancy, post delivery and any associated emergencies that need attention.
- 2) A woman shall be granted a special leave to cover the pre-delivery period and the post delivery period for 50 days with Gross Salary for not more than three times throughout her service with the employer.
- 3) Maternity leave may be granted to women employees in cases of miscarriage including abortion subject to the condition that the leave does not exceed 6 weeks
- 4) The woman employee is entitled to full salary for the maternity leave period.
- 5) Maternity leave is subject to provision of a medical certificate from a qualified doctor.
- 6) Women employees who have been in service for more than a year, requiring longer periods of rest during pregnancies can opt for sick leave or leave without pay if they do not have enough annual leave balance. Such women can apply for leave extensions during maternity in cases where it is required
- 7) Extensions in leave during maternity must be supported by evidence from Ministry of Health approved hospital.
- 8) Maternity leaves could be combined with annual leave or with leave without pay upon Department Head's approval.
- 9) Such permissions can be approved at the discretion of the department head taking into consideration business exigencies.

Article 6.5.3. Examination Leave

- 1) DDC employees are entitled for 14 days leave every calendar year for purpose of preparation for and appearing in examinations.
- 2) Examination Leaves not availed in a particular calendar year will not be carried forward to the next year.



- 3) The employee should have received prior approvals to undertake the course.
- 4) The employee should also provide copies of hall tickets issued by the university/institution where he/she has enrolled for education.

Article 6.5.4. Matrimonial Leave

- 1) All employees, irrespective of grades will be eligible for a special leave on account of marriage for 3 days once during the tenure of service with DDC.

Article 6.5.5. Compassionate Leave

- 1) All employees, irrespective of grades will be eligible for a special leave on account of death of a family member.
 - a) Three days in case of the death of a son, daughter, mother, father, wife, grandfather, grandmother, brother or sister.
 - b) Two days in case of the death of an uncle, or an aunt.
- 2) Such leaves will be granted on submission of a death certificate from a qualified doctor or from the Wali of the area where the death has occurred.

Article 6.5.6. Iddah

- 1) DDC in accordance with the Oman Labor law, grants a Muslim woman employee; a special leave with full pay for a period of 4 months and 10 days immediately following the death of her husband. This period of leave will be in addition to the 3 days Emergency Leave granted to the employee for the death of her husband, provided she observes Iddah.

Article 6.5.7. Hajj Leave

- 1) DDC provides all Muslim employees (with one year of service at DDC) 15 days leave for performing Hajj pilgrimage.
- 2) The leave is granted only once during the course of his/her employment and needs to be approved by the respective DH.
- 3) In case of Non Omanis, prior to the sanction of leave, the employee should obtain the visit permit to go on the Hajj from the Ministry of Islamic Affairs.
- 4) The employee should submit the leave notice at least 1 month in advance to the Department Head.
- 5) In case the employee has exceeded the period of leave, additional period shall be considered as leave without pay or may be deducted from his/her annual leave balance.
- 6) Official Eid Al-Adha holidays will not be applicable to the employee under such circumstances.
- 7) On return to duty after Hajj leave, the employee should submit copy of the passport page showing entry and exit stamp to Jeddah.

Article 6.5.8. Leave without Pay

- 1) Leave without pay is provided to employees only in extra ordinary circumstances and only when the employee's annual leave balance is zero.



- 2) Employees are not entitled to leave without pay as a matter of right and shall be subject to discretion of the respective DH. Leave without pay can be neither accrued nor en-cashed.
- 3) Employee should have exhausted his/her annual leave balance prior to availing leave without pay.
- 4) Such leaves must be granted by the DHs only when sufficient justification has been provided by the employee and that operational activities are not affected.
- 5) Any leave without pay exceeding 14 days should be referred to DCEO for approval and forwarded to the CEO for signoff.

Article 6.5.9. Public Holidays

- 1) DDC recognizes holidays applicable and as published by the Government Sector. The HRM announces the commencement date and duration of the holiday on each occasion.
- 2) If a period of official mourning is announced by the government, the employee will remain at work or first report for duty as normal and await the instructions from the HRM.

Table 13– Procedure for Leave

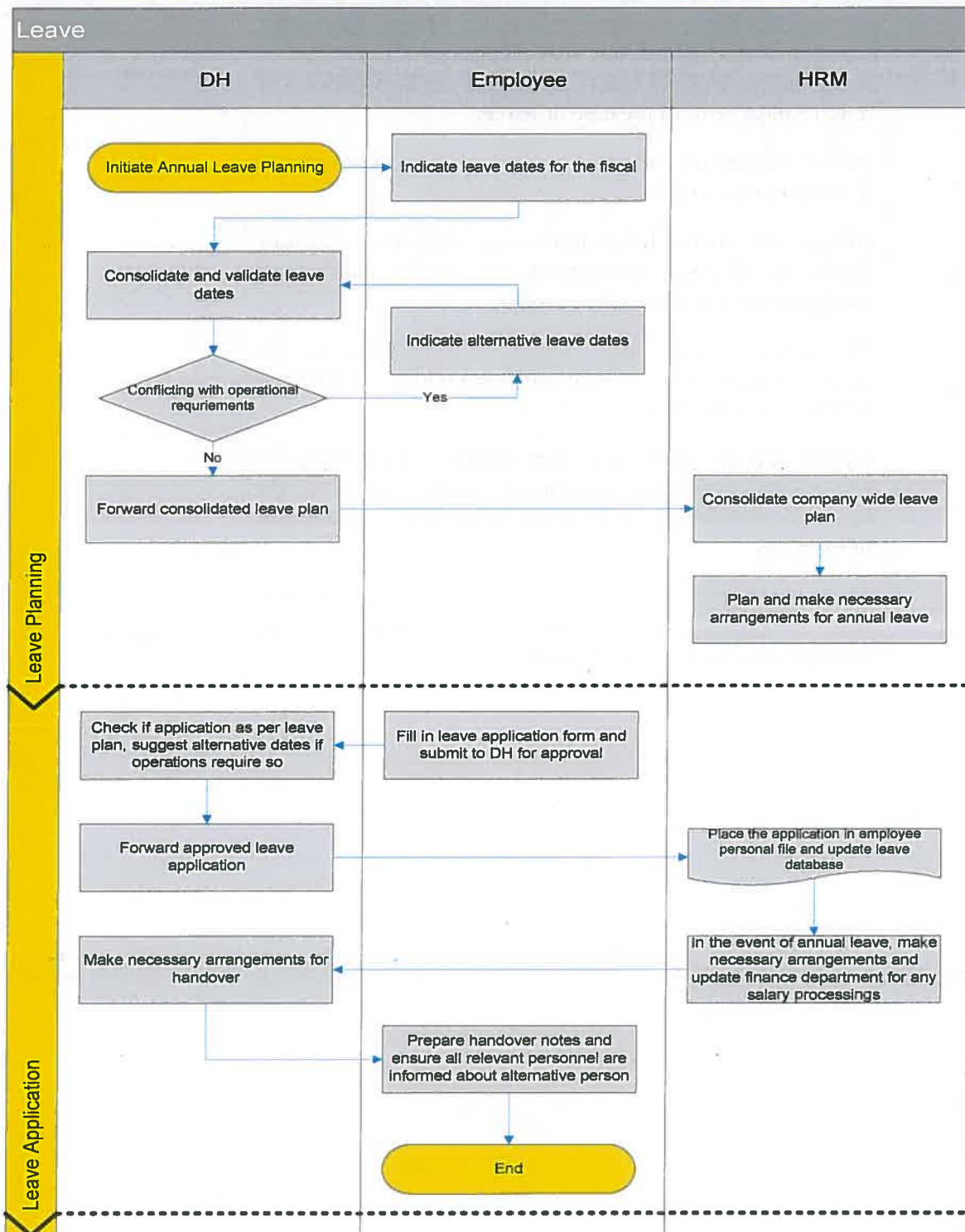
Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
Leave Planning		
1	Annual leave planning for the team members will be done by the Department Heads at the beginning of year	DH
2	Employees should indicate the dates that they would like to be on leave for the fiscal. For leaves such as study leave or Hajj leave etc, the employees should update the DH on the tentative dates as soon as they are aware of the same	Employee
3	Based on the leave dates submitted by the team members, consolidate and validate if dates of leave do not conflict operational requirements and request alternative dates from employees if required	DH
4	In the event the dates suggested are conflicting operational requirements, then provide alternative dates for leave.	Employee
5	Any changes in dates or cancellation of the leave must be intimated to the DH and the HRM at least a month in advance.	Employee
6	Make necessary arrangements for air travel as applicable based on the leave plans provided by the DHs.	HRM
Leave Application		
1	Fill in leave application form and submit the same to the DH for approval. In case of emergency leave or sick leave, on day of resuming work fill the application form and submit to the DH for approval.	DH
2	Review if the application is as per plan or if sufficient	DH



	justification and prior approval has been provided or taken.	
3	Approve the form and forward it to the Human Resources department for processing leave application. In case of annual leave, the DHs must forward the application form at least 15 days prior to the date of leave.	DH
4	Review application, update leave database and keep posted the employee on his/her new leave balances.	HRM
5	Forward the annual leave application form and necessary details to finance department for making necessary arrangements for leave salary payout.	HRM
6	For annual leave make necessary arrangements for employee travel ticket if applicable and update the DH and Employee on the same	HRM
7	Ensure that the alternative team member is arranged for performing necessary operational work and that the employee proceeding on leave has made sufficient handover of the tasks.	DH
8	Make necessary notes for handover of job tasks, and ensure that all relevant people are communicated with the alternative team member's details.	Employee



Figure 13 – Leave Planning and Application Cross Functional Process Map



Chapter 7. Visas

Introduction

Any expatriate intending to travel to Oman must have a valid visa. Certain general arrangements are facilitated by the HRM in obtaining visas for expatriates visiting DDC.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to employee visas, family visas, business travel visas etc.

Section 7.1. Employee Visa

- 1) The Human Resources department must obtain employment/ express visas as required for DDC's new expatriate employees. The PRO shall be responsible for obtaining any such visas. When hiring an expatriate employee and prior to applying for employee visa, the Human Resources department will obtain labor clearance.
- 2) The PRO should update the Human Resources department on a regular basis on changes in the visa acquiring procedures and formalities that need to be completed or documents needed prior to completion of employment visas.
- 3) The Human Resources department in consultation with the PRO must intimate the potential employee on documents required for visa processing and shall ensure that all required documents are ready for visa application.
- 4) The PRO shall coordinate with the ROP immigration department in obtaining employment visas.
- 5) The employment visa should be deposited at the airport by the PRO and a copy of visa along with the deposit slip should be provided to the Human Resources Department. The Human Resources department should send a copy of visa and deposit slip to the potential employee and advise him to carry the same while travelling to Oman.
- 6) Two years after the employee's entry into Oman and endorsement of visa, the PRO shall facilitate the visa renewal process by submitting necessary application forms and accompanying the employee to the ROP immigration department for visa renewals.

Section 7.2. Family Visa

- 1) DDC assists its employees on family status in arranging resident visas for dependents (includes spouse and children only). If the employee is provided with family status, the expenses for obtaining visas shall be borne by DDC.
- 2) In the event an employee wishes to bring his/her parents or other dependents such as brothers and sisters on family resident visa, DDC shall assist only in the application and obtaining of the visa, however all the expense related to the obtaining visa shall be borne by the employee.
- 3) If an employee wishes to bring any other family member or friends on visit visa, the same has to be approved by the respective DH and the HRM. An undertaking has to be provided by the employee to the Human Resource department stating that he/she shall be responsible for any acts or legal implications for the person he/she wishes to bring in. All expenses relate to obtaining

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such visas should be borne by the employee.

Section 7.3. Business Visa

- 1) Business visit visas are generally arranged for business visitors, suppliers, export customers etc. These visas permit a single entry for a stay of not more than 2 months in Oman and are cancelled on departure. No labor clearance is required for business visit visa. The business visa cannot be extended or renewed.
- 2) All requests for business visas should be approved by the DCEO and the CEO and routed to the Human Resources Department for processing.
- 3) The PRO shall obtain visit visas/ transit visas as required for DDC's guests or business associates invited to the Sultanate of Oman.
- 4) For outbound business visas or foreign travel visas, the requests should be made by the DHs and approved by the DCEO and the CEO. The Human Resources department shall facilitate in obtaining of the visas, however it is the responsibility of the concerned employee to submit required documents in a timely manner and attend any consulate interviews.



Chapter 8. Compensation and Benefits

Introduction

DDC intends to attract and retain qualified employees by maintaining a compensation system that is externally competitive and internally consistent. Periodically, through participation in surveys and/ or other sources for identifying trends and changes in the job market and determining adjustments required to maintain a competitive position.

Application

These guidelines cover all provisions and regulations relating to Basic Pay, Allowances and Benefits applicable to various grades of employees.

Section 8.1. Salary Administration

Article 8.1.1. Salary Structure

- 1) Salaries for all new hires shall be based on the job grade and remuneration structure applicable at the time of recruitment.
- 2) Any changes in salary for employees will be based on the existing remuneration structure of DDC.
- 3) The basic pay and various allowances will be in accordance with the parameters set from time to time by the Board of Directors.
- 4) Salary changes shall be at the discretion of DDC and may occur as a result of the following:
 - a) Increments after annual appraisal cycle
 - b) Changes in salary components due to promotions, re-designation, lateral movement or transfers.
 - c) Change in remuneration structure due to market correction or inflation
- 5) Salary increments will be effective from the date mentioned in the salary change letter.
- 6) Salary changes for employees in Grade 1 to Grade 3 shall be reviewed and approved by the Board of Directors.
- 7) Salary changes for employees in Grade 4 to Grade 9 will be reviewed and approved by the DCEO and signed off by the CEO.

Article 8.1.2. Disbursement of Salary

- 1) Salaries shall be paid via bank transfer to all staff on the 23rd of every month in arrears or before in case 23rd being a holiday. CEO/DCEO is authorized to decide the date of payment of salary.
- 2) Disbursement of salary shall cease in the event of:
 - a) Long term suspensions pending enquiry as per the suspension letter.



- b) On application for leave without pay followed by approval.
 - c) Unauthorized absence without intimation for 5 days.
- 3) Disbursement of dues in special circumstances such as completion of tenure by an employee either due to termination or resignation.
- a) All outstanding dues to the employee shall be after computation of deductions and/or End of Service Benefits, if any. Outstanding dues shall be either transferred to employee bank account or paid through cheques.
- 4) Pay advice shall be emailed to the employees address as per record or handed over at the time of relieving.

Section 8.2. Allowances and Benefits

Article 8.2.1. House Rent Allowance

- 1) The terms and conditions of employment for employees do not include the provision of accommodation, however, employees will be provided with House Rent Allowance to cover their housing expenses.
- 2) The house rent allowance covers expenses for utilities and other general housing expenses and they shall not be paid separately.
- 3) The house rent allowance paid to employees shall be based on the fixed salary structure and as per their position/ grade held at DDC.
- 4) Advance of six month's rent may be provided to employees, depending on the tenancy agreement. Employees requesting for advanced HRA should submit necessary documentation for receiving the same. Advance shall not exceed the house rent allowance of the employee.

Article 8.2.2. Transportation Allowance

- 1) Employees are provided with transportation allowance or company maintained car based on their position/grade held at DDC.
- 2) Employees in Grade 1 shall be entitled for a company maintained car subject to a maximum limit of RO 28,000.
- 3) Employees in Grade 2 shall be entitled for a company maintained card subject to a maximum limit of RO 23,000.
- 4) Employees between Grade 3 to Grade 9 are entitled to transportation allowance as per the fixed salary structure applicable to their position/grade held at DDC.

Article 8.2.3. Furnishing Allowance

- 1) DDC provides furnishing allowance to employees in grades 1 to 4 which covers both hard and soft furnishing expenses.



- 2) Furnishing allowance shall be payable to eligible employee only once during their employment with DDC.
- 3) Furnishing allowance will be amortized over a period of 36 months, in the event the employee who has availed furnishing allowance resigns from his duty, he must repay the furnishing allowance on a pro-rata basis.
- 4) For availing the furnishing allowance, employees should make a request in writing to the HRM. The HRM will coordinate with the Finance Department to release the furnishing allowance.
- 5) The table below shows furnishing allowance entitlement provided to DDC employees:

Job Grade	Entitlement (RO)
1	5,000
2	5,000
3	3,000
4	2,000

Article 8.2.4. Dependents of Employees

- 5) DDC provides various benefits to dependents of employees.
- 6) Dependents include:
 - a) An employee's spouse who is residing with the employee in Oman and not employed by any other organization in Oman.
 - b) A child, step child or adopted child residing with an employee in Oman and is under age of 18.
- 7) Any policy or guideline outlining benefits or allowances refer only to aforesaid dependents. Any allowances or benefits provided to dependent children will be subject to a maximum of two children.
- 8) An employee's spouse who is on employee's dependent visa must not be employed with any other organization unless an employment visa is received from the employing organization.

Article 8.2.5. Telephone Allowance

- 1) Employees shall be provided with telephone allowance based on the nature of job and requirement. The necessity for the telephone allowance shall be determined by the DH and approval shall be at the discretion of the DCEO/CEO.
- 2) DDC shall provide phone devices to employees between Grade 1 and Grade 3.
- 3) CEO/DCEO shall decide on the model and replacement timings of the phone devices to be given to the eligible employees and the allowance as per the packages available.



- 4) The entitlement for the telephone allowance is as per the following:

Job Grade	Entitlement (RO)
1	Monthly allowance of OR 79.500. Official International calls paid on actual.
2	Monthly allowance of OR 79.500. Official International calls paid on actual.
3	Monthly allowance of RO 49.500

- 5) Authorize CEO/DCEO to decide a suitable allowance and phone set on a need basis for other employees.

Article 8.2.6. Education Assistance to Children

- DDC provides education assistance for employees in grade 1 to 4 to cover the cost of their education. The entitlement shall be for a maximum of two children, up to the age of 18.
- The following table shows children education allowance provided to DDC employees:

Job Grade	Allowance per child (RO)
1	4,000
2	3,000
3	2,000
4	1,000

Article 8.2.7. Air Passage

- DDC provides business class air passage to employees in Grade 1 and 2 and economy class air passage for their dependants.
- Employees between Grade 3 to Grade 9 are provided with economy class air passage.
- All expatriate employees and their dependants (if applicable) are entitled to one-way air ticket from the nearest international airport to their hometown to Oman upon joining.
- All expatriate employees shall be provided with round trip air ticket or an equivalent amount of cash after completion of each year of service at DDC (from Oman to nearest international airport to their hometown).
- On termination of employment all expatriate employees and their dependants (if applicable) are entitled to one-way air ticket to travel from Oman to the nearest international airport to their hometown.

Article 8.2.8. Insurance

- DDC employees are insured under the company Group Life Insurance. The policy covers events such as Natural Death, and Permanent Total Disability and Permanent Partial Disability in line with normal practices. DDC shall provide life insurance cover of 36 basic salaries. However, if employee chooses not to opt for group life cover, DDC may provide a yearly allowance on account of life Insurance as given below. However, the company does not hold any responsibility in case the employee fails to take insurance policy or take policy with insufficient coverage.



Grade	Allowance
1	1,000
2	900
3	630
4	450
5	215
6	145
7	90
8	65
9	40

- 2) The payments and processing of claims will be as per the terms and conditions and exclusions of the insurance policy. The scheme intends supporting employee/employee's family by providing certain financial benefits in case of death or permanent disability.
- 3) All employees and their dependents shall be covered under a medical insurance scheme in line with local and best practices as approved by the DCEO and the CEO.
- 4) All medical facilities and reimbursements shall be as per the subscribed medical insurance scheme. All excluded sickness as per the medical insurance policy shall be borne by the employee. The detailed medical insurance scheme will be provided to the employee after joining the company on request.

Article 8.2.9. Duty Travel and Accommodation

- 1) An employee who is authorized to travel on DDC business will be compensated with reasonable expenses. Duty travel also includes travel for official training outside Oman.
- 2) Concerned DHs are responsible for authorizing the duty travel and expenses of employees in their Department. In case of DHs, the DCEO and the CEO are responsible for authorizing the duty travel and expenses.
- 3) Duty travel and anticipated relative expenses must be authorized in advance on a travel authorization and expense claim form signed by the DH. For employees in Grade 3 and above the expenses must be authorized by the DCEO and approved by the CEO.
- 4) All travel is to be undertaken in the most economical and practical means available. The HRM will ensure making appropriate arrangements for the flight tickets and accommodation as necessary.
- 5) Board Members and employees in grade 1 to 2 are eligible for business class air travel, whilst all other employees are eligible for economy class air travel.
- 6) The employees are paid transportation allowance or company car, which is deemed to cover all business related travel within the local business area. Also, the employees are entitled for a travel allowance of RO 10 per day for travel to Duqm.
- 7) The employees in Grade 3 and below are entitled for a mileage allowance of RO 0.050 per km



in case they use their own vehicle for business purposes as the case may be depending on the location base of the employee. The reimbursement is made through expense vouchers on a monthly basis, approved by the respective DH.

- 8) All employees attending DDC approved training or business trips shall receive compensation as follows:

Countries of Travel	Grade 1 & 2	Grade 3 & 4	Others
UAE & other GCC	200	150	100
Other countries	250	200	150
Within Oman	Compensation based on actual expenses		

- 9) If a foreign country entity or another authority or DDC pays some or all the living expenses of the employee or grants him a financial grant, the allowance shall be paid as per the following:

A	50% of the allowance in case accommodation is provided
B	25% of the allowance if food and accommodation is provided

- 10) When employees from different job grades travel together within official delegation representing the company, the travelling class shall be determined pursuant to the highest grade.
- 11) In case of an extraordinary expense abroad, the company shall compensate employee for the costs borne by him against the payment documents (entry visas, departure taxation etc.)
- 12) Employees assigned for an official mission abroad whether for work or for training purposes are entitled to air tickets or 75% of their value in case the employee uses a private means of transport.

Section 8.3. End of Service Benefits

Introduction

Severance pay is an entitlement that may be payable to an employee of DDC upon termination of employment.

Application

These guidelines are applicable to all employees of DDC.

Article 8.3.1. PASI for Omani Nationals

- 1) Omani Employees are covered under the PASI are entitled to benefits as per the PASI law.
 - a) All new employees will be registered under PASI and will be provided with the PASI registration number.
 - b) New employees who were employed previously with a different organization should provide their PASI registration number and complete all formalities for transferring the registration.



- c) The PASI contribution will be as per the PASI law.
- d) Employees will be provided with PASI cancellation paper or any other relevant documentation required for transferring or claiming the benefits at the end of service with DDC. Employees should coordinate with PASI for claiming or transferring the benefit amount.

Article 8.3.2. End of Service Benefits for Non Omani Employees

- 1) Employees that are not covered under the PASI are entitled to End of Service Benefits in the form of a gratuity payment upon termination.
 - a) Employees are eligible for 1 month of basic salary for each year of service completed with DDC.
 - b) The employee will be entitled to a pro rata amount for the gratuity, calculated at the last basic wage rate and proportionate to the period of service that year.

Section 8.4. Personal Loan

Article 8.4.1. Personal Loan

- 1) Employees shall be allowed to obtain loan up to a maximum of one Basic Salary. The loan is repayable within one year. Employees can only apply for loan again once they fully repaid the earlier loan.
- 2) Only employees who have completed one year with the company are entitled for personal loan.

Chapter 9. Discipline

Section 9.1. Employee Discipline

Introduction

Employee performance and behavior is expected to contribute toward the achievement of the organization's goals and objectives. When an employee's performance or behavior is unsatisfactory, corrective action must be taken. Corrective action will follow the process of progressive discipline when the situation is a result of inappropriate behavior or unsatisfactory performance when the employee has the ability to perform at an acceptable level but chooses not to do so.

Application

These guidelines apply to all employees of DDC and in-sourced employees.

Article 9.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) Discipline should not be viewed as punishment, but as a method of correcting a problem.



- 2) The DH must inform an employee of the standards of particular conduct that apply in the workplace.
- 3) An employee may be disciplined for breaching standards of general conduct or standards of particular conduct.
- 4) Disciplinary investigation and action must be taken within five days of accusing an employee of a violation.
- 5) Disciplinary action should only be taken after an employee has an opportunity to provide an explanation of his/her behavior. A meeting should be held with the employee for this purpose.
- 6) Prior to any disciplinary action taking place, an employee must receive 24 hours advance notice of a meeting if:
 - a) It may result in suspension, discharge or dismissal; and
 - b) A letter of suspension or dismissal is delivered and the issue is to be discussed with the employee.
- 7) It is inappropriate to allow other employees to witness the discipline of a co-worker. Interviews involving discipline must be scheduled in advance and held in private.
- 8) The DH should take notes of all discussions and meetings. Disciplinary action should not be unduly delayed.
- 9) The progression of disciplinary measures for DDC is as follows:
 - a) Verbal warning;
 - b) Written reprimand;
 - c) One day suspension;
 - d) Five day suspension;
 - e) Suspension up to three months;
 - f) Termination.
- 10) Incidents of serious misconduct (such as assault, theft or serious insubordination) may warrant serious disciplinary measures, and steps of the progressive discipline process may be by-passed on the advice of Management and HRM. Misconduct that occurs early in the employment, and/or occurs in a short period of employment is viewed as serious misconduct.
- 11) The progressive discipline process may be accelerated for a temporary or in-sourced employee resulting in dismissal without all the steps having been taken. For example, a temporary employee has an employment contract for three months. During the first week of employment, the employee misses two days of work without notice or explanation. Given the short-term nature of this employment contract and the early emergence of problems, it is reasonable for the DH to consider and recommend dismissal.
- 12) Disciplinary steps may be repeated on the advice of the HRM in cases involving significant mitigating factors.
- 13) DHs should review the authorities for imposing discipline. If the employee fails to correct the behavior, the discipline imposed increases with each incident as follows:



a) Step 1: Verbal Reprimand

- i) The employee's DH gives verbal reprimands. The reprimand must be given in private and must address the area of concern including the possible outcome if the behavior is not corrected. The DH will identify the gap between the desired behavior and the problematic behavior. The employee is given an opportunity to provide his or her version of the events. The supervisor should take notes on the discussion that took place, as they may be needed if it is necessary to move on to the next step. These notes should be forwarded to HRM to place in employee personal file.

b) Step 2: Written Reprimand

- i) The employee's DH gives written reprimands. The DH is encouraged to consult with HRM before proceeding. The letter should include actions that may be taken if the inappropriate behavior continues. The supervisor schedules a meeting with the employee to discuss the problem. The supervisor will identify the gap between the desired behavior and the problematic behavior. The employee is given an opportunity to provide his or her version of the events. The letter should be given in private and a copy is placed in the employee's personnel file.

c) Step 3: Disciplinary Suspension and Non Disciplinary Suspension

- i) Only the CEO and the DCEO have authority to suspend employees. The DCEO and the CEO, upon reviewing the recommendation of the DH, administers disciplinary suspensions. The DH makes the recommendation for suspension after looking into the matter and discussing the problem with the employee. Prior to any meeting to discuss the problem, the employee must be given 24 hours notice. Suspensions are applied progressively, but should be appropriate to the seriousness of the misconduct. The first suspension is for one day. If this does not correct the behavior and repetition occurs, the next incident would result in a five day suspension, and then a suspension up to three months or termination would be considered in cases of misdemeanor. HRM should be consulted for advice on any matters where a suspension is being considered.
- ii) The DCEO and the CEO do not give a disciplinary suspension where they feel an extensive investigation is required. Where the DCEO and the CEO feel that an employee must be removed from the work site to properly conduct an investigation, a suspension pending investigation is required.
- iii) Suspension pending investigation can be up to three months, during which the employee is deprived of his gross salary for the first month and is paid half his gross salary in the second and third month. During investigation if the employee has been acquitted, he/she shall be reinstated and the previously suspended salary shall be paid to him. In the event the employee is proven guilty, he shall be terminated from the services.



d) Step 4: Termination

- i) Only the CEO has the authority to dismiss an employee from a position in DDC which shall be in consultation with the DCEO . The DH makes a recommendation for dismissal after looking into the matter and hearing the employee's explanation. Prior to any meeting to discuss the problem, the employee must be given 24 hours notice. The DCEO , upon reviewing the recommendation of the DH and previous reprimand, gives the employee an opportunity to provide a written submission and makes recommendations to the CEO.
- 14) In determining the appropriate disciplinary step to address an employee's misconduct, the DH should consider factors including:
 - a) The employee's length of service;
 - b) The employee's past discipline record;
 - c) The seriousness of the misconduct;
 - d) The employee's explanation; and
 - e) Any other pertinent facts.
 - 15) For a temporary employee or an employee on probation, the progressive discipline process indicated above may be accelerated.
 - 16) Written reprimands, letters of suspension, letters of demotion and letters of termination are copied to an employee's personnel file.
 - 17) The denial of an employee's performance increment is not part of the progressive discipline process. An employee's increment may be denied if an employee's performance is poor.

Article 9.1.2. Categories of Violation

Violations of DDC Rules and Unacceptable Personal Conduct are divided into four categories; A, B, C & D. The violations categorized here under are indicative of the severity of offences and are not limited to the situations described.

CATEGORY A

- 1) Posting, altering, tempering or removing any matter on the bulletin boards or DDC property without permission.
- 2) Collecting contributions, soliciting for any purpose whatsoever, or distribution of any printed or written materials of any kind during official working hours.
- 3) Pretending to be ill.
- 4) Failure to immediately report a personal accident or injury occurring whilst working.
- 5) Inattentive, inefficient performance of duties.
- 6) Intentionally reducing production or negligence causing low quality.
- 7) Failing to abide by safety instructions for staff and workplace.
- 8) Any misconduct similar to the ones mentioned above.



CATEGORY B

- 1) Causing injury to another person due to carelessness, negligence or horseplay.
- 2) Abusive, obscene, immoral, or indecent language or behavior.
- 3) Using DDC time, materials or equipment to do unauthorized work.
- 4) Impugning the reputation of other employees or client personnel.
- 5) Conduct on the job, which is contrary to morality and decency.
- 6) Leaving the work place during work hours without permission or without notifying the superior.
- 7) Holding of, participating in, or attending any unauthorized meeting during work hours.
- 8) Tampering with, or careless, neglect or unauthorized use of DDC property, materials or equipment.
- 9) Negligence in performing duties causing risks for staff safety or health or damage for material or equipment.
- 10) Breach of health requirements issued by competent authorities related to work.
- 11) Absence from duty without notification or justified reason for 5 days.
- 12) Any misconduct similar to the ones mentioned above.

CATEGORY C

- 1) Fighting on DDC property. Threatening, intimidating, or coercing another employee, or other persons, by word or act.
- 2) Insubordination or gross disrespect of superior.
- 3) Unjustified refusal to testify or be witness for DDC in any civil, administrative grievance or any official DDC investigation.
- 4) Refusing to be searched upon leaving work place.
- 5) Refusal to perform assigned work in a timely manner.
- 6) Refusing to implement instructions related to work.
- 7) Smoking in the DDC premises.
- 8) Violation or disobedience of normal orders pertaining to duties.
- 9) Giving company information to any person or press without management approval.
- 10) Falsely claim to principles or colleagues leading to suspension of work.
- 11) Any misconduct similar to the ones mentioned above



CATEGORY D

- 1) All misconducts as defined in Oman Labor Law Article 40.
- 2) Attempting to inflict bodily harm, fighting with other employees, or otherwise assaulting an employee, causing riots, or anyone else on DDC property.
- 3) Sabotage, destruction, or vandalism, of DDC property, materials or equipment.
- 4) Maliciously committing an act resulting in a serious loss to DDC.
- 5) Repeatedly disobeying the instructions of the superior.
- 6) Absence from duty without notification for more than 10 non-consecutive days or more than 7 consecutive days during a year without any justified reason.
- 7) Being convicted of a crime affecting honor, honesty, or morality.
- 8) Use of fraud, including misrepresentation of credentials, qualifications, and previous employment for the purpose of obtaining work with DDC.
- 9) Falsification of DDC records. Providing false or misleading information to DDC.
- 10) Divulging trade secrets, proprietary information, or confidential information belonging to DDC.
- 11) Soliciting, offering, or accepting bribes or anything of value in exchange for services.
- 12) Stealing DDC property or property of another employee.
- 13) Gross misuse of DDC property, including computers, telephone equipment and telephone connections, or personal property of other employees.
- 14) Possession of a dangerous weapon while on DDC property.
- 15) Bringing unauthorized objects or doing business at work place.
- 16) Accepting kickbacks or financial favors from suppliers or Clients.
- 17) Reporting to work under the influence of alcohol/or other similar narcotic substances.
- 18) Doing or inciting illegal strikes or protests.
- 19) Intentionally cheating customers on bill prices and also receiving money from them without giving bills.
- 20) Any misconduct similar to the ones mentioned above.

Article 9.1.3. Violations Not Listed

In case that a staff has committed a violation which is not listed in categories A,B,C & D below, the department heads should coordinate with HRM to add the violation and suggest a suitable penalty.

Article 9.1.4. Penalties for Violation

The following schedule outlines the ramification of not complying with DDC work rules and unacceptable personal conduct:



Category	1 st Time	2 nd Time	3 rd Time	4 th Time
A	Verbal Warning	Written Warning	Suspension	Termination
B	Written Warning	Suspension	Termination	
C	Suspension	Termination		
D	Termination			

Table 14: Procedure for Discipline

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	The DH informs employees of the standards of particular conduct which apply to the workplace.	DH
2	When standards of conduct are not met, the supervisor initiates disciplinary action. The supervisor documents disciplinary action on the disciplinary action record sheet (<i>Annexure 9: Disciplinary Action Record Sheet</i>).	DH
3	To determine the appropriate course of action, the supervisor may contact HRM and ensures that any investigation or action is taken within five working days of accusing the employee of a violation.	DH
4	The supervisor holds a private interview with the employee before disciplinary action is taken (and provides the employee with 24 hours advance notice of the meeting) to do the following: - Ensure the employee is aware of the problem; - Give the employee an opportunity to explain the circumstances surrounding the unsatisfactory performance or the breach of conduct; - Determine if the employee's actions were merely a result of misunderstanding directions, or if the employee wilfully broke rules of conduct; and - Explain to the employee how management is considering dealing with the misconduct.	DH/Employee
5	Depending on the nature of the misconduct, the supervisor may speak to witnesses	DH
6	The supervisor makes notes of the interviews. These notes are forwarded to the HRM	DH
7	Notes are placed in the employee's personnel file in a confidential manner for future reference should the behaviour continue.	HRM
8	After taking into account all information, including the employee's version of events and the advice of Management and HRM, the DH determines the appropriate level of discipline (if any).	DH
9	All discipline includes: - An explanation of the behaviour for which the employee is being reprimanded; - An explanation of how to correct the behaviour; - An explanation of further action that will be taken if the employee fails to correct the behaviour; and - An explanation to the employee that all disciplinary letters, including reprimands and suspensions, are placed on the employee's personnel file.	DH
10	If the violation continues, the supervisor may prepare a written reprimand. The supervisor hand delivers this letter to the employee. A copy is placed in the	DH



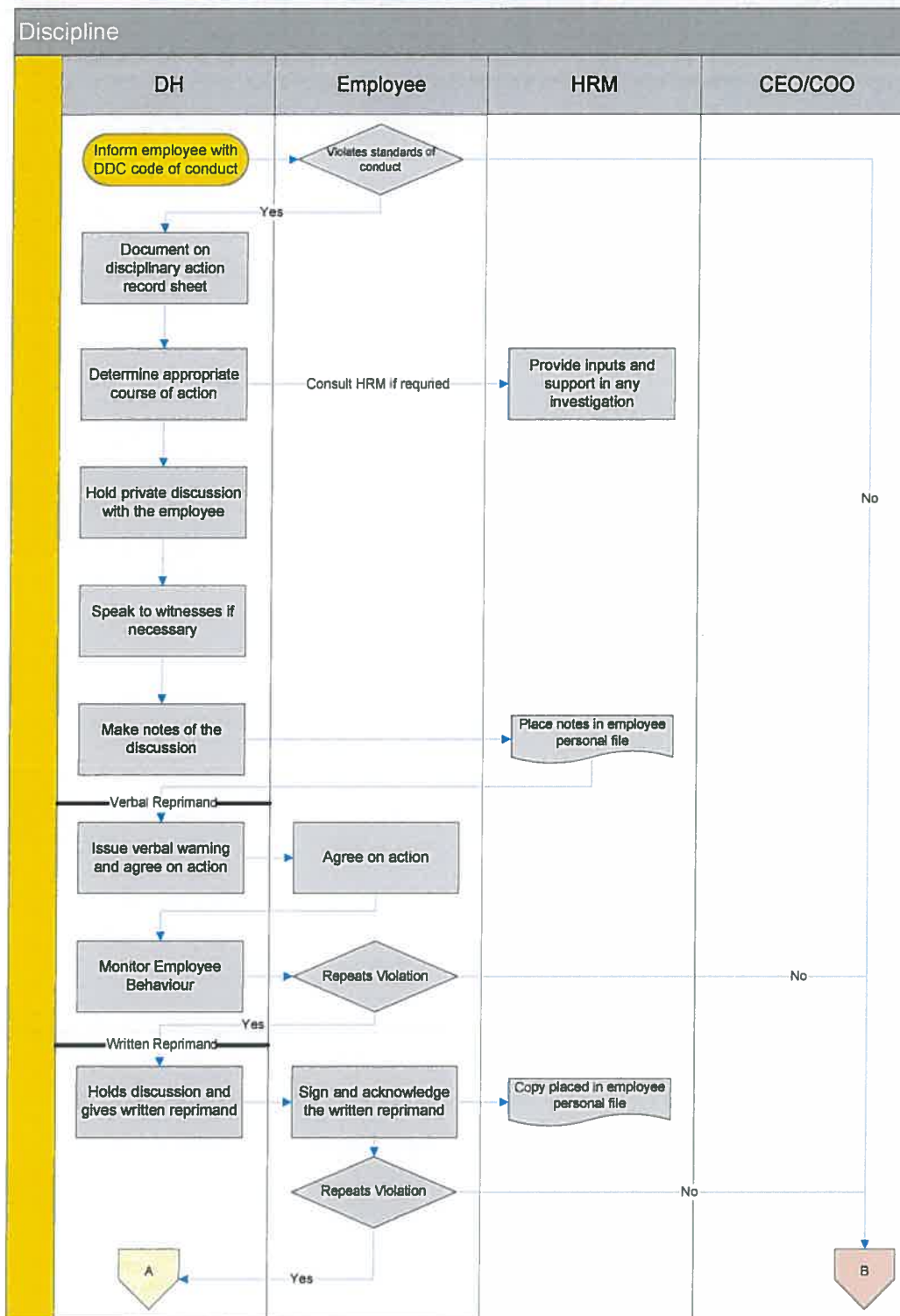
	employee's personnel file	
11	Where a disciplinary suspension is the next step in the progressive discipline procedure, the supervisor must: - Consult with Management and HRM; and - If warranted by the investigation, prepare a report for the CEO/ DCEO and recommend disciplinary suspension. The report must include the employee's explanation.	DH
12	If the CEO/ DCEO accepts the recommendation for suspension, he/she signs the letter of suspension.	CEO/ DCEO
13	Draft the letter of suspension	HRM
14	The HRM hand delivers this letter to the employee. A copy is placed on the employee's personnel file.	HRM
15	CEO/ DCEO may consider terminating an employee as the final step in progressive discipline, or as a result of one act of serious misconduct, on recommendation from the DH. As much information as possible should be included in the recommendation to ensure the CEO/ DCEO is making an informed decision. HRM must be consulted in situations where dismissal is being considered.	CEO/ DCEO
16	The CEO/ DCEO reviews the request for termination. The following points are examined during this process: - Does the seriousness or persistence of the problem warrant dismissal (i.e., misconduct such as theft, fraud, insubordination, dishonesty or progression of lesser but cumulative issues)? - What are the DDC's rules for dealing with the particular offence? Have these rules been followed? - Are there precedents for dealing with similar incidents and it is in line with Oman Labor Law? - Was it made clear to the employee that this offence may result in dismissal? - What is the length of the employee's service? - What is the employee's performance like and are performance appraisals on file? - Was the employee given a chance to provide an explanation or his/her version of the events? - Are there any mitigating factors (i.e., remorse, extreme stress, illness)?	CEO/ DCEO
17	The CEO/ DCEO advises the employee in writing of the recommendation for termination. The letter must contain the reasons for the recommended termination and clearly outline that the employee has five days in which to make a written submission on his/her behalf. Employees are not required to attend work during this five day period and continue to receive pay.	CEO/ DCEO
18	After reviewing all of the information, including the written submission (if provided) and the advice of HRM, the CEO/ DCEO determines if termination is appropriate. The CEO/ DCEO consults with HRM, through HRM informs the employee in writing of his/her termination from the DDC	CEO/ DCEO
19	The letter of termination should clearly state the reasons for the termination, why further employment cannot continue and that termination of the said position is effective immediately.	HRM
20	The HRM hand delivers this letter of termination to the employee. Employee	HRM

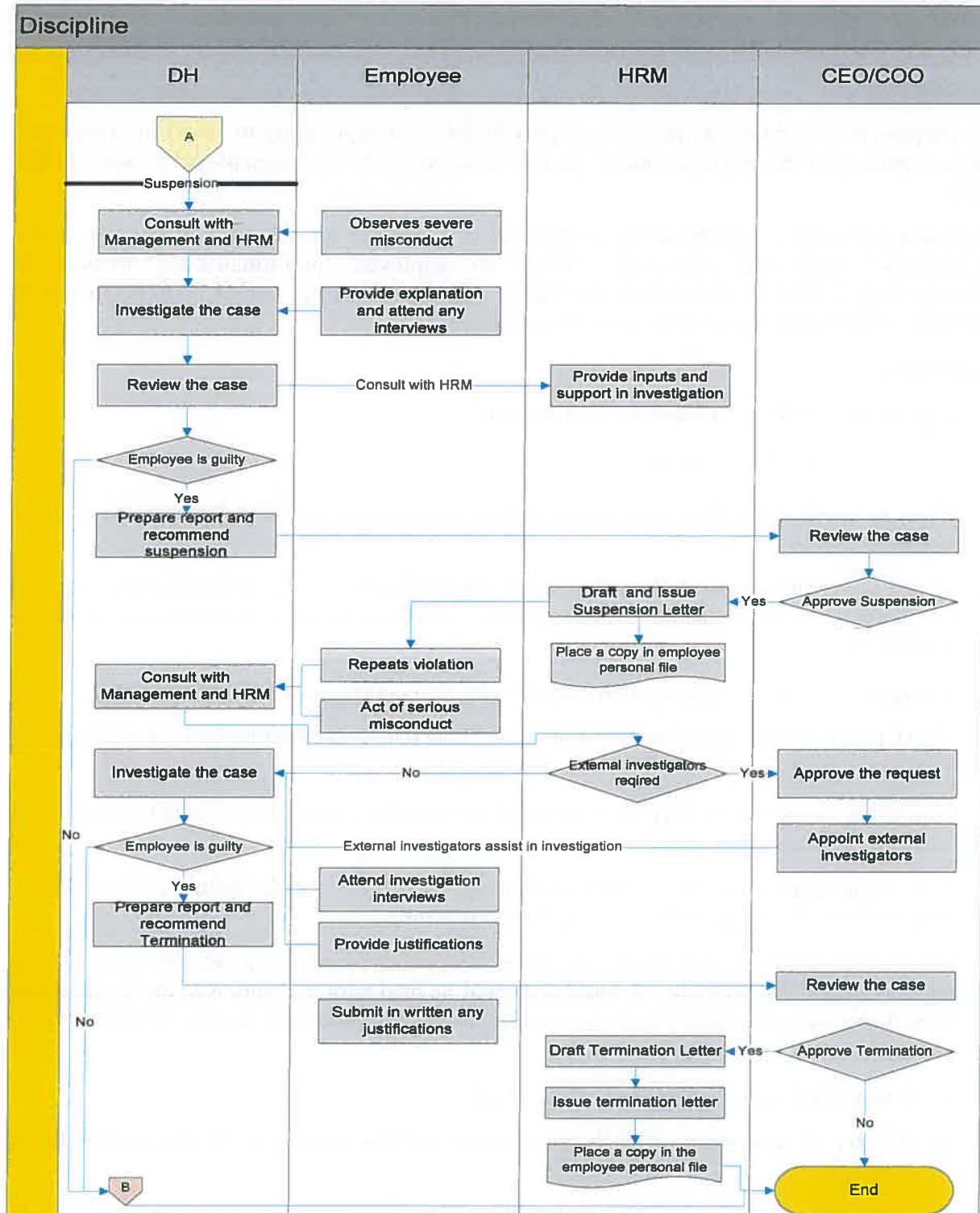


	will be given all opportunities to present his case prior to termination.	
21	The letter of termination is copied to the employee's personnel file and to the department for calculating End of Service benefits.	HRM
22	A copy of the letter of termination is hand delivered or faxed to the appropriate labour authority's office if required.	HRM



Figure 14: Discipline Cross Functional Process Map





Section 9.2. Employees on Probation

Introduction

The purpose of a probationary period is to provide DDC an opportunity to assess the suitability and competency of the employee and to provide an opportunity for the employee to adapt to the work.

Employee performance and behavior is expected to contribute toward the achievement of the organization's goals and objectives. When an employee's performance or behavior is unsatisfactory, corrective action must be taken. If an employee is unable meet performance standards, termination on probation may be considered.

Application

These guidelines apply to all employees on probation .

Article 9.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) When an employee is first appointed to he/she is placed on probation for a period of three months.
- 2) An employee who is appointed to a position that has the same duties as his/her previous position will not serve an additional probationary period. This does not apply to trainees or temporary employees.
- 3) An employee may be terminated on probation for misconduct, unsuitability or incompetence.
- 4) The DH must inform an employee on probation of the standards of particular conduct that apply in the workplace.
- 5) Employees on probation may be disciplined for breaching standards of general conduct or standards of particular conduct.
- 6) It is inappropriate to allow other employees to witness the discipline of a co-worker. Interviews involving discipline must be held in private.
- 7) Disciplinary action should only be taken after the employee has an opportunity to provide an explanation for the behavior. A meeting should be held with the employee for this purpose. Prior to any such disciplinary meeting taking place, an employee must receive 24 hours advance notice if:
 - a) It may result in suspension or discharge; and/
 - b) A letter of suspension or discharge is given and this issue is to be discussed with the employee.
- 8) Discipline should be applied progressively. The progressive discipline process may be accelerated for an employee on probation resulting in termination on probation without all the progressive discipline steps having been taken.

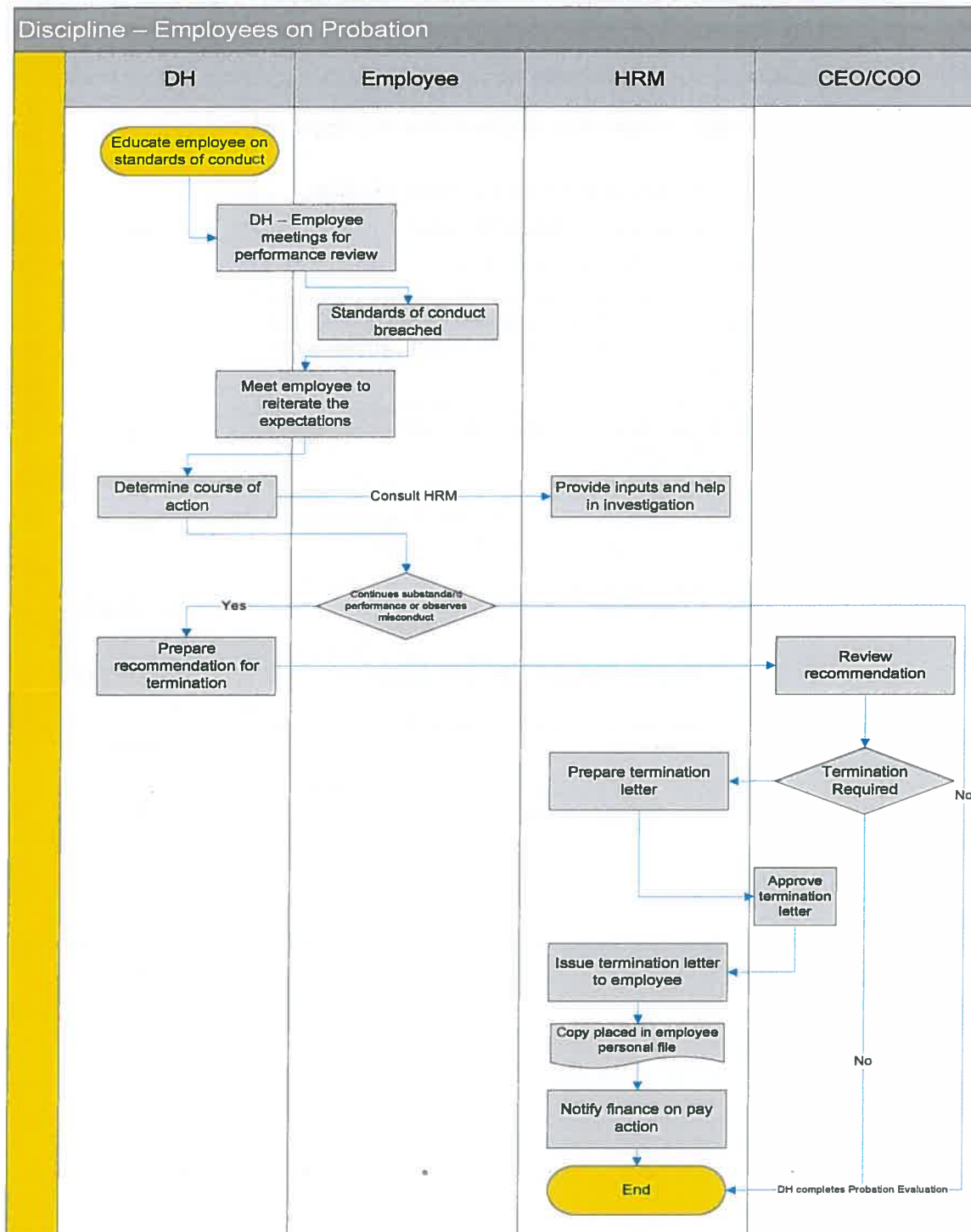


Table 15: Procedure for Discipline - Employees on Probation

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	The DH informs an employee on probation of the standards of particular conduct which apply to the workplace. The DH meets regularly with an employee on probation to review the employee's performance and management expectations.	DH
2	When standards of conduct are breached or if any concerns (i.e. performance, attendance, attitude and/or ability) arise during the employee's period of probation, the DH initiates corrective action. The DH meets with the employee in order to: - Explain the areas where the employee's performance is deficient; - Explain how the employee can correct performance; - Set the time limits for the corrective action; and - Explain that if the employee's performance does not meet the required standard, the manager may apply discipline for misconduct, and may consider rejection on probation for misconduct, unsuitability or incompetence.	DH
3	To determine the appropriate course of action, the DH contacts HRM and ensures that any investigation or action is taken within five working days of accusing the employee of a violation.	DH
4	If the employee's performance continues to be sub-standard the DH may recommend termination on probation. The DH prepares the recommendation and all supporting documentation for the CEO/ DCEO 's signature	DH
5	The CEO/DCEO reviews the recommendation and supporting documentation to determine if dismissal is appropriate.	CEO/ DCEO
6	If termination on probation is deemed to be appropriate, the CEO/ DCEO notifies the HRM of the recommendation to terminate on probation.	CEO/ DCEO
7	The HRM prepares the termination letter, gets it signed from the CEO and issues the letter to the concerned employee.	HRM
8	The HRM notifies the appropriate pay action to the finance department and places the termination letter on employee's personal file.	HRM



Figure 15: Discipline for Employees on Probation Cross Functional Process Map



Section 9.3. Suspension Pending Investigation

Introduction

DDC may investigate allegations of incompetence or misconduct of an employee.

Application

These guidelines apply to all employees at DDC.

Article 9.3.1. Guidelines

- 1) DDC can suspend an employee up to three months pending investigation. CEO/ DCEO shall be the authority for suspending an employee for pending investigation. A suspension pending investigation is imposed when an employee is alleged to be guilty of misconduct or incompetence and the DH considers it desirable to remove the employee in order to investigate the allegations.
- 2) Suspension pending investigation is considered when:
 - a) An employee's continued attendance in the workplace may hinder the investigation;
 - b) The employee's continued attendance presents a risk to the employee or others; or
 - c) When the alleged actions interfere with the objectives of the Department, or the Company, either by damage to reputation or otherwise.
- 3) The CEO/ DCEO may suspend an employee without pay for first month and then with half the pay for the next two months. However, if the employee is acquitted he shall be reimbursed with the deducted pay.
- 4) The total period of suspension pending investigation may not exceed three months.
- 5) An employee on suspension pending investigation must be available for interviews throughout the entire suspension period. The employee is responsible for providing contact information to his/her DH and the HRM.

Table 16: Procedure for Suspension Pending Investigation

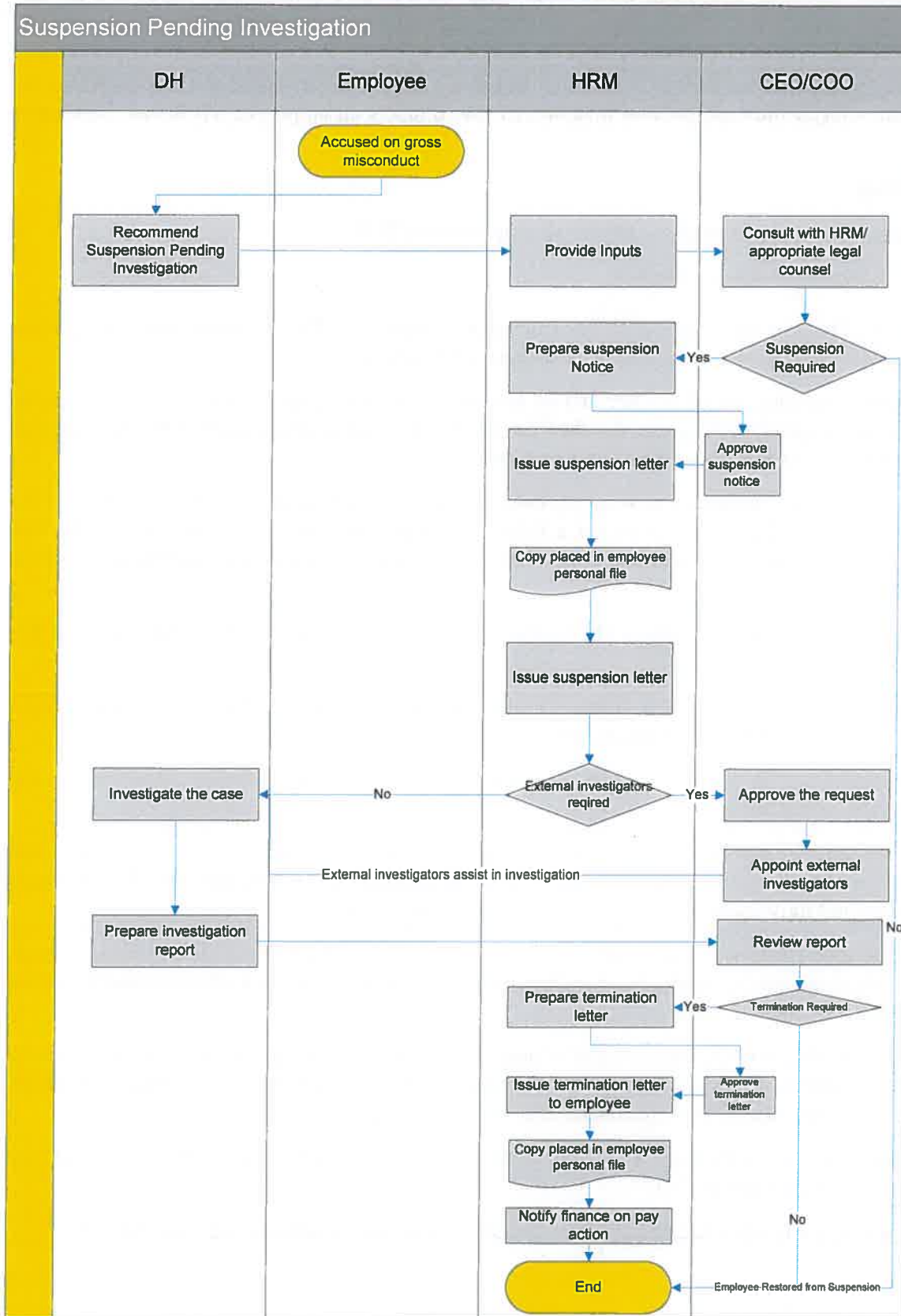
Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	When an employee is accused of misconduct, the employee's DH may recommend suspension pending investigation to the CEO/ DCEO . Supporting rationale and information must accompany this recommendation.	DH
2	The CEO/ DCEO consults with HRM or appropriate legal counsel to determine if a suspension pending investigation is appropriate.	CEO/ DCEO
3	If the CEO/ DCEO decides that a suspension is in order, the CEO/ DCEO informs the HRM in writing for notice of suspension.	CEO/ DCEO
4	The HRM issues notice of suspension to the employee and places a copy of the letter on the employee's personnel file.	HRM
5	The DH along with HRM investigates the alleged misconduct or incompetence as quickly and thoroughly as possible. External investigator(s) may be sought for (in cases where fraud is suspected) to investigate the case.	DH



6	The investigator(s) must complete the investigation and write a report no later than one week before the suspension expires. The investigation report is usually provided to the CEO/ DCEO .	Investigator(s)
7	If the CEO/ DCEO believes the employee is guilty of misconduct or incompetence, the CEO/ DCEO will determine, in consultation with HRM or a legal counsel, the appropriate discipline to apply, if any. If the CEO/ DCEO determines that the employee is innocent of misconduct or incompetence, the CEO/ DCEO terminates the suspension and re-instates the employee	CEO/ DCEO
8	If the employee is found guilty, the CEO/ DCEO communicate to the HRM about the employee termination	CEO/ DCEO
9	The HRM prepares, gets it signed by the CEO/ DCEO and issues the termination letter to the employee	HRM



Figure 16: Suspension Pending Investigation Cross Functional Process Map



Section 9.4. Investigations

Introduction

When an employee's conduct is called into question, DDC has the right and responsibility to investigate alleged incompetence or misconduct that impacts an employee's role and DDC as a whole.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees at DDC.

Article 9.4.1. Guidelines

- 1) All allegations or suspicions of theft or misappropriation of DDC resources must be reported to the DHs who advise the HRM to take appropriate action.
- 2) An employee must notify his/her DH of any on- or off-duty conduct for which he or she is being investigated or charged under the Criminal Code, or any other legislation that may require the employee to appear before a Judge or Court.
- 3) All allegations of harassing or bullying behavior must be dealt with as soon as it comes to the attention of the DH, whether or not a formal complaint is made. The approach of the DH depends on the nature of the allegation. The DH may wish to consult with the HRM as to how to proceed.
- 4) Problem solving or mediation is always the preferred option; however, from time to time, this is not feasible.
- 5) Employees whose conduct is being investigated have the right to due process including a thorough, fair and timely investigation.
- 6) If an employee is called to attend as a witness to an allegation, his/her attendance at the interview is mandatory.
- 7) All individuals interviewed during an investigation must keep their knowledge of events and of the investigation confidential. Confidential information must not be shared with individuals who are not duly authorized to have access to the information.
- 8) In most investigations, there will be two individuals representing DDC at all meetings. Persons investigating an incident must take notes during each meeting. Each set of notes must be signed and dated by the note taker.
- 9) In any investigation the comments of witnesses may ultimately be disclosed to the complainant and respondent. Investigation reports will keep the names of witnesses confidential; however, ultimate disclosure of the information may be legally required.
- 10) An employee on suspension pending investigation must be available for interviews throughout the entire suspension period.
- 11) Approval of the CEO/ DCEO must be sought prior to appointing external investigators.



Section 9.5. Dispute Resolution

Introduction

Disputes between DDC and employees are resolved through the grievance process.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees at DDC.

Article 9.5.1. Guidelines

- 1) The grievance guidelines allows the parties to settle disputes that arise regarding the interpretation or application of a provision of an act, policy or regulation, direction or other instrument made or issued by DDC dealing with the terms or conditions of employment, a provision of disciplinary action, dismissal and letters of discipline.
- 2) Employees present their grievances personally to the HRM in writing.
- 3) The grievance process for employees is a three level process.
 - **Level 1**
Usually the employee's direct supervisor or a person designated as the First Level grievance respondent
 - **Level 2**
Usually the HRM or any other designated person by the CEO/ DCEO .
 - **Level 3**
Usually the CEO or the DCEO of DDC
- 4) The different levels of the grievance procedure allow the matter to be examined by different individuals.
- 5) Specific time limits apply within which employees may submit grievances, and within which the appropriate employer representative must respond to a grievance.
- 6) The time limits may be extended by a mutual agreement between the DDC and the Employee which shall be as per the Oman Labor Law.
- 7) The grievance levels may be skipped depending on the severity of the issue.

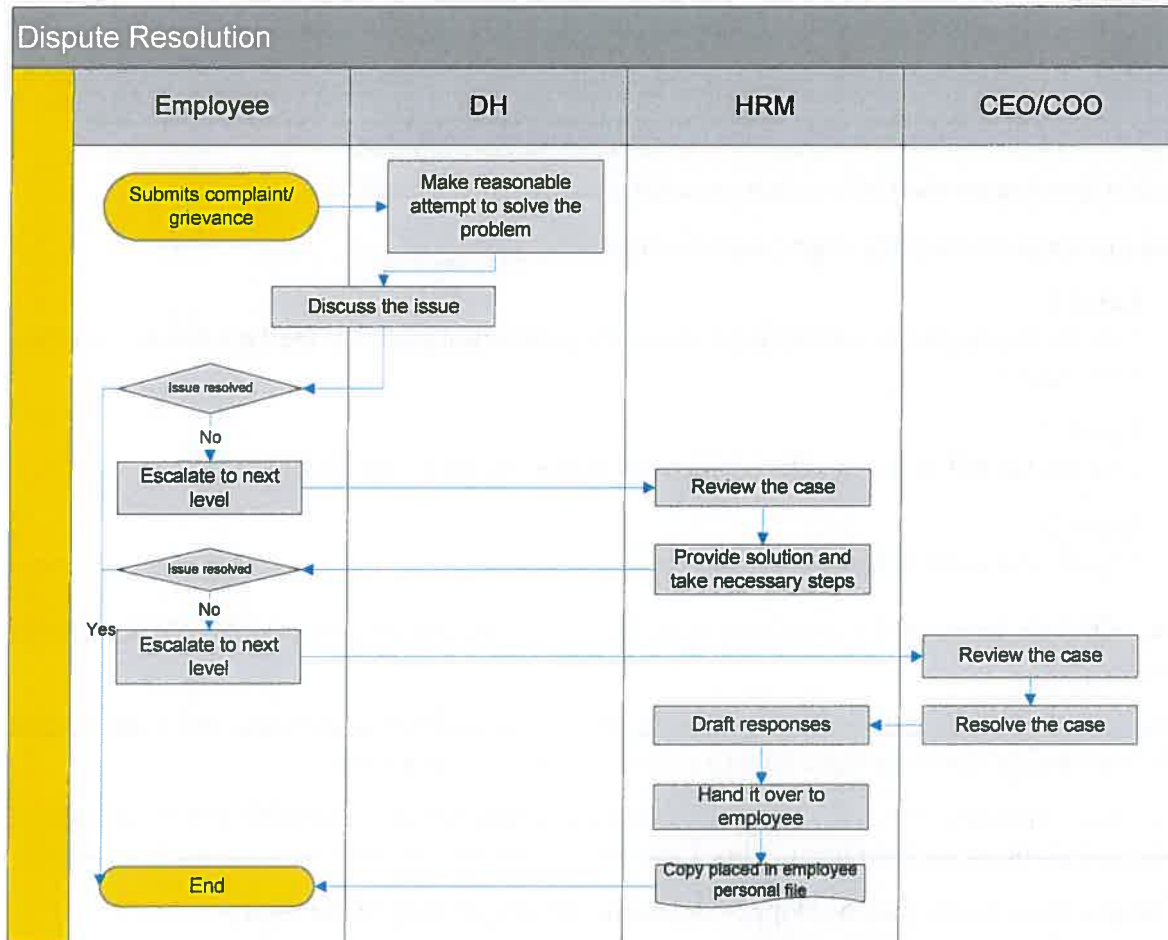
Table 17: Procedure for Dispute Resolution

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
1	An employee submits a complaint through the formal grievance process. The Employee may also seek advice from the HRM.	Employee
2	The DH and the employee make a reasonable attempt to solve the problem.	DH
3	The DH has a meeting with the employee to determine exactly what the Employee's concerns are in an attempt to resolve the complaint.	DH
4	If the issue is not resolved employee may escalate to the next levels	Employee
5	The representatives in the next level review the details of the case and make a	HRM/CEO/ DCEO



	reasonable attempt to solve the employee problem.	
6	The decisions or the responses provided at the third level are to be considered as final.	CEO/ DCEO
7	The HRM drafts responses to the Grievances and hand it over the concerned employee.	HRM
8	A copy of the responses is placed in the employee personal file.	HRM

Figure 17: Dispute Resolution Cross Functional Process Map



Chapter 10. Code of Conduct

Section 10.1. Oath of Office and Secrecy

Introduction

DDC employees have a duty of loyalty to DDC as their employer. The duty of loyalty, affirmed through the Oath of Office and Secrecy, requires employees to serve DDC to the best of their ability.

The release of confidential information that employees receive through the course of their employment may have a significant impact on the DDC's ability to manage its affairs or to maintain a perception of impartiality and integrity with its clients and the public.

To protect the interests of the DDC, its clients and the public, confidential information that employees receive through their employment must not be divulged to anyone other than persons who are authorized to receive the information both during their employment and after they terminate their employment. As well, employees must not use confidential information, or their ability to access such information, for the purpose of furthering any private interest or as a means of making personal gains.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

The application of the Oath of Office and Secrecy after ceasing to be an employee is of particular importance where employees or former employees have had access to confidential and/or privileged information, which, if disclosed, could harm the interests of the DDC and/or the clients it represents.

Article 10.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) All employees must abide by the Oath of Office and Secrecy.
- 2) Each employee, at the time of joining, must take the following oath or affirmation:
- 3) I, _____, solemnly affirm and declare that I will faithfully and honestly fulfill the duties that devolve upon me by reason of my employment at DDC and that I will not, without due authority, disclose or make known any matter that comes to my knowledge by reason of such employment.
- 4) In circumstances where an employee, or a former employee, reasonably believes that they may be asked to or feel pressured to breach their Oath of Office and Secrecy or that they may be in breach of their Oath of Office and Secrecy the employee or former employee shall notify their DH, or in the case of former employees the DH of their former Department, in writing of the circumstances and request clarification of the obligations arising from their Oath of Office and Secrecy.
- 5) Failure to comply with the Oath of Office and Secrecy could result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.
- 6) In the case of a former employee, failure to comply with the Oath of Office and Secrecy may result in legal action against the former employee



Section 10.2. Code of Conduct – General

Introduction

DDC is entrusted with the protection of the shareholder, client and public interest. In view of the importance of this trust, it is essential that DDC employees adhere to high ethical standards that maintain and foster shareholder, client and public confidence.

To ensure continued shareholder, client and public confidence in the impartiality and integrity the Code of Conduct Respecting Conflict of Interest and Oath of Office and Secrecy for the employees, DDC identifies standards of conduct for the employees in the execution of their duties, and in specific areas once an employee terminates their employment. It also outlines what steps employees should take to ensure they do not place themselves in a situation that can be perceived as a conflict of interest.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 10.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) Employees must perform official duties and arrange private affairs so the shareholders, clients and public trust in the integrity and objectivity of DDC is conserved and strengthened.
- 2) Employees must arrange their personal affairs so there is no contravention of the Code. Employees are not prevented from using DDC information that is available to the public for their private affairs. However, where such information is not available to the public, employees must manage their private affairs so that neither they nor their immediate family, relatives, friends, business associates or former business associates benefit from the use of such information. Employees are responsible for making sure there are no conflicts of interest.
- 3) An employee who contravenes any section of the Code may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.
- 4) Employees shall disclose and discuss with their DH, any situation, which may be a conflict of interest.
- 5) Complaints about employees' conflicts (i.e., outside activities) will be referred to the appropriate DH.
- 6) HRM should ensure that all employees receive a copy of code of conduct when they are hired.
- 7) Where a DH seeks to prohibit an employee's actions under the provisions of the Code, the employee has the right to request a review of that decision to the HRM. In the case of employees of the Human Resources Department, a review request can be made to the CEO/ DCEO .
- 8) Should an employee not agree with any decisions or actions taken as a result of the application of the Code, the employee may access the grievance process contained in the appropriate section of this manual.

Article 10.2.2. Equitable Treatment

- 1) DDC is committed to the equal treatment of all employees and qualified applicants.



- a) All applicants and employees must be judged by their qualifications, demonstrated skills and achievements.
 - b) Equal Employment Opportunity applies to all aspects of the employment relationship including promotion, placement, training and compensation.
 - c) DDC is committed to compliance with applicable employment laws everywhere we operate.
- 2) The government of the Sultanate of Oman in accordance with its Omanization policy seeks to promote employment of Omani workers in certain sectors and job functions as part of its initiative to up skill the Omani workforce. DDC takes the Omanization policy into cognizance while promoting equitable treatment.

Article 10.2.3. Discrimination and Harassment

- 1) DDC has zero tolerance for unlawful discrimination and harassment of any kind.
 - a) Any verbal or physical harassment by an employee that disrupts another's work performance.
 - b) Creates an intimidating, offensive, abusive or hostile work environment based on a protected characteristic will not be tolerated.
 - c) In addition, unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other unwelcome verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature are specifically prohibited.

Article 10.2.4. Health and Safety

- 1) DDC is committed to ensure a safe and congenial work atmosphere for its employees.
 - a) All employees are responsible for following safety rules and precautions as required by their job function as mandated by their operational areas
 - b) Employees are responsible for reporting any accidents, injuries, hazards or unsafe practices to their supervisors or department heads as soon as observed.
 - c) DHs on their part are responsible for providing the required safety training and regular monitoring and ensuring safe working conditions.

Article 10.2.5. Workplace Violence

- 1) DDC is committed to ensuring the safety and security of their employees, customers and other individuals or organizations that are involved in the day to day conduct of business.
 - a) Any observations about threats, attempts at or actual violence against themselves, other employees, customers or third parties on company premises should immediately be reported to the concerned authorities.
 - b) This applies to customers who are endangering the safety of employees or public in general.

Article 10.2.6. Smoking on Duty

- 1) DDC as part of its Health and Safety Policy lays down strict restrictions with respect to smoking.



- a) Under no circumstances will any employee smoke inside DDC premises.
- b) Smoking is only allowed in the designated areas.

Article 10.2.7. Alcohol and Drugs

- 1) DDC prohibits the possession, sale, purchase, delivery, use or transfer of illegal substances (except medically prescribed drugs) on company property or at company functions.
 - a) Employee must report to work free from the influence of any substance that could prevent him or her from conducting work activities safely and effectively.
 - b) HRM must be notified immediately of any illegal activity involving employees for the purpose of examination and preventive care.

Section 10.3. Conflict of Interest

Introduction

Employees take part in a wide range of activities as a reason of their position at DDC or outside of DDC employment including volunteer activities, self-employment and service (either volunteer or paid) on boards, councils or committees etc.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 10.3.1. Guidelines

- 1) Employees must perform official duties and arrange private affairs so shareholders, client and public trust in the integrity and objectivity of DDC is conserved and strengthened.
- 2) Employees must arrange their personal affairs so there is no contravention of the Code. It is not the DDC's intention to prevent employees from engaging in outside service or volunteer activities. However, where employees engage in outside service or volunteer activities, employees must ensure outside activities do not:
 - a) Cause a conflict of interest;
 - b) Be performed in such a way as to appear to be an official act on the DDC's behalf, or to represent a DDC opinion or policy;
 - c) Interfere with regular duties;
 - d) Involve the use of DDC premises, equipment or supplies; or
 - e) Place the employee in a position where the employee has confidential knowledge or information that the employee can exploit for personal gain.
- 3) CEO approval in writing is required before employees start any outside activities that may create a real or perceived conflict of interest. The CEO must obtain approval from the Chairman of Board of Directors. Employees should also notify their CEO if their outside activity changes (i.e., different volunteer for another organization) or when previous approval is several years



old.

- 4) An employee who contravenes any section of the Code may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.
- 5) Employees shall disclose and discuss with their DH or the CEO, any situation, which may be a conflict of interest.
- 6) Complaints from the shareholders, clients and public about employees' conflicts (i.e., outside activities) will be referred to the appropriate DH for taking necessary disciplinary action.

Article 10.3.2. Serving Customers

- 1) DDC strives to achieve customer excellence in all its dealings with customers, clients, and organizations etc in the day to day conduct of its business. The image of the DDC is of prime importance and as such, all dealings with outsiders will affect the same.
- 2) Employees are expected to deal fairly, honestly and ethically with all customers to ensure customer satisfaction.
- 3) Any special treatment to customers should be based on legitimate published criteria only.
- 4) Customers who are close friends and relatives should not be given any preferential treatment; unless such privileges are a part of a promotional scheme announced by DDC for a specific period.
- 5) Employees shall not divulge any personal information of customers to outsiders; such information is strictly for the use of DDC and staff to make effective business decisions.
- 6) Any disclosures to third parties will be made only in accordance with applicable law or company policy.

Article 10.3.3. Doing Business with Others

- 1) DDC's corporate reputation and standing in public is highly dependent upon its relationships with outsiders. DDC strives to develop supplier relations with fair, honest and ethical conduct. In the day to day conduct of its business, DDC enlists the services of several business and service partners.
- 2) Third parties who represent DDC as general sales agents, independent contractors, service providers etc are expected to observe the same code of conduct as DDC's employees.
- 3) Employees who liaise with any outside bodies are responsible for educating them about DDC's Code of Conduct.
- 4) Employees should report any violations of the code by these third parties to relevant authorities of DDC.
- 5) All purchases and awarding of contracts should be made in the best interest of DDC.
- 6) Employees involved in enlisting such outside services are responsible for considering competitive bids, ensuring quality service and confirming the financial capability of such supplier or service providers.
- 7) Employees and representatives of DDC should ensure that all sales, marketing and promotion materials are accurate and honest.



Article 10.3.4. Family and Personal Relationships

- 1) DDC does not prohibit spouses, siblings, close relatives and friends working in the organization. However the following considerations must be kept in mind.
 - a) An employee may not directly supervise his/her spouse, sibling, children, close relative or the supervisor of his/her spouse, sibling, children or close relative.
 - b) An employee may not allow his friendship or personal relationship to effect or influence his/her judgment while making selections, appraisals or promotions.
 - c) An employee may not make any decisions relating to contracts and agreements in which friends, relatives, close family members or business associates are involved. In such cases, the employee shall refer the matter to one of his peers to maintain objectivity.

Article 10.3.5. Breach of Confidentiality

The employees shall not disclose any confidential information to which they may have had access to during the course of their work, unless they are required to do so by a judicial order or under any law prevailing in the country to outsiders and unauthorized persons. All employees shall sign the Oath of Office and Secrecy.

Article 10.3.6. Accepting Gifts

Neither the employees nor the family members may accept any gifts whatsoever from the clients, suppliers, garages or agents of the Company, except minor gifts that are considered a token of appreciation for extra-ordinary service provided. Such extra-ordinary service should not result in a compromise of company objectives.

Section 10.4. Publication Rights

Article 10.4.1. Consent of the Company

A written consent of the company must be obtained before an employee releases any information on DDC. It may include, but not be limited to the following events:

- 1) Publish, cause to be published or submit for publication, any article, book, letter or photograph
- 2) Give any interview or disclose any information for publication
- 3) Broadcast or appear in television programs
- 4) Deliver any lecture or speech
- 5) Provide any material for any script, scenario or play
- 6) Exhibit or cause to be exhibited any film on any subject dealing with his duties or the business of DDC.

Article 10.4.2. Application to Publish Material

- 1) Applications to publish material in accordance with these rules must be submitted to the DH before the approval of the Planning and Marketing department.



Article 10.4.3. Mention DDC in publications

- 1) In case of publication under any of the headings above not concerned with the business of DDC, no mention may be made by the employee of his title or position with DDC or his connection thereafter.
- 2) No employee is permitted without specific approval of the Planning and Marketing Department to publish a book or other written work connected in any way with the Company's activities.

Section 10.5. Personal Conduct

Article 10.5.1. Attendance

- 1) The employee has the responsibility to ensure that all reasonable steps are to be taken to enable him to attend duty in accordance with his scheduled duty times.
- 2) All employees are required to record their attendance daily in the form as communicated by the HRM.

Article 10.5.2. Personal Appearance and Hygiene

- 1) All Employees at working hours or while in the premises of the company should maintain a decent professional appearance and hygiene.
- 2) The Human Resources Department will issue general rules for minimum requirements for employees according to their type of work from time to time.
- 3) DHs will counsel their employees regarding their appearance.
- 4) Uniformed staff is required to maintain clean and smart appearance and bearing at all times, and the following general rules shall apply:
 - a) Hair shall be worn at a reasonable length and manner.
 - b) Uniforms are required to be buttoned at all times.
 - c) Uniformed staff needs to wear shoes at all times as stipulated by company with respect to standard color and type.
 - d) Staff may proceed to and from duty in uniform, but are not permitted to wear it off duty.
- 5) Meet acceptable levels of personal hygiene or dress, in the interests of one's own health and safety and the interests of others.

Article 10.5.3. Inappropriate Behavior

- 1) DDC is committed to promoting the right behavior in workplace. Inappropriate behavior will be dealt with serious consequences. Such behaviors include and are not limited to the following;
 - a) Insubordination or refusal to obey a direct request of a supervisor
 - b) Failure to be courteous and respectful to all employees, clients and members of the public at all times.
 - c) Any conduct that might adversely impact the welfare of a client



- d) Disorderly conduct in dealing with fellow employees, clients, including, but not limited to, fighting, gossiping, threatening, intimidating, or using obscene, abusive or provocative language.
- e) Theft, fraud, or dishonesty in any form, including bribes or kickbacks
- f) Carrying or bringing firearms or other dangerous weapons, including explosives, knives, blackjacks, etc., on DDC premises.
- g) Causing dissension or disruption of the work of others, regardless of the intent of such conduct.
- h) Gambling at DDC property.
- i) Removal or misuse of fire extinguishers from proper locations or tampering with any fire protection or other safety equipment.
- j) Deliberately loafing on the job, in restrooms or elsewhere or otherwise failing to make a productive effort.
- k) Willful or deliberate destruction, damage, neglect, abuse, waste, or misuse of DDC property or equipment, or the property or equipment of any employee or client.
- l) Deliberately restricting output or interfering with efficiency or discipline.
- m) Refusing or failing to take a required drug test.
- n) Failure to adhere to DDC's Code of Conduct or to maintain confidentiality of sensitive Code of Conduct or client information.
- o) Failure to follow safety procedures.
- p) Conduct that may compromise the licensing status of any DDC's facilities.
- q) Leaving work without authorization.

Article 10.5.4. Expense Claims

- 1) Making expense claims in the course of day to day business is of routine nature. Such expense claims should however be accurate, genuine and be supported by evidence as appropriate. Employees should fill in Expense Claim Form as suggested by the Finance Department for claiming all such expenses. Employees shall strictly adhere to the below while making expense claims:
 - a) Approval of expense claims shall be in accordance with the Company policies and authorization limits relevant to the type of expense.
 - b) In general, prior approval of the DH/ relevant authority shall be required.
 - c) All claims for reimbursement shall be duly supported by documents evidencing the expense incurred to the department head.
 - d) Employees shall be fully responsible for the accuracy and genuineness of their claims.
 - e) Disciplinary action, including legal proceedings, shall be instituted against an employee deliberately defrauding the Company.



Article 10.5.5. Misrepresentation

- 1) DDC strives to promote a work environment that is orderly, positive and productive. Any behavior that is inconsistent with this objective shall be viewed as a violation of this code of conduct. Such behaviors include and are not limited to the following:
 - a) Failure to disclose details of previous employment when asked, or making of false declarations in the application form.
 - b) Falsification or misrepresentation of any information or records, including time records, employment applications, resumes, or alteration of any document.
 - c) Misrepresentation of an illness, disability or grounds for a request for leave.
 - d) Making a false, vicious, profane or malicious statement concerning any client or employee, or DDC or its services.

Article 10.5.6. Using Work Resources

- 1) The use of work resources by DDC employees should be restricted for the purpose of official reasons. Any personal use of such resources will be a violation of this code of conduct, this may include the following:
 - a) Use of office stationery for personal work
 - b) Use of company vehicles for personal purposes, unless such a benefit is conferred upon certain positions in the compensation structure
 - c) Use of company premises, equipment or property for private trading
 - d) Misappropriation of cash or using company cash for personal reasons
 - e) Use of telephones and internet for personal communication, except in times of emergency

Chapter 11. Termination

Section 11.1. Termination during Probation

Introduction

The purpose of a probationary period is to provide the employing department with a reasonable period of time in which to ascertain whether an employee is suitable and competent in the duties



of the position assigned. It also provides an employee with the opportunity to adapt to the work environment.

Where a probationary employee fails to maintain the required standard of conduct and corrective action has not resulted in acceptable improvement in performance, rejection on probation may be considered. Rejection on probation may also be considered if during the probationary period it is determined the employee is not suitable for the position or does not have the competency to perform the duties of the position at an acceptable level.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 11.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) The duration of a probationary period for all employees is three months.
- 2) A probationary period cannot be extended and an employee shall be placed on probationary period only once.
- 3) An employee on probation may be terminated on probation for unsuitability, incompetence, or misconduct. There must be adequate documentation to support such an action.
- 4) A employee may be rejected on probation:
 - a) By mutual consent;
 - b) For cause or incompetence;
- 5) A seven day written notification before the end of final day of probation must be provided to employees on probation for terminating the employment.
- 6) Supporting documentation (e.g., probation evaluation, records of disciplinary action, attendance records) must accompany the recommendation for termination on probation.
- 7) An employee who is terminated on probation for misconduct is not entitled to removal benefits.

Section 11.2. Voluntary Separation

Introduction

To assist departments in fulfilling operational requirements, employees must provide at least one month notice (or notice period as mentioned in employment contract, if notice in employment contract is higher), in writing, of their resignation.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 11.2.1. Resignation

- 1) An employee is hired for an indeterminate period, unless stated otherwise in the letter of offer.
- 2) Employees are required to provide a written notice of the intent of separation as per the notice period mentioned in their employment contract.



- 3) An employee may ask to withdraw a resignation by writing to the DH. A DH approves a withdrawal only if it is before the effective date of the resignation and there has not been another person selected for or appointed to the position.
- 4) A written resignation may be accepted by an employee's immediate supervisor. The resignation is accepted in writing. If the employee is upset, the supervisor should ask the employee to think the matter over carefully.
- 5) The employee's letter of resignation and a copy of the acceptance must be sent to HRM. A copy of each is placed on the employee's personnel file.

Section 11.3. Involuntary Separation

Introduction

Termination of employment with DDC can arise from a variety of circumstances involving certain action on the part of the employee, DDC or both.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 11.3.1. Medical Termination

- 1) DDC may terminate an employee who is unable to fulfill obligations under the employment relationship due to illness. This shall be done in accordance with the section 40 and 43 of Oman Labor Law.
- 2) Sick leave is approved for employees when appropriate.
- 3) A medical termination is not disciplinary in nature.
- 4) The basis of a medical termination is a prognosis of the employee's condition. DDC will accommodate absenteeism due to illness in most cases. A medical termination is appropriate only where the absences are extensive and likely to be of long duration.
- 5) A medical termination is appropriate in cases where an Employee has been off duty due to illness for an extensive period (a period of 10 weeks in a year) and is unable to carry out the duties of the position. Medical termination may be actioned earlier if the prognosis shows that the employee is unlikely ever to return to duty or if the employee is deemed to be medically unfit for his job role.
- 6) If the employee is injured during his/her service with DDC, and as a result of the injury becomes completely handicapped, the employee shall be compensated through the medical insurance scheme. In case of Omani employee, he/she will be compensated through PASI and Medical Insurance Scheme.
- 7) Care needs to be taken in all medical termination cases to ensure that there is no discrimination against an employee due to disability. DDC will make every effort to secure an alternative employment at the company; however on failing to secure an alternative job, the contract of employment will be terminated on medical reasons.



Article 11.3.2. Termination for Cause

The employee's service may be terminated without notice. The following illustrated below are general circumstances that could cause suitable grounds for termination:

- 1) The employee has been dismissed as per the disciplinary procedure outlined in the Discipline policy of this manual and article 40 & 43 of Oman Labour Law.
- 2) Reduction in workforce, downsizing, right-sizing and restructuring and reorganization may include a number of methods of eliminating worker hours, including layoff. Such termination is caused by economic factors, changing markets, poor management or some other factor related to work behavior, in all such cases the employee is terminated in accordance to Oman Labor Law.
- 3) If a position was cancelled from the organization structure, the employee who is occupying it shall be transferred to another vacant position within the same level in DDC but only if he meets the requirement of that level, otherwise the employee will be considered as early retired from the date of that position was cancelled. The employee will be entitled to his salary until the date of his final settlement and then he is finally released from DDC.
- 4) DDC may extend the services of an employee, after the expiry date of his/her contract, in cases of war or national emergency. The extension period will continue for as long as the war or emergency continues, and/or until DDC or appropriate concerned authorities decides to terminate the employee's services.

Article 11.3.3. Termination due to non-performance

- 1) DDC employees who fail to meet expected standards of performance and do not respond to informal counseling should be formally notified by his/her DH of the areas of substandard performance via the performance appraisal process and/or other written communication.
 - a) If performance continues at a substandard level, additional communications, warnings, and counseling should be provided by the DH and HRM should be consulted by the department.
 - b) If termination of employment is considered, the department head should consult with HRM to review the circumstances and make final arrangements.
- 2) After the decision has been made to terminate an employee, HRM will prepare a letter of termination and make necessary arrangements for final settlement and communicate to the Finance Department.

Section 11.4. Retirement

Introduction

DDC assists its employees in planning for their retirement from their service.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 11.4.1. Guidelines

- 1) The age of retirement is 65 years for all employees.



- 2) Any employee who has reached the age of retirement may be retained for additional years, if it is in the interest of DDC, after obtaining CEO's approval. However, such extension of employment may be terminated at any stage based on circumstances of DDC.
- 3) The HRM informs the employee one year in advance about the date of retirement. Any leave outstanding as on the date of retirement can be en-cashed and will be paid to the employee during final settlement.

Section 11.5. Death in Service

Introduction

DDC makes every effort to deal with terminations due to death as quickly and compassionately as possible.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 11.5.1. Guidelines

- 1) When an employee dies, all advanced but unearned leave is forgiven.
- 2) Severance is paid to the deceased employee's dependents.
- 3) Payment is made for salary and benefits earned up to and including the date of death.
- 4) Ultimate removal applies to the dependents of deceased employees. One hundred percent (100%) removal is provided to any destination. Costs for the shipping of the body are included as part of life insurance coverage.
- 5) Pension, gratuity and insurance benefits are paid to the beneficiary or nominee according to the provisions of each benefit.

Article 11.5.2. Reporting a Death

- 1) A person discovering a death must report the fact immediately to HR Department who will notify the Royal Oman Police.
- 2) The DH will immediately inform the following:
 - a) HRM
 - b) Public Relations Officer (PRO)/ Department Representative
- 3) The HRM and respective DH will coordinate all activities associated with the investigation of the death and the repatriation of the deceased.

Article 11.5.3. Death of an Expatriate Employee in the Sultanate

- 1) The HRM must ensure that the overseas agents, etc. if necessary are appropriately informed about the death, request assistance in notification of next-of-kin or emergency contacts.
- 2) Ensure the relatives of the deceased are informed and follow-up, as necessary, with additional



information and assistance. (The family will be responsible for making funeral arrangements and all expenses associated with the interment).

- 3) Ensure that the deceased's personal effects are secured, inventoried, and air freighted. If the employee is on single status, the inventory must be witnessed and provided to accompany the shipment and for placement in the employee personal file.
- 4) Contact the relevant Embassy to report the death of a national of that country.
- 5) Advise Finance and follow-up to ensure all payments, if any, due to the deceased are processed immediately, and that a final cheque is prepared for the HRM to coordinate delivery to appropriate authority.
- 6) Co-ordinate transportation requirements for the repatriation of the deceased.
- 7) Co-ordinate airline tickets and accommodations if necessary.
- 8) Monitor and log all activities connected with the death. A copy is placed in the employee's Personnel File.
- 9) The HRM will be responsible for the following activities:
 - a) Co-ordinate the necessary procedures immediately with the Royal Oman Police.
 - b) Seek permission to move the deceased to the local mortuary.
 - c) Obtain all necessary documentation to allow the deceased to be repatriated to their country of origin.
 - d) Obtain and send the following original documents and approved certified translations to the Human Resources Department.
 - i) Death Certificate
 - ii) Police Report and Clearance
 - iii) ☐Expense
 - iv) ☐Report
 - v) ☐Embalming Certificate
 - vi) ☐Transit Permit
 - vii) ☐Burial Permission Certificate.
 - e) Coordination with PASI in case of Omani employees as per the Oman Labour Law.
- 10) Upon being notified of an employee's death, the Finance Department is responsible for:
 - f) To arrange payment of his/her final settlement as prepared by the HR payroll.
 - g) Deducting any amounts due to DDC
 - h) Coordinating insurance claims and advising SM HR
 - i) Issuing the final settlement cheque in the name of the nominee.
 - j) DDC will pay an amount of R.O 500 to cover the funeral and related expenses.



- k) The insurance cheque will be delivered to Human Resource Employee Relations section to be handed over to the nominee.

Section 11.6. Abandonment of Position

Introduction

Where an employee is absent from duty without leave for a period of more than ten days in one year or more than seven consecutive days, a DH may declare the employee to have abandoned the position. The position then becomes vacant and the individual ceases to be an employee of the DDC.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 11.6.1. Guidelines

- 1) An employee who is declared to have abandoned a position is not entitled to severance pay. Since abandonment of position constitutes misconduct.
- 2) When an employee is absent from duty without leave, the DH makes every reasonable effort to contact the employee to determine the reason for the absence and to establish the employee's intent with respect to returning to duty.
- 3) The DH documents all attempts to contact the employee. Attempts must include telephoning the employee, contacting a spouse or relative, visiting the employee at home and sending the employee a registered letter requesting an immediate response.
- 4) If the DH is successful in contacting the employee, the DH specifies to the employee a date for return to duty. Upon return to duty, the employee is disciplined for the absence. If the employee fails to return to work on the date specified, a request for declaration of abandonment of position is prepared.
- 5) A request for declaration of abandonment of position is sent to the employee's HRM by the DH. This request must be accompanied by supporting documentation which includes the name of the employee, the position title and number, attendance records showing the period of the employee's absence without leave and a summary of the attempts made to contact the employee.
- 6) Upon determining that declaration of abandonment of position is appropriate, the HRM consults with the appropriate authority and advises the employee in writing that he or she is declared to have abandoned his or her position.
- 7) The HRM makes every reasonable attempt to hand-deliver this written notice to the employee without undue delay. A copy of this letter is placed on the employee's personnel file. A copy is also given to the Finance Department as soon as possible so that appropriate pay action is taken.

Table 18: Procedure for Separation

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
Voluntary Separation		
1	The employee submits resignation letter to the respective DH detailing the effective date of resignation, reasons for	Employee



	resignations and tentative date for relieving (date of relieving should be as per the employment contract).	
2	DH receives the resignation letter and meets the employee to discuss about separation. The DH should make all efforts to understand why the employee is leaving organization and tries to solve any of the employee's grievances and retain the employee.	DH
3	If the employee still wishes to separate, the DH signs off on the resignation letter and forwards it to the HRM for further processing.	DH
4	The HRM reviews the letter and verifies if relieving dates are as per the terms of employment contract. If there are any concerns notifies the respective DH of the same.	HRM
5	The HRM confirms on email the resignation acceptance and the effective date of relieving. The HRM also suggests the exit formalities the employee needs to complete before separation.	HRM
6	The DH initiates the replacement hiring process by sending hiring request form to the HRM. The HRM will initiate hiring process as per the hiring policy and finds a suitable replacement. If a suitable replacement is not found employees effective relieving date may be extended upon approval of the CEO.	DH/HRM
7	The DH provides the employee with handover checklist at least 3 weeks prior to the date of relieving. The handover check list includes the tasks that relieving employee needs to complete prior to separation and details the knowledge transfer to be made to DH or the replacement employee.	DH
8	The employee completes tasks as per the handover checklist and signs off on the same.	Employee
9	The HRM provides the employee with exit clearance form and requests the employee to obtain clearances from DHs, in certain cases clearances might have to be obtained from outside personnel.	HRM
10	The Employee obtains all required clearances and submits it to the HRM for processing the final settlements.	Employee
11	The HRM completes the exit interview for the employee and initiates end of service benefits process. The HRM also prepares the relieving letter and gets approval from the CEO.	HRM
12	On the last day of employment, the employee is paid with all dues from DDC or if any dues are pending from	HRM



	employee, they are recovered.	
13	Employee signs on the relieving letter and agrees that no dues are pending to or from DDC.	Employee
14	A copy of employee relieving letter is placed in the employee personal file and the file is closed and kept in safe custody.	HRM
Involuntary Separation		
1	Termination of employment with DDC can arise from a variety of circumstances involving certain action on the part of the employee, DDC or both. Involuntary Separation may arise from any of the following, but not limited to: • Termination on probation • Medical termination • Termination due to death in service • Termination for cause/ disciplinary action • Termination due to retirement	HRM
2	The HRM receives appropriate notification / decision on termination of employee.	HRM
3	The HRM prepares notice of termination and forwards it to the CEO/ DCEO for approval.	HRM
4	The CEO/COO reviews the termination letter and approves the termination letter.	CEO/ DCEO
5	The HRM hands over the termination letter to the employee and suggests the employee on exit clearances.	HRM
6	The DH prepares handover checklist and ensures that all handover by the employee is completed at least one week prior to the date of termination.	DH
7	Employee completes the handover as per the tasks mentioned in the check list and completes all required exit clearances.	Employee
8	The HRM conducts exit interview with the employees and initiates end of service benefits process.	HRM
9	On the last day of employment, the employee is paid with all dues from DDC or if any dues are pending from employee, they are recovered.	HRM
10	Employee signs on the relieving letter and agrees that no dues are pending to or from DDC.	Employee
11	A copy of employee relieving letter is placed in the	HRM



employee personal file and the file is closed and kept in safe custody.	
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Figure 18(A): Voluntary Termination

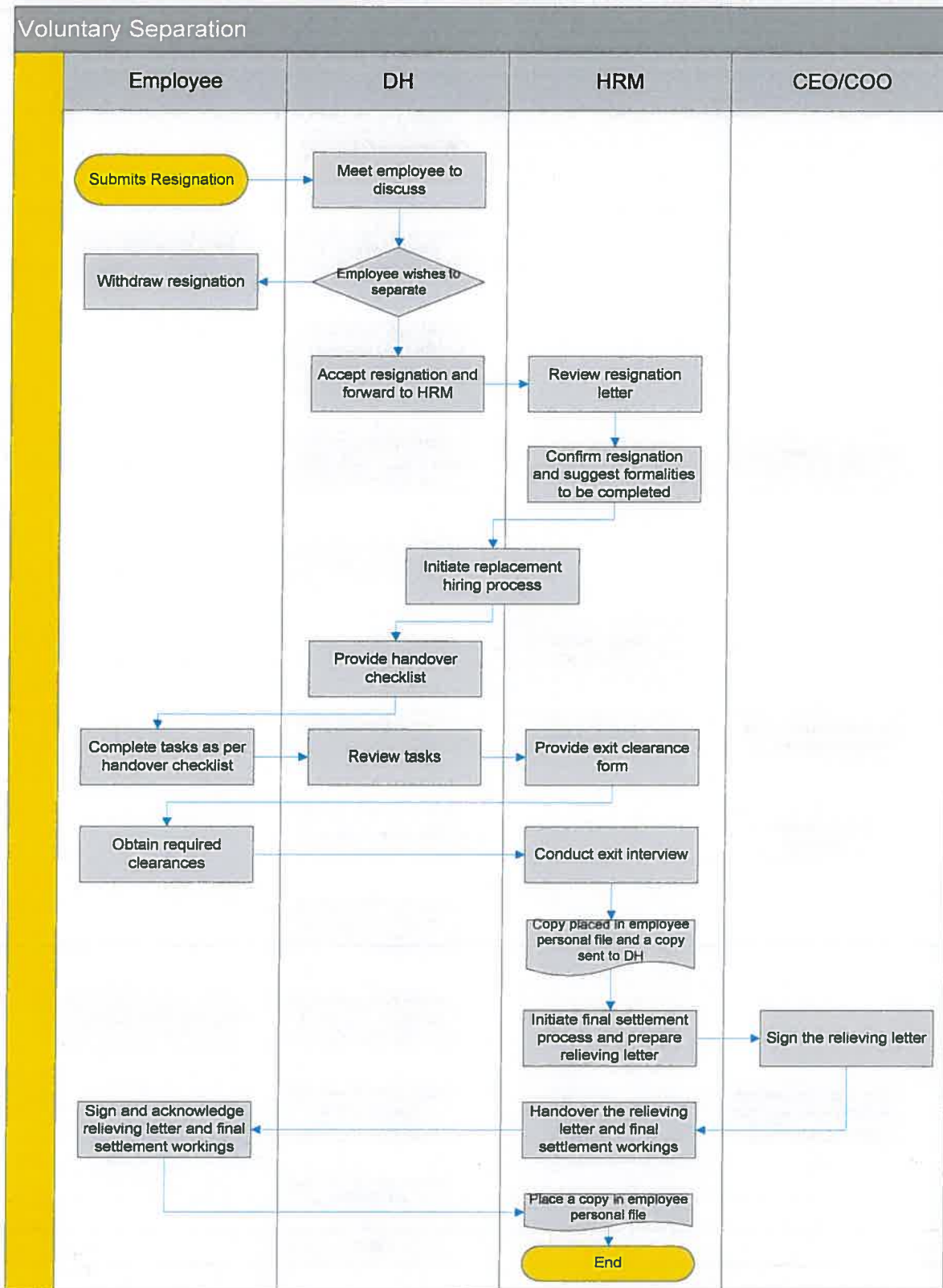
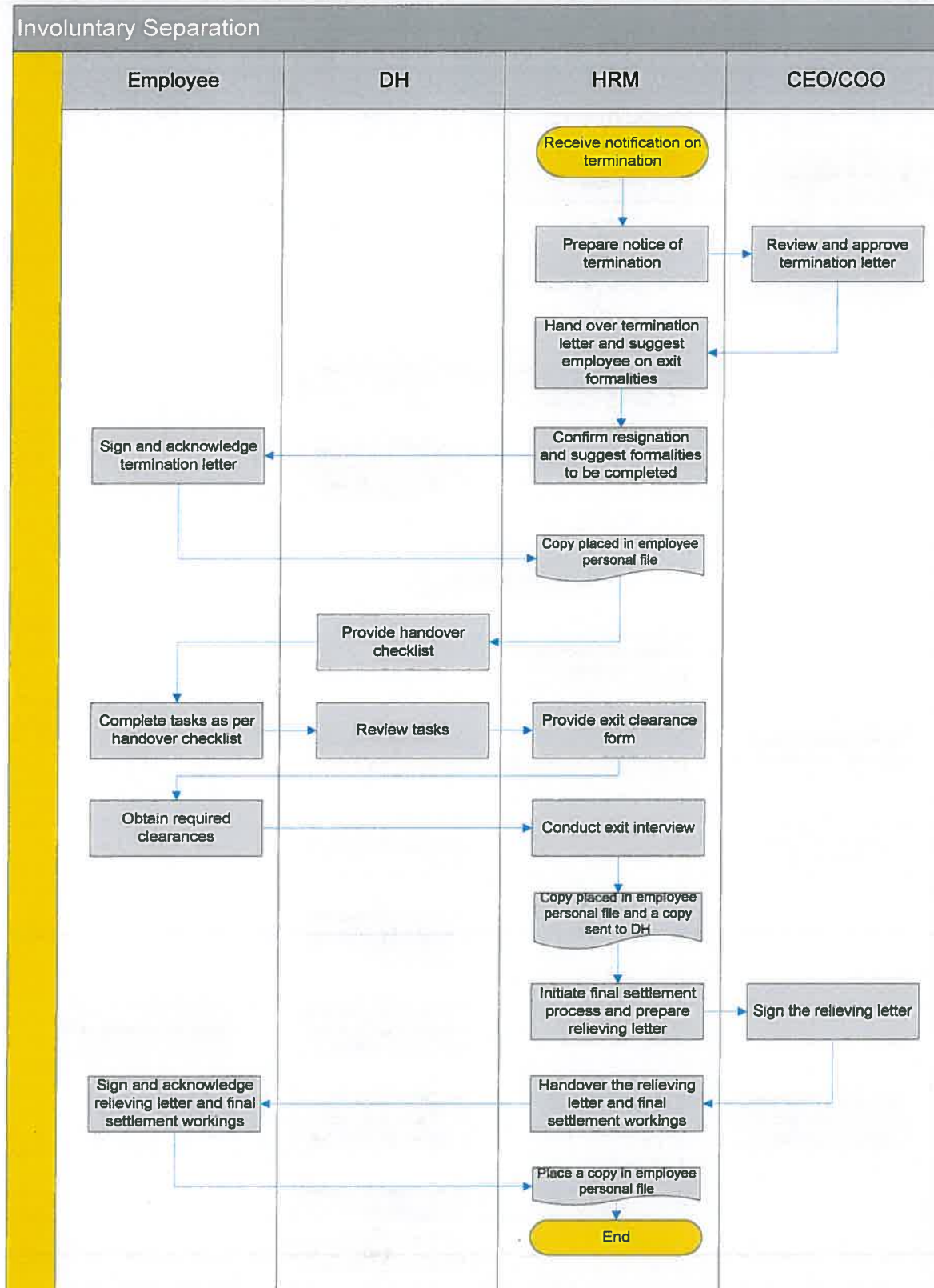


Figure 18(B): Involuntary Termination



Chapter 12. Performance Management, Increments & Bonus and Rewards

Section 12.1. Performance Management

Introduction

Performance management provides the Management team with a consistent method for evaluating an employee's performance. They also provide a scheduled opportunity for the employees to improve the subordinate's performance. Evaluations are used to define steps to further the employee's development to ensure that rewards and recognition are consistent with performance, and to plan the most appropriate utilization of employee's capabilities.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 12.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) Performance evaluation will be completed prior to the following events:
 - Increments & Bonus
 - Promotion
 - Disciplinary action for performance deficiency
 - Termination.
- 2) The Human Resources Committee will supply the individual DHs via Human resources department, with copies of the employee appraisal forms in November of each year.
- 3) All employees working for DDC (Grade 3 and below) will be subject to a systematic evaluation process throughout the year.
- 4) All employees who have completed at least six months of continuous service with DDC are appraised on an annual basis.
- 5) It will be the responsibility of the employee's Department Heads to monitor the completion of the performance evaluation before November 15 of each year.
- 6) HR Committee should complete the Evaluation process within the third week of November.
- 7) The performance of all employees will be evaluated against criteria applicable to their organizational level and work situation. The criteria include:
 - Prior year goals and achievement, thereof
 - Departmental goals and objectives
 - DDC strategic plan
 - Quality of performance
 - Personal effectiveness

Section 12.2. Increments & Bonus

Introduction

The salary that any employee is paid is based on the classification of that employee's position on



the salary schedule. The schedule establishes a range for each classification. Increments are provided, based on recommendation of quality performance, up to the maximum of classification.

HRM will recommend a bonus mechanism to CEO / DCEO based on annual performance appraisal of each employee. The mechanism and amount of bonus is subject to Board approval.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 12.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) Employees, subject to satisfactory performance and according to performance review procedures, will proceed by annual increment through the salary range appropriate to the classification of the position occupied, to the maximum of the range.
- 2) DDC may, in exceptional circumstances, advance an employee more than one increment or grant a special increment or increments in the salary range appropriate to the classification of the position occupied.
- 3) DHs are strongly encouraged to seek assistance from HRM in circumstances where, they believe, it is appropriate to withhold an increment.
- 4) Employees will be counseled by their DH if deferment is recommended and provided with written reasons for deferment and the steps to be undertaken to improve their performance.
- 5) Employees have the opportunity to reply in writing and have their reply considered by the HRM. Any deferment of increment will be considered by the HRM, with consultation between the DH and the CEO.
- 6) Decisions to defer an increment shall be reviewed within 4 months from the date of deferral.
- 7) Any subsequent approval for payment on an increment will be effective from the date of approval with all future annual increments becoming due on the regular increment cycle date.

Section 12.3. Rewards Management

Introduction

DDC encourages the recognition of excellent performance and achievement through the use of rewards that are creative, flexible, and meaningful. When administered and communicated effectively, reward and recognition are an important part of a total compensation program. DDC may choose whether or not to develop Defined Reward Programs. In the absence of a Defined Reward Program, DDC may give rewards in immediate response to specific accomplishments

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.



Article 12.3.1. Guidelines

- 1) Rewards are one-time cash or non-cash award for significant outstanding performance. Rewards should not be confused with annual increment cycle or the performance appraisal cycle, they are one time in nature and would have got outstanding results to DDC.
- 2) Rewards should be given for significant outstanding performance that advances DDC goals, and should be tied to a specific accomplishment.
- 3) Rewards are most effective when they are meaningful to the individual.
- 4) Defined Rewards Program must be designed by the HRM in consultation with the CEO and DCEO .
- 5) The purpose, process, parameters and expected outcomes of the reward program should be communicated in writing to the employees.

Section 12.4. Promotions

Introduction

Through promotions, the DDC provides career development opportunities to existing employees and develops internal source of manpower to assume higher responsibilities.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 12.4.1. Guidelines

- 1) Promotions may be awarded to:
 - a) Fill a vacancy that has arisen during this period for which an employee is evaluated to be suitable
 - b) Recognize the exceptional performance of an employee
 - c) Promotions will be based entirely on merit.
 - d) Promotions will be awarded only if the performance evaluation clearly indicates that the employee has the capability of accepting additional responsibilities.
 - e) Candidates for promotions must possess the minimum qualifications and experience, as specified in the job description, required for the new position.
 - f) In considering the alternatives for filling a vacancy, priority will be given to employees who fulfill the position requirements and can be considered for promotion or transfer.
 - g) Promotions will be given once in a year only after completion of the appraisal process. In certain special circumstances, including cases of vacancy and other such circumstances as considered appropriate by the Human Resource Committee and approved by CEO, promotions may be given during the year.
 - h) All promotions will be declared by the management latest by the end of the first month of the following year (except for exceptional circumstances as stated in the previous policy).



- i) In case of having more than one employee, both of which are eligible for promotion to a higher grade, having comparable experience within DDC, then academic and professional qualification would be considered as the deciding factor. If again, the candidate is found equally eligible, then the experience factor will be considered and the more experienced candidate will be promoted (Unless approaching retirement age).
- 2) Types of promotion are as follows:
 - a) Promotion on Performance: In case of outstanding performance, in combination with proven level of competencies for higher grade, promotion is granted to employees. Reference is made to the concerned employee's career development plan and to DDC's overall employee position structure. Promotions should also be justified on the grounds of change of responsibility, increase of know-how and experience. When granting a promotion consideration should be given to the implication on other employees with similar experience and education.
 - b) Promotion on Transfer: In case of internal transfer to another position, promotion is granted if the employee is competent to execute the tasks at the higher level efficiently and effectively.
- 3) The employee will be granted the promotion entitlements based on the new grade and in accordance to the existing Compensation Structure.



Chapter 13. Career Development and Succession Planning

Section 13.1. Career Development

Introduction

The Career Development Policy derives from the high value placed by DDC upon its employees and the belief that they are central to the DDC's endeavors. This policy aims to assist the development of each individual and thereby enhance the DDC's performance and its status as a quality employer.

Extending the knowledge and skills of its staff is one of the DDC's key commitments. DDC is dedicated to the pursuit of learning, but is itself required to be a "learning organization", so that it can continually improve the provision of learning and career opportunities to its employees. Development of knowledge, skills and attitudes enhances the performance of employees in their current tasks and prepares them for the emerging roles to which they will need to adapt.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 13.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) The DHs bear the primary responsibility for implementing career development policy by ensuring that employees are given necessary opportunities to undertake appropriate training and development activities.
- 2) DHs should analyze the development needs of the unit and individual employees and develop and implement plans to meet these needs. These plans will cover both the initiatives that can be taken to meet requirements of the Department and employee career goals.
- 3) DHs should recommend/authorize and make budgetary provision for employee development opportunities when appropriate, and ensure that employees are released for approved activities;
- 4) DHs should advise on development activities including program content and promote information sharing and application of new skills or insights in the workplace; and
- 5) The effectiveness of any career development activity depends on the active and purposeful participation of the employees involved. Employees have a clear responsibility to develop their skills to enhance performance in their current position and to be ready to assume further responsibilities.

Section 13.2. Succession Planning

Introduction



Given the ever changing face of employment and the need for talented individuals in various positions, it is a policy at DDC to be prepared for a change – either planned or unplanned – to ensure the stability and accountability of the organization at all times. It is important that the DDC takes steps to ensure the retention of staff in general and in particular those candidates that show potential are in key positions or have scarce skills.

Succession Planning also serves to establish the present and potential talent in DDC in a systematic way with a view of filling future positions effectively and quickly.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 13.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) The board of directors along with the executive management shall be responsible for implementing this policy and its related procedures to ensure stability of the organization at all times
- 2) The board shall assess the permanent leadership needs of the organization to help ensure the selection of qualified and capable leaders who are a good fit for the organization's mission, vision, values, goals, and objectives; and who have the necessary skills for the organization.
- 3) The board and the executive management shall aim at:
 - a) Creating an ongoing supply of well trained broadly experienced, well-motivated employees who are ready to step into key positions as required
 - b) Integrating desirable Omani candidates into the succession plan to support the Omanization initiative of the Sultanate
 - c) Creating opportunities for educating the candidates in the succession plan to work with different departments in the organization
 - d) Defining employee career path and supporting career goals of key personnel to help retain talent
 - e) Encouraging managers to allow the release of potential subordinates to other departments for multi skilling in other functions
- 4) The board of directors and the executive management shall also be responsible to ensure that the promotion and performance management policies are in line with the provisions of this policy
- 5) The CEO/ DCEO shall ensure that the key positions for the succession plan are identified
- 6) The DHs shall ensure that candidates in their department are identified as potential successors for the key positions identified
- 7) The CEO/ DCEO and the DHs should ensure that the career development benefits available as part of the training and development policy are fully utilized to support the succession plans
- 8) The HRM shall be the key catalyst in ensuring that the succession plan is implemented in word and spirit by the management. The incumbent shall ensure that the following information about the candidates identified in the succession plan is updated and monitored regularly.



- a) Work experience and achievements
 - b) Performance appraisal results
 - c) Special areas of expertise
 - d) Key competencies
 - e) Other attributes that may benefit the organization
- 9) The succession planning process should include the following elements:
- a) Preparing short term work plans for identified positions
 - b) A list of temporary tasks that the position performs
 - c) A handover mechanism for the position
 - d) A mentor for the position
 - e) Training exposure of various types (college, in-house seminars, courses etc)



Chapter 14. Training and Development

Section 14.1. Training Needs Assessment

Introduction

The purpose of a training needs assessment is to identify performance requirements or needs within DDC in order to help direct resources to the areas of greatest need, those that closely relate to fulfilling the organizational goals and objectives, improving productivity and providing quality services.

The training needs assessment is the first step in the establishment of a training and development program. It is used as the foundation for determining instructional objectives, the selection and design of instructional programs, the implementation of the programs and the evaluation of the training provided. These processes form a continuous cycle which must begin with a needs assessment.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 14.1.1. Guidelines

- 1) The primary responsibility of ensuring that the training needs analysis is done in an appropriate manner lies with the HRM. The HRM shall ensure that the process is well communicated and understood by the line managers.
- 2) For the purpose of identifying training needs the HRM may collect and document information from the following three areas, but not limited to:

- a) Organizational Assessment

Organization assessment is carried out to look at the effectiveness of the organization and to determine where training is needed and under what conditions it will be conducted. This includes regulatory impacts on the organization, change in technology, changing workforce demographics and organizational goals.

- b) Task Assessment

Task assessment is conducted to analyze gaps about a job or a group of jobs and the knowledge, skills, attitudes and abilities needed to achieve peak performance. This includes assessment based on job descriptions, knowledge, skills and abilities and performance standards required.

- c) Individual Assessment

Individual assessment is carried out to analyze how well the individual employee is doing the job and to determine the kind of training required for the employee to improve his job performance. This includes assessment based on performance evaluation, observations by



supervisor, work samples and employee surveys.

- 3) The HRM in consultation with the DHs should determine the training needs considering the backgrounds of the employees to be trained, and their present status in the Organization. Basically, a candidate for training may come from any one of three groups:
 - a) New Hires
 - b) Employees
 - c) Trainees
 - d) Government Directives
- 4) The DHs should identify the gaps in the employee competencies either through a formal competency assessment or a supervisor's assessment.
- 5) The DHs and the immediate supervisors should review the competencies needed within the department/ team against the department /team's objectives.
- 6) The HRM should ensure that the inputs received are valid and relevant to the Organizational Goals and the job roles of the employees.
- 7) Training needs should be identified based on the importance and impact of the training program on the regular operations. The HRM must priorities the training in accordance with urgency, operational objectives combined with budgetary guidelines.

Section 14.2. Training Budget

Introduction

Training budgets are done to identify the costs of training interventions which includes calculation of the cost of training and/ or assessments and any additional costs that may be associated with the training for example: travel, accommodation, refreshments, materials, trainee allowance etc.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 14.2.1. Guidelines

- 1) The HRM shall develop a training budget to project finances needed for supporting the training objectives.
- 2) The training budget should be based on the organizational strategic plan, manpower plan, training needs assessment, training programs required and ad-hoc training requests.
- 3) All costs such as the following should be included while preparing the training budget:
 - a) Fixed costs (instructor salary, information distribution, etc.),
 - b) Variable costs (printed handouts, lunch for participants, etc.),
 - c) Direct costs (course development or purchase, printing, equipment rental, training evaluation, etc.)
- 4) The training budgets are prepared by the HRM in conjunction with the DHs.



- a) The budget shall be prepared during the annual operating budget cycle; any changes required should be incorporated by the Training Manager and forwarded for approval. The HRM should ensure that all training programs are conducted in line with the approved budget.
 - b) Every item of expenditure incurred during the training program should be within the training budget.
 - c) The training budget is forwarded to the CFO and then to CEO for final review and approval by the Board.
- 5) All incidental expenditures incurred during the course of delivery of a training program shall be reimbursed.
 - 6) These expenses should be within the training budget and should be supported by proper justification.

Section 14.3. Training Program Management

Introduction

The Human Resources Department based on the training needs assessment devises a plan that details various methods through which the training will be imparted. The training department looks after the overall program management for various methods of training and coordinates with relevant department in the course of action.

Application

These guidelines and procedures apply to all employees.

Article 14.3.1. Guidelines

- 1) The training department will ensure the selection of appropriate method for imparting a training and looks after the overall management of the training program.
- 2) The training programs shall be done using any of the following methods:
 - a) In house Training
 - i) In house training refers to the training programs that are conducted in DDC premises.
 - ii) In house training is provided by DDC professionals or External trainers who are called upon for providing training.
 - iii) In house training may be conducted during regular working hours or after the regular working hours based on the training program.
 - iv) The Human Resources Department coordinates with all relevant departments for arranging for the in house training program.
 - b) External Training
 - i) External training programs are the ones that are held outside DDC's premises. The Human Resources Department will coordinate with relevant departments, trainees and training providers for the training program management.



- ii) The training department should ensure that the training activities are in line with the training plan and within approved training budgets.
- c) Overseas Training
 - i) Based on the training programs developed, where necessary the trainees shall be sent abroad for undertaking the training program.
 - ii) The Human Resource Department looks after the management of all such programs, including the logistics arrangement for the trainees, co ordination with the training provider overseas and ensuring the training costs involved are well within the approved budgets.



Table 19: Procedure for Training

Step No.	Procedure	Responsibility
In-house Training		
1	The HRM advises the DHs on the upcoming training programs four weeks prior to the date of training.	HRM
2	The DHs should send across the nominations for the training at least 3 weeks prior to the date of training.	DH
3	The HRM will compile the list of nominations received and finalized the list.	HRM
4	The HRM will ensure all necessary arrangements and coordination is completed and seven days prior to the date of training send email to trainees and DHs on the training date, trainer and other relevant program details	HRM
5	Two days prior to the date of training, the list of trainees is provided to the trainer and all relevant logistics such as stationary, refreshments are taken care of by the HRM	HRM
6	On the day of training the HRM must ensure that all arrangements such as training material are copied, projectors or any other required system support are in place.	HRM
7	Attendance list and trainee feedback form are prepared by the HRM and handed over the trainer.	HRM
8	The trainers are expected to deliver the training program as per the training objectives and mark attendance for the trainees who have attended on the training. The training feedback form should be provided to the trainees to provide their comments and collected back and handed over to the HRM.	Trainer
9	Depending on the training program, the trainer might have to assess the trainees on certain areas and the program might include certain tests and activities. Any assessments or tests conducted during the training along with the results should be handed over to the HRM at the end of training.	Trainer
10	The HRM will consult with the trainer and prepares certificates on completion of the training program. If the training has an assessment at the end of training the certificates will be prepared based on the trainee passing the assessment.	HRM
11	The training certificates will be handed over to the training certificates up on successful completion of the training program.	HRM
12	The DHs should provide opportunity to their team members on utilizing the training knowledge in their day to day work and develop a training action plan. The training action plan should detail how the trainee wants to implement what he has learnt from the training and a period for training action plan review should be agreed upon. At the end the DH should evaluate if the objectives of the training action plan are achieved and if the DH perceives that a further training may be required for the employee, same should be referred to the HRM.	DH
13	The training action plan evaluation report should be sent to the	DH



	HRM for placing it in the employee personal file.	
External/ Overseas Training		
1	Based on the training plan devised at the beginning of the year, the HRM will identify the training providers and shortlist appropriate training providers in consultation with the respective DH and in line with the approved training budget.	HRM
2	The DH should nominate trainees for the training program and send across the nominations to the HRM.	DH
3	Upon receiving the nominations, the HRM will coordinate with the Finance Department and training provider for registering the trainees for the training program.	HRM
4	The trainees will be intimated on the training program details and dates of training, the DH will be advised to make necessary arrangements for handover and ensure that the operational requirements are not affected.	HRM
5	Depending on the training program, employees may have to enter into a training bond, in such cases the HRM prepares the training bond and the employees should sign and acknowledge the terms and conditions specified in the training bond prior to proceeding on training.	HRM
6	Employees must attend training program as per the specified training schedule and in the event that they miss the training program, they must refund the training expenses.	Employee
7	Upon completion of the training program, the employee should submit the training certificates or any assessment reports to the HRM for placing in their respective personal file.	Employee
8	The DHs should provide opportunity to their team members on utilizing the training knowledge in their day to day work and develop a training action plan. The training action plan should detail how the trainee wants to implement what he has learnt from the training and a period for training action plan review should be agreed upon. At the end the DH should evaluate if the objectives of the training action plan are achieved and if the DH perceives that a further training may be required for the employee, same should be referred to the HRM.	DH
9	The training action plan evaluation report should be sent to the HRM for placing it in the employee personal file.	DH



Figure 19(A): In-house Training Cross Functional Process Map

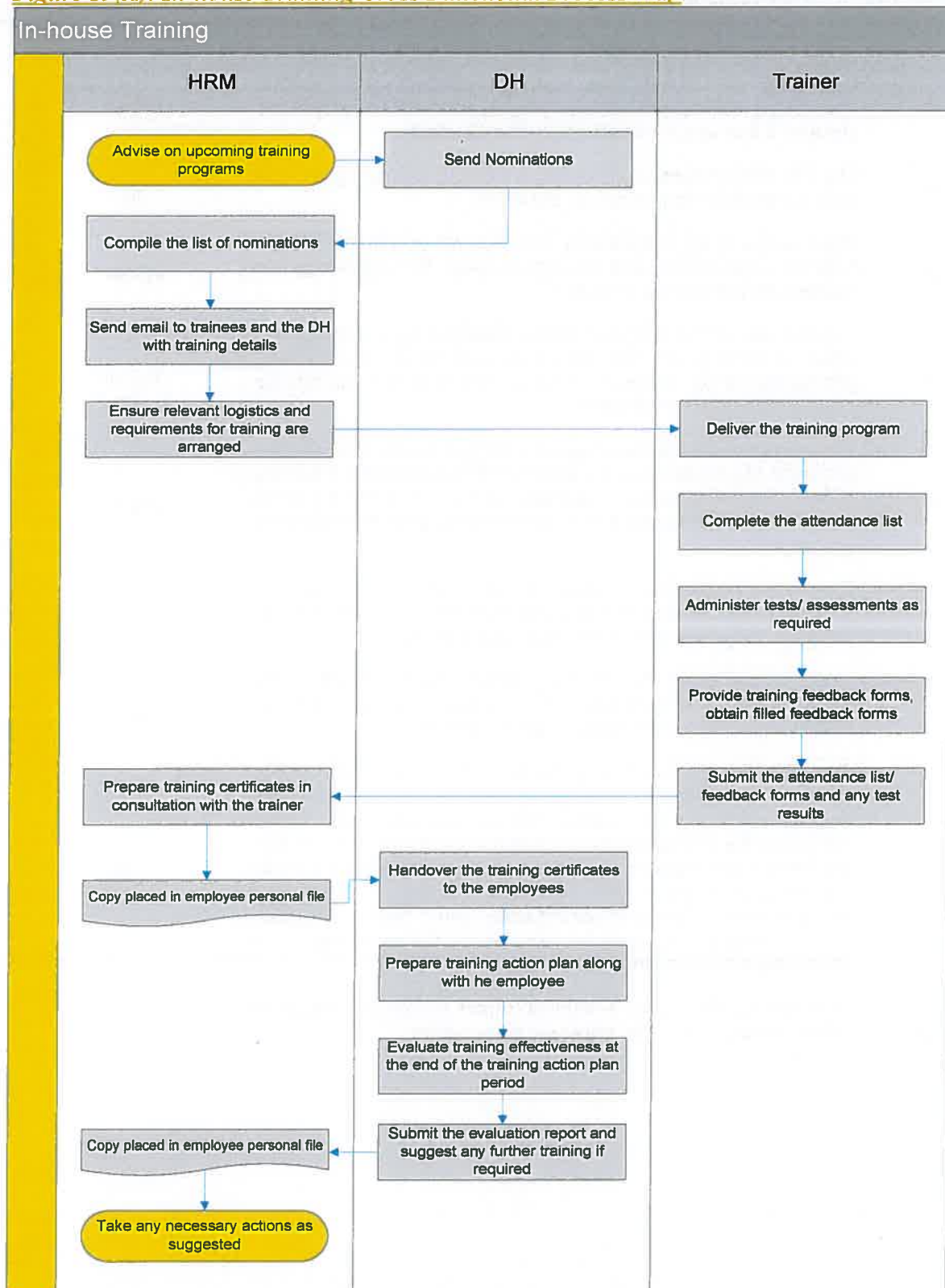
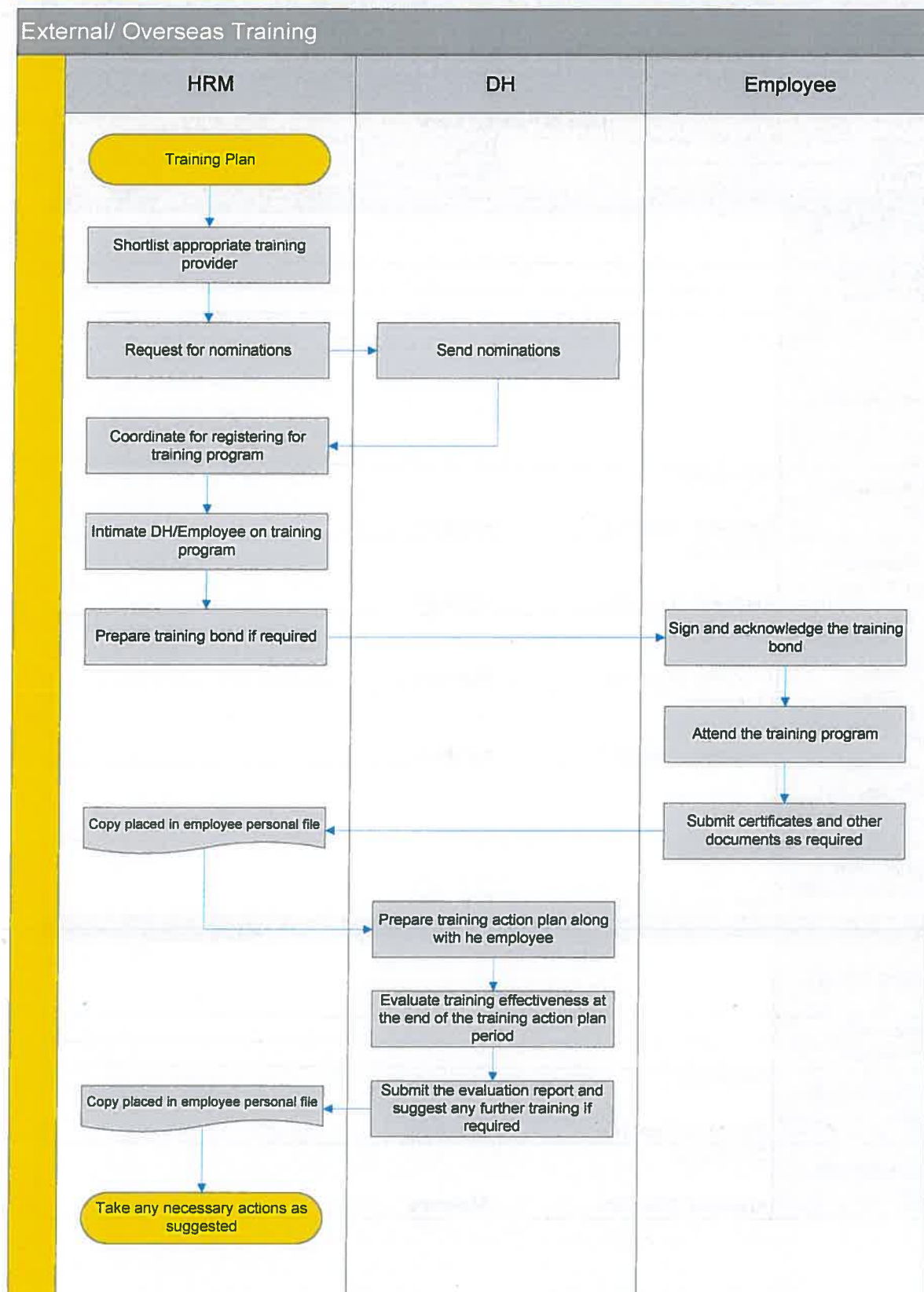


Figure 19(B): External/ Overseas Training Cross Functional Process Map

Chapter 15. Annexure

Section 15.1. Manual Revision Form

Manual Revision Form	
Reference:	Date:
Originated By:	Designation:
Matters proposed to be revised	
Chapter Number & Name	
Section Number	
Article Number	
Page Number	
Proposed Revision	
HRM Review and Signoff	Comments: Approved: (Yes/ No) Signature:
HRC Review and Signoff	Comments: Approved: (Yes/ No) Signature:
COO Review and Signoff	Comments: Approved: (Yes/ No) Signature:
CEO Review and Signoff	Comments: Approved: (Yes/ No) Signature:
BOD Review and Comments	
Chairman BOD Review and Signoff	Comments: Approved: (Yes/ No) Signature:
Manual Revision Control	
Proposed Changes	
Release Date	
Effective Date	
CEO Review and Signoff	Comments: Approved: (Yes/ No) Signature:
HRM Review and Signoff	Comments: Approved: (Yes/ No) Signature:



Section 15.2. Interview Questions and Assignment Examples

The overall purpose of Interview Questions and Assignments is to determine if the candidates are suitable for the position. It is important to assess Technical Suitability AND Personal Suitability

Definitions

Technical Suitability

A candidate is considered technically suitable for the position if he/she has the skills, education, training and technical knowledge required to perform the job.

Responses to Technical Suitability questions tell you if candidates CAN do the job.

Personal Suitability

A candidate is considered to be personally suitable for the position if he/she has the motivation, work habits, and job related people skills and attitudes required to successfully perform the job duties.

Responses to Personal Suitability questions tell you if the applicant WILL do the job.

Assessing Suitability

Really good questions will assess both technical and personal suitability - this is especially true if you are skilled at probing.

Three types of questions that can be used to assess suitability are described in detail below. Examples and the advantages and disadvantages of each type are provided.

A. Behavioral Based Questions

A.1 Description

Behavioral Based Questions ask a person for a specific example of a behavior or skill from their own experience. The initial question is usually followed by a series of follow-up questions which probe for further information and clarification.

Behavioral Based Questioning can feel like a conversation, although the interviewer should keep their part of the conversation to more questions.

Responses to Behavioral Based Questions tell you how a candidate has responded to particular situations or problems in the past. The theory behind behavioral questions is that “the best predictor of whether a person will demonstrate a competency in a job is evidence that the person has demonstrated that competency effectively in a previous situation”.

Therefore, responses to Behavioral Based Questions should tell you how a person



WILL respond in a similar situation

A.2 Example

“Tell us about a time when you were involved in staffing a vacant position. What was your role? Who else was involved? What position were you staffing? What did you do?...”

A.3 Advantages and Disadvantages of Behavioral Based Questions

Advantages	Disadvantages
Assess both technical and personal suitability.	Not all Selection Committee members may be comfortable or skilled in the technique of Behavioral Based Questioning.
The technique focuses on real examples From the candidate's experience, so candidates are less able to quote a textbook answer.	Timeframe for interviews may be more unpredictable – you can't predict what example a candidate will provide, how many follow-up questions need to be asked or how long it will take to respond.

B. Fact Gathering Questions

B.1 Descriptions

These tend to be relatively simple and straightforward. They are less like a conversation and more like a test with a question followed by an answer.

If the answer is not clear, a follow-up question may be asked to get greater clarity. However, care needs to be taken to ensure the follow up doesn't steer the candidate in a particular direction.

Responses to Basic Fact Gathering Questions will tell you if the person possesses the knowledge or skills required to perform the job duties.

B.2 Example

“Please describe the Business Planning Process”



B.3 Advantages and Disadvantages of Fact Gathering Questions

Advantages	Disadvantages
Assess technical suitability clear, quick and easy way to assess knowledge.	Does not assess personal suitability Less useful in assessing whether or not an applicant possesses the skills required for the job. For example, a candidate may be able to describe a problem solving process. This only indicates that they have knowledge of a problem solving process, NOT that they have good problem solving skills.

C. Situational Based Questions

C.1 Description

In a situational question, the candidate is asked to describe a situation and how they would handle it. Some follow-up questions may be asked to help clarify the information provided.

Responses to Situational Based Questions tell you what a candidate THINKS is the best way to respond to a particular situation or problem. It tells you what someone thinks they SHOULD do, which is NOT necessarily what they WOULD do if/when faced with the particular situation.

C.2 Example

“If you were responsible for staffing a candidate, what types of things/major activities would you do?”

C.3 Advantages and Disadvantages of Situational Based Questions

Advantages	Disadvantages		
Assess technical suitability and, to a certain extent, personal suitability Easy to come up with questions about specific situations and to identify the “ideal” expected responses	Too easy for candidates to “tell you what you want to hear”. If you only ask situational based questions to determine personal suitability, you may end up with an employee who knows the right thing to do or say, but doesn’t behave that way in the workplace. Easy for candidates to anticipate questions in certain areas and provide you with that “ideal” answer.		

Finding the Right Mix

Because different types of questions get at different aspects of suitability, you sometimes need to ask a two or three-part question and combine the different types of questions in order to obtain a full picture of each candidate’s suitability.



Generally, a behavioral-based question will assess both personal and technical suitability as the behavioral based question involves the use of multiple questions and probing. Situational questions and fact gathering questions often need to be used together or in combination with a behavioral based question and/or probing in order to obtain a full picture of each candidate's suitability.

Examples of Combining Questions

Situational Question

“If you had a problem, how would you go about solving it?”

As this question does not assess Personal Suitability, probing or a follow up behavioral-based question is required, for example:

“Please describe a situation where you used this approach to solve a problem. What was the problem? Who was involved? What role did you play? What was the end result?...”

Fact Gathering Question

“Describe the Business Planning Process”.

As this question does not assess Personal Suitability, probing or a follow up behavioral-based question is required, for example:

“Describe Business Planning activity that you were involved with. What was your role? Who else was involved? Who was consulted? What was the outcome? What did you learn? What might you do differently next time?”



Section 15.3. Sample Letter to Dismissed/Rejected Candidates

(Date)

(Candidate's Name)

(Candidate's Address)

Dear Candidate:

Application for Employment

We received your recent application for employment with Duqm Development Company, and are returning it for your records. DDC is unwilling to consider your application at this time, as you were (dismissed) (rejected on probation) for cause from your previous position at DDC and have not reestablished a positive work history.

Once you have reestablished a positive and stable work history with other employers, DDC will accept your applications for vacant positions.

Sincerely,

[Name]

Human Resource & Administration Manager



Section 15.4. Screening Criteria

Position Name:	
Position No:	
Location:	
Region:	
Competition Reference:	
Department:	

EDUCATION AND EXPERIENCE

- Completion of a university degree with specialization in journalism, public relations or business administration (marketing), with a minimum five years experience in the communications field.

EQUIVALENCIES

- ☐ A relevant diploma in journalism, public relations or business administration (marketing), combined with seven years experience as outlined above.
- ☐ A Master's degree in journalism, public relations or business administration, combined with three years experience as outlined above.
- ☐ All other equivalencies will be assessed on a case-by-case basis.

SELECTION COMMITTEE MEMBERS:

(Name)	(Title)	Date
(Name)	(Title)	Date
(Name)	HR & Administration Manager	Date



Section 15.5. Reference Check Authorization Form

I hereby authorize any person, educational institution, association, society or company I have listed as a reference below to disclose in good faith any information they may have regarding my qualifications and suitability for employment in Duqm Development Company. These checks are to be made in connection with my application for the position of _____ and must be carried out within thirty days of the signing of this document.

References:

Name	Organization	Phone Number	Reference Type*

*Reference Type: A. Current immediate supervisor

- Former Supervisor
- Other: *Please Specify* _____

Candidate's Signature

Date

Human Resource & Administration Manager



Section 15.6. Reference Check Guide

Person Contacted _____

Telephone Number _____

Remember to:

- Inform the referee that all information provided will be kept strictly confidential.
- Briefly describe the position being filled.

Describe the nature of your relationship with the candidate (e.g. supervisor, client, peer, etc.)

Comment on the candidate's strengths and weaknesses.

How would you rate the overall quality of the candidate's performance? (outstanding, good, average, poor, unsatisfactory)

Comment on the candidate's attendance, dependability and their ability to take on new responsibilities.

These are the knowledge, skills and ability required for the position (See job description for a brief description). How has the candidate demonstrated these in the past while working in your organization?

Ask the referee questions that stem from the interview, assignment or resume that the selection committee would like to verify or know more about from the supervisor's perspective.

What kind of recommendation would you give the candidate for this particular position and why?

Is there anything else that you would like to tell us about the candidate's knowledge skills, and ability?

Would you rehire this person in a similar capacity: Yes No Another capacity: Yes No

If not, why:

Completed by: _____

Date: _____



Annexure (1): HR Manual Guidance

Item	Guidance										
Salary Scale	- Using salary structure (Head Office) attached. - Using the minimum gross salary for replacing current staff and attracting new hiring. - University fresh graduate salary is the average between Min & Max of grade 6, which is RO 1,180. - Basic salary 70% and Allowance 30%. - Allowances distribution percentage as per practices in government companies. - Methodology staff grade allocation grades and titles in HR Manual and guidance at annexure (2). - Company may add 3% from basic salary on max total years of experience if required to attract or retain any staff.										
Annual increment	3% from Gross Salary										
Pension system	HR Manual applicable for staff attached with PASI.										
Working Hours	Eight working hours a day or 40 hours a week according to MOMP Law.										
Furniture allowance	To hold upon BOD approval										
End of service gratuity	- Adopt SEZAD policy or any government companies where is appropriate. - As per Labor law for expatriates. - Employees entitle who completed minimum one year in services.										
Children education allowance	<table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Job Grade</th><th>Allowance per child (RO)</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>1</td><td>2,500</td></tr> <tr> <td>2</td><td>2,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>3</td><td>1,500</td></tr> <tr> <td>4</td><td>1,000</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Job Grade	Allowance per child (RO)	1	2,500	2	2,000	3	1,500	4	1,000
Job Grade	Allowance per child (RO)										
1	2,500										
2	2,000										
3	1,500										
4	1,000										
Annual Leaves	As per HR Manual										
Vehicles	- Provide for business use. - Management to develop vehicles use policy.										
Telephone	- Provide for business use. - Management to develop Telephone use policy.										



Salary Structure (Head Office)

Grade	Basic Salary		Housing Allowance	Transportation Allowance	Gross Salary	
	Minimum	Maximum			Minimum	Maximum
1	4,700	7,480	1,500	*	6,200	8,980
2	4,200	6,600	1,260	*	5,450	7,850
3	3,000	4,400	1,000	375	4,375	5,775
4.1	2,000	3,300	625	250	2,875	4,175
4.2	1,500	2,400	400	200	2,100	3,000
5	1,100	1,785	250	165	1,515	2,200
6	600	1,265	160	100	850	1,515
7	450	650	100	100	650	850
8	300	525	75	50	425	650
9	150	300	75	50	275	425
10	50	200	50	25	125	275

Rial Omani

G1. maintain a company car amount of (28,000)

G2. Maintain a company car amount of (23,000)



Provisional Grade	Basic Salary			Housing and Food Allowances		Transportation Allowances		Gross Salary		
	Minimum	Median	Maximum					Minimum	Median	Maximum
O&M 1	1,700	1,950	2,200	350	250			2,300	2,550	2,800
O&M 2	1,200	1,450	1,700	250	165			1,615	1,865	2,115
O&M 3	650	925	1,200	150	125			925	1,200	1,475
O&M 4	450	550	650	125	100			675	775	875
O&M 5	250	350	450	100	50			400	500	600
O&M 6	150	200	250	100	50			300	350	400
O&M 7	100	150	200	50	25			175	225	275
O&M 8	60	90	120	10	10			80	110	140

Rial Omani





Appendix (1)

Table of minimum qualifications and experience required - Head Office and Engineers

Levels	Proposed Job Title	Grade	Job Requirements	Remarks
	Chief Executive Officer	Special Contract	In accordance with the Board resolution	This for salary and other benefits
Senior Management Jobs	• Chief Technical officer • Chief Financial Officer • Senior Manager • Senior expert, Advisor or Consultant	1	• PhD + 8 years' experience • Master's degree + 12 years' experience. • An appropriate university degree + 15 years' experience.	The grade based on: • Staff and position criticality to the business. • Last salary. • Expected achievements and delivery.
	• Chief Engineers • Sr. Projects Manager • Sr. Operation & Maintenance Manager	2	• Professional qualification + 10 years' experience. • Or other professional experience meet job requirements.	









Managerial level Jobs	- Department Managers for core business. - Department Managers for support business. - Project Manager or PIC for special project. - Expert. - Sr. Specialist (core business). - Sr. Project Manager - Sr. Operation & Maintenance Engineer - Sr. Engineer	3	- PhD + 5 years' experience - Master's degree + 8 years' experience. - An appropriate university degree + 10 years' experience. - Professional qualification + 10 years' experience. - Or other professional experience meets job requirements. - Sr. Engineer require Professional qualification + 10 years' experience	The grade based on: - Staff and position criticality to the business. - Last salary. - Expected achievements and delivery. - Core business positions related to project management, Facilities management and investment.
Line Management Jobs	- Section Head. - In Charge. - Supervisor. - Sr. Specialist for non-core. Business. - Executive Secretary - Sr. Support services staff - Sr. Auditor	4.2	- Master's degree + 5 years' experience. - An appropriate university degree + 8 years' experience. - Professional qualification + 7 years' experience.	The grade based on: - Staff and position criticality to the business. - Last salary. - Expected achievements and delivery.



	• Sr. Engineer • Project/Civil/ Electrical/ Mechanical Engineer	5	• Or other professional experience meets job requirements. • Sr. Engineer require Professional qualification + 7 years' experience • Project/Civil/Electrical/ Mechanical Engineer require Professional qualification + 5 years' experience	• Core business positions related to project management, Facilities management and investment.
Functional jobs	• Fresh Diploma Graduates. • Sr. Engineer • Project/Civil/ Electrical/ Mechanical Engineer • Operation & Maintenance Engineer • QS • Support services staff. • Auditor. • Archive • Administrator (HR, Admin) • Asst. Accountant • IT Support	6	• An appropriate university degree + 8 years' experience. • Professional qualification + 7 years' experience. • Or other professional experience meet job requirements	The grade based on: • Staff and position criticality to the business. • Last salary. • Expected achievements and delivery. • Core business positions related to project management, Facilities management and investment.

Auxiliary jobs	• Secretary. • Coordinator • PRO • Receptionist • Assistant • PA	7	• Post-secondary Diploma + 5 years' experience. • Post-secondary Diploma + 2 years' experience. • Post-secondary Diploma • Secondary school certificate + 4 years' experience	The grade based on: • Staff and position criticality to the business. • Last salary. • Expected achievements and delivery.
Skilled jobs and support services	• Drivers • Messengers • Service assistants	8	• Secondary school certificate (or equivalent). • Secondary/ preliminary school	The grade based on: • Last salary. • Expected achievements and delivery.

- Fresh Bachelor graduates will take the average salary of grade 6 (OMR. 1180)
- Grade 10 and 9 are not applicable as per MOMP law Ministerial Decision No. 222/2013
- This salary scale is only for permeanant Omani staff
- Positions not mentioned in above table can be mapped with other positions have same qualification / experience & required competencies at this table.








Board Meeting (2/2018) held on June 25, 2018

**BOARD RESOLUTION (2-2/2018)
FORMATION OF HR COMMITTEE**

Board Resolution 2-2/2018

The Board approved the formation of the HR Committee with the following members:

- a. Mr. Salah Al Maawali – Board Member
- b. Dr. Rashid Al Balushi – Board Member
- c. Chief Executive Officer (CEO) ,
- d. Chief Technical Officer (CTO)
- e. Chief Financial Officer (CEO)

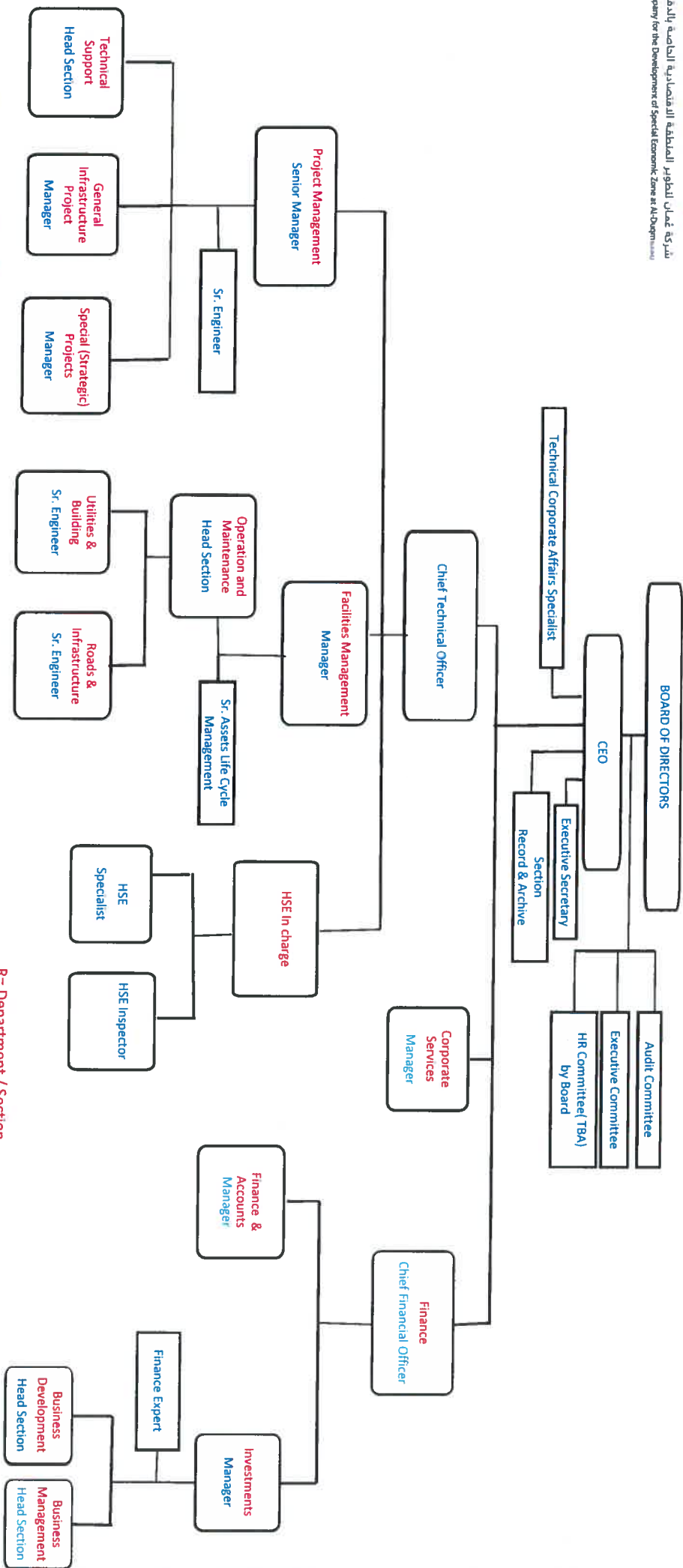
Till the time the positions for CTO and CFO are not filled Senior Manager Projects and Finance Manager will replace respectively

The Board agreed to have SLA agreement with Duqm Quarries for HR related matters as Duqm Quarries will follow the same HR Manual and guidelines.


Yahya bin Said bin Abdullah Al Jabri
Chairman

Date: 25/6/2018

ORGANISATION STRUCTURE



Corporate Services will include following departments HR, IT, Legal, Admin, Shared Services etc. and the positions will be filled as and when required as per business needs.

R= Department / Section
 B= Designation
 G=Employee Name
 TBE (To Be Employed)
 TBA(To Be Approve)



